

Religion, Education, and the State*

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Abstract

This paper explores how state and religious providers of education compete during the nation building process. Using novel administrative data, we characterize the evolution of Indonesia's Islamic education system and religious school choice after the introduction of mass public primary schooling in the 1970s. Funded through informal taxation, Islamic schools competed with the state by entering in the same markets. While primary enrollment shifted towards state schools, religious education increased overall as Islamic schools absorbed growing demand for secondary education. In the short run, electoral support for the secular regime weakened in markets with greater public school construction. Over the long run, Islamic schools established at this juncture are more differentiated in terms of religious curriculum, and cohorts exposed to mass public schooling as children are more invested in religion than in the national identity. Our findings offer a new perspective on the political economy of education reforms and the emergence of parallel systems of public goods provision.

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1 Introduction

Providing education is one of the central missions of modern states. Yet, for centuries, religious organizations, rather than the state, provided schooling to the masses. In many countries, the state sidelined religious schools through sweeping secularization policies. In others, these schools still cater to large numbers of students. These varied trajectories raise important questions about how state and non-state providers of education compete throughout the development process. Recent work has examined the link between schooling reforms and ideology (Alesina et al., 2021; Cantoni et al., 2017) but has not explored the competitive response to state expansion in education markets, nor its potential to trigger a cultural backlash (Carvalho et al., 2022; Fouka, 2020; Squicciarini, 2020). In this paper, we show how educational expansion aimed at nation-building can have unintended consequences in the presence of equilibrium responses by competing religious institutions.

We explore the political economy of education reforms in Indonesia, the world’s largest Muslim country. Millions of Indonesians were educated in religious institutions historically, and around one-fifth of students attended Islamic schools in 2019. This dual system has persisted despite many attempts by the state to reform it. In the 1970s, the country underwent a drastic expansion of its public schooling system through the celebrated *Sekolah Dasar* Presidential Instruction, or SD INPRES (Duflo, 2001). This policy not only increased access to public primary schooling, but also aimed to homogenize education through the adoption of a single secular national curriculum (Boland, 1982; Kelabora, 1976). We study how the Islamic school system adapted to this landmark policy and mitigated its impacts.

Our empirical strategy examines the dynamic effects of SD INPRES on education markets and exposed cohorts. We use several novel data sources to explore how the policy shaped multiple dimensions of schooling content and cultural outcomes. Nationally-representative surveys capture Islamic school choice, and administrative data record the universe of schools with date and location of establishment. The latter comprise nearly 220,000 secular and 160,000 Islamic schools, including day (*madrasa*), boarding (*pesantren*), and Qur’anic study schools (*diniyah*). Additional survey and administrative data help uncover local mechanisms for mobilizing and funding the Islamic sector response to SD INPRES. For some schools, we also observe a breakdown of curriculum hours in 2019, which we use to measure religious instruction and to identify shifts in ideological differentiation over the long run. Together, these data enable us to characterize market equilibria in the ensuing decades.

We explore the policy’s multifaceted effects on three types of outcomes: Islamic school entry, school choice, and downstream ideological impacts. Using a suite of difference-in-differences (DID) methods, we first assess how SD INPRES affected Islamic school entry across different markets. The state allocated schools across districts proportional to their non-enrolled-student population, which *de facto* implied greater SD INPRES construction in markets where Islamic schools had been prevalent historically. Motivated by this insight, we estimate DID specifications that flexibly account for differential trends in Islamic education and use the synthetic DID approach (Arkhangelsky et al., 2021), which is more robust to potential violations of parallel trends. Using our granular administrative data, we also exploit, for the first time, the staggered entry of INPRES schools at the village level.

Islamic school construction increased in areas where the state built more primary schools. We find

greater entry both at the primary level, where new *madrasa* provided an alternative to newly built public primary schools, and at the secondary level, where *madrasa* capitalized on growing demand for continued schooling among SD INPRES graduates. This ensured that the state's educational expansion failed to crowd out Islamic schools. Informal boarding schools and afternoon Qur'anic study schools also entered, but these informal institutions decreased as a fraction of all new Islamic schools, consistent with competition from the state inducing formalization in the religious education sector.¹

The Islamic sector mobilized its own resources to respond to the state's mass schooling effort. While windfall oil revenues allowed the state to build more than 61,000 schools between 1973–80, increased revenue from a simultaneous spike in the global price of rice accrued to the largely informal Islamic taxation system. In addition, the Islamic sector mobilized inalienable religious endowments (*waqf*) to expand educational infrastructure. Local elites often use the *waqf* to “endow public goods in perpetuity and to benefit from the prestige and reputational benefits associated with this public demonstration of piety,” allowing “public recognition of their legacy to survive for decades” (Fauzia, 2013, p. 36). This revenue stream, built on private charity, supports religious investments in education markets across the Muslim world. We show that the entry response was stronger in villages with a larger *waqf* base before INPRES and greater exposure to the concurrent rice price shock. Meanwhile, as state oil revenue collapsed in the early 1980s, capacity constraints in public secondary schools deepened, thus creating an opportunity for the Islamic sector to capture SD INPRES graduates at the secondary level.

Islamic schools could have shifted their curriculum in a more secular direction to mitigate competition from SD INPRES schools and attract a larger student base. On the contrary, we find suggestive evidence that new *madrasa* entering high-INPRES districts after the program provided more religious curriculum over the long run at the primary and junior secondary level. We measure differentiation based on classroom hours devoted to religious subjects, including Islamic law, theology, and ethics, as well as Arabic instruction. The increase in Islamic content comes, in part, at the expense of core subjects in the standard curriculum, including study of the national language and *Pancasila*, the secular ideology of the state. These responses worked against the state's efforts to homogenize and secularize school curricula across Indonesia.

While Islamic schools lost market share in primary education, they expanded in secondary and ultimately increased exposure to formal Islamic education. Among school-age cohorts, SD INPRES decreased Islamic elementary enrollment. However, mass primary schooling created excess demand for secondary education, and the Islamic sector could absorb many INPRES graduates in its newly built secondary institutions.² Overall, these demand effects at the secondary level offset substitution effects at the primary level and made it more likely that exposed cohorts attended a formal Islamic school. Thus,

¹In our data, formal and informal elementary Islamic schools clearly appear to be substitutes. 86% of the new informal Qur'anic study schools (*dinyah*) entering from 1973–78 were built in villages without any formal elementary *madrasa* construction, while 91% of the entering *madrasa* were built in villages without any *dinyah* construction.

²Auxiliary data from the Indonesian Family Life Survey suggest that nearly 80% of students in Islamic secondary schools attended public primary schools, and Indonesia is not unique in the prevalence of public-to-private transitions. In a series of studies, James (1987a,b, 1993) observed, across many countries, that excess demand for secondary education was an inevitable outcome of mass primary schooling interventions and a potential driver of growth in private secondary schools. An advisor to the Indonesian government observed that “[i]n 1972, any plan that rapidly increased the number of students going beyond grade 6 would have resulted in grave problems of accommodation” (Beeby, 1979, p. 193).

SD INPRES increased not only years of schooling but also, unexpectedly, exposure to *madrassa* education.

We show that heterogeneous preferences shaped these school choice responses. Female students exhibit stronger demand effects at the secondary level, particularly among cohorts exposed to a subsequent regulation banning the Islamic veil in public schools. While SD INPRES had more limited impacts on total years of schooling among girls, those impacts might have been even more limited if not for the new Islamic elementary options. Families were also more likely to send their children to an Islamic secondary school in high-INPRES regions with deeper historical support for Islamic politics.

These results open a new window into the celebrated SD INPRES program and help explain the surprising political and ideological legacy of mass schooling. The school expansion did not benefit the autocratic President Suharto's political party, *Golkar*, in the 1977 and 1982 elections, nor after 1987 when affected cohorts began to vote. In the medium to long run, school-age exposure to SD INPRES did not increase support for *Pancasila*, use of the national language, or affinity with secular principles. Instead, exposed cohorts are more literate in Arabic (a core part of Islamic school curriculum) and exhibit greater piety across a range of Islamic practices. Finally, Arabic literacy among affected cohorts is passed on to children in the next generation. Together, these results show that Indonesia's landmark mass public schooling policy did not bolster support for the regime nor adoption of a secular Indonesian identity.

Our paper provides a new perspective on the competition between the state and alternative providers of public goods over the course of development. While our focus is on education, the dynamics we study may apply broadly to other domains such as tax collection (Olken and Singhal, 2011), health (Lowe and Montero, 2019), policing (Blattman et al., 2021), and justice (Acemoglu et al., 2020). Competitive frictions are especially salient at early stages of development where limited capacity often induces states to outsource service delivery (Banerjee et al., 2019; Romero et al., 2020). Equipped with rich data on formal and informal schools, we offer new insights on the challenges associated with the formalization process. Our findings have implications for many settings where dual systems of governance involving traditional, informal, or religious authorities have endured (Acemoglu et al., 2014; Basurto et al., 2020).

Building on research across the social sciences, we also provide novel evidence on the role of education in nation building (Anderson, 1983; Boli et al., 1985; Gellner, 1983; Green, 1990). Recent work shows that mass schooling is introduced during periods of social conflict (Paglayan, 2022) and describes the strategies used by states to engage with religious schools (Ansell and Lindvall, 2013).³ Our key innovation lies in understanding how the responses by non-state actors shape the impacts of mass schooling. Squicciarini (2020) shows how Catholic schooling slowed the diffusion of technical knowledge in 19th century France (see also Franck and Johnson, 2016). West and Woessmann (2010) argue that such backlash was pervasive in European states with a large Catholic population but where Catholicism was not the state religion.⁴ In contrast, we explore competition between state and non-state schools after one of the largest school expansion programs ever implemented. Ultimately, the Islamic

³Alesina et al. (2021), Paglayan (2021), and Testa (2018) study why non-democratic regimes engage in mass schooling. Cantoni and Yuchtman (2013) examine the tradeoffs governments face in determining new forms of educational content. In the U.S., Bandiera et al. (2019) link the rise of compulsory schooling to nation-building efforts in response to mass immigration. Cantoni et al. (2017) study how a curriculum reform affected political attitudes in China. Other studies show that education fosters civic values and engagement (Andrabi et al., 2020; Dee, 2004; Larreguy and Marshall, 2017).

⁴On cultural backlash to state schooling policies, see also Fouka (2020) and Sakalli (2019) for examples from the U.S. and Turkey.

sector response contributed to the program’s limited impacts on secular nation building.

Prior work on SD INPRES has not explored market dynamics or the program’s nation-building consequences. [Akresh et al. \(2018\)](#) and [Mazumder et al. \(2019\)](#) explore intergenerational effects on similar outcomes as [Duflo \(2001\)](#), while [Ashraf et al. \(2020\)](#) study effects on ethnic groups with a bride price tradition, and [Hsiao \(2023\)](#) quantifies the program’s distributional impacts in a spatial equilibrium framework. [Martinez-Bravo \(2017\)](#), [Roth and Sumarto \(2015\)](#), and [Rohner and Saia \(2019\)](#) explore impacts on governance, intergroup tolerance, and conflict. We expand the scope of analysis to provide new insights into the political economy of schooling reforms in the presence of alternative religious providers.

These insights also advance the literature on education and its consequences for religious transmission. Some have explored the returns to Catholic schooling ([Altonji et al., 2005](#); [Neal, 1997](#)), while others provided background on Islamic schooling in Muslim societies ([Andrabi et al., 2006](#); [Berman and Stepanyan, 2004](#)). Few studies distinguish between private secular and private religious schools, which often pursue distinct ideological objectives. Our findings suggest that mass public schooling in Indonesia fell short of its ideological objectives through a combination of exposure to religious education and increased transmission of Islamic values (as in the models of [Bisin et al., 2020](#); [Carvalho et al., 2022](#)). This ensured that religiosity persisted over the long run. As such, our paper is among the first to link educational expansion to greater piety, at the expense of secularization objectives.⁵ We provide a new answer to the puzzle of enduring religion in modernizing societies: religious institutions vary in their capacity to adapt to secularization, and religious schools can provide a relevant substitute to public education.

2 Political Economy of Education in Indonesia

Indonesia’s vibrant Islamic education sector reflects the enduring role of religious schools in a country home to more than 230 million Muslims. This section provides relevant background on the origins and the resilience of the country’s dual education system. Appendix C additionally presents qualitative accounts, collected via novel oral histories, of Islamic schools constructed during the mass schooling era.

2.1 Origins and Characteristics of the Dual Education System

Indonesia’s education system has historically been comprised of secular and religious schools. The former were modeled after the Dutch system and first built in large numbers during the colonial era. After 1945, amidst heated debate about the role of religion in the young nation, Indonesia’s new leaders opted for a state-run secular education system governed by the Ministry of Education and Culture (MEC).

However, Islamic schools long predated secular schools. The country’s first religious schools, going as far back as the 15th century, were the *pesantren*, a type of boarding school blending Islamic and Javanese pedagogical principles. Contemporary *pesantren* are dedicated to the study of Islam, face little regulatory oversight, and offer instruction across multiple ages often in the same classroom.

⁵Many studies show that education weakens religious practice (e.g., [Hungerman, 2014](#)), with examples in Germany ([Arold et al., 2022](#); [Becker et al., 2017](#)) and Turkey ([Cesur and Mocan, 2018](#); [Gulesci and Meyersson, 2016](#)). However, across countries there is considerable heterogeneity in the education–religiosity relationship (see Appendix Figure A.10).

Madrasa, the main type of Islamic school operating today, are day schools that use methods similar to secular schools but offer more religious content. Inspired by reformist influences from the Middle East, *madrasa* appeared in Indonesia in the early 1900s as an attempt to modernize Islamic education and counter Western influence (Kelabora, 1976; Kuipers, 2011). *Madrasa* operate at the same levels as secular schools, from primary to junior secondary to senior secondary, but teach a range of religious subjects that are not covered in the latter. This includes Islamic law (*fiqh*), doctrine (*aqidah*), ethics (*akhlaq*), the Qur'an and traditions of Prophet Muhammad (*hadith*), Arabic language, and history of the Prophets (*qisa al-anbiya*). In our data, the average *madrasa* devotes 26% of instruction hours to religious content, only 5% is devoted to *Pancasila* and civic education, and an additional 5% to Indonesian language and literature. Beyond the formal *madrasa*, more informal schools known as *madrasa diniyah* focus largely on Qur'anic study, often operate in the afternoon, and attract students who attend public schools in the morning.

Although officially under the purview of the Ministry of Religious Affairs (MORA), the Islamic education system is highly decentralized with most establishments run through autonomous *waqf* endowments. Beyond its traditional role in supporting religious public goods, the *waqf* has often been used by religious elites in Indonesia (and beyond) to buttress local institutions against state encroachment. *Waqf* provide the land on which schools are built and some of the revenue to cover construction and operating costs. Under Islamic law, assets held in *waqf* are inalienable and can only be used for religious or charitable purposes. Bazzi et al. (2020) show how land transfers into *waqf* across Indonesia in the 1960s allowed Islamic institutions such as *pesantren* and *madrasa* to thrive and ensured their long-term financial autonomy. In addition to *waqf*-based financing, voluntary faith-based contributions (*infaq*) and obligatory alms (*zakat*) are important sources of revenue. While some schools are affiliated with large Indonesian Islamic NGOs, the vast majority are run by independent, local Islamic actors.⁶

Islamic schools comprise the majority of all private schools (more than 60% in 2019), and within many markets, private school choice is tantamount to Islamic school choice. Unlike non-religious private schools, Islamic and state schools charge minimal fees. According to 2015 household survey data (*Susenas*), average annual costs of primary *madrasa* were USD 20 compared to USD 21 for primary public, and students report traveling similar distances to attend each type of school. This suggests ample scope for local competition, something already observed in the early 1970s: “[e]xcept for the small number who can afford the more expensive private schools, the only significant choice at the primary level is between schools under the Education Department [i.e., SD] and religious schools” (Beeby, 1979).

At the time of writing, Islamic schools enroll 21% of Indonesia’s 60 million students (Appendix Table A.16). More than two-thirds of these students attend formal *madrasa* with the remainder in *pesantren*. The rest attend secular schools, the vast majority of which are public, especially at the primary level.

2.2 The Politics of SD INPRES

Despite multiple reform attempts under Indonesia’s first president, Sukarno, the government failed to homogenize the country’s education system and to achieve universal primary schooling.⁷ In the 1960s,

⁶We show in Section 3.2 that our findings on Islamic school entry are not driven by religious-NGO-affiliated schools.

⁷For example, in 1958, a failed reform aimed to limit religious instruction time to 21–28% of study hours in Islamic schools.

Indonesia was deeply divided, and a new regime, President Suharto's New Order, took hold after mass violence decimated a burgeoning Communist movement. Although Suharto initially allied with Islamic movements in the fight against Communism, after becoming president, he began mobilizing against some of these same forces, then seen as opposing his vision for the nation-state.

Suharto prioritized universal public education as part of a broader secular nation-building agenda at odds with organized Islam. The regime tried in 1967 and again in 1972, failing both times, to convince Islamic schools to become state-run and to reduce their religious curriculum. A decade later in 1982, a MEC regulation imposed standardized uniforms in public schools. This was tantamount to a ban on Islamic veiling (see Appendix Figure A.9). Confrontation also emerged in domains besides education. In the early 1970s, the state enacted a Marriage Law challenging Muslim marital norms enforced by Islamic courts (Cammack, 1989). In 1973, the regime forced Islamic political organizations into the umbrella United Development Party (*Partai Persatuan Pembangunan* or PPP). In 1977, the regime forced the PPP to drop Islamic symbolism, and in 1984 forced it to adopt *Pancasila* as its official ideological platform.

It was during this conflictual period that the regime launched SD INPRES. Equipped with windfall oil revenues, the government allocated considerable resources for primary school construction. Presidential Instruction No. 10/1973 and subsequent yearly decrees specified funding allocations to each district as a function of the child population not enrolled in school. In total, up to 61,000 schools were constructed between 1973–80 under the program, with districts building between 16 and 824 new elementary schools.⁸ Parallel to the school expansion program, a 1972 decree stipulated that all formal education must be administered by the MEC. This was strongly opposed by Muslim leaders and abandoned in 1975.⁹ The regime also intended to expand secondary school construction after SD INPRES implementation. However, as oil prices collapsed in the early 1980s, budgetary resources dried up, leaving the country with far fewer secondary public schools than anticipated by planners in the 1970s.

This vast reform agenda aimed at secularizing and homogenizing primary education. Civic education was to supplant certain Islamic subjects, while instruction was to take place in the national language, *Bahasa Indonesia*, rather than local ethnic languages or Arabic. The goal was to build a citizenry steeped in the inclusive *Pancasila* ideology and invested in the national identity. A World Bank (1989) report notes that "... public education was viewed by the Government as a key medium for promoting national unity—first, through instruction in *Pancasila*, and next through instruction in the national language" (p. 14), and that "[i]n so large and dispersed a country ... policymakers have consistently looked to neighborhood primary schools as vehicles for national integration" (p. 35).

Given its objective to expand public schooling, SD INPRES was prone to confrontation with the Islamic sector. The policy rule allocated resources proportional to the non-enrolled primary-school-age population at the district level within provinces. This meant building more schools in areas with greater unmet demand for formal education. Figure 1 shows that such areas were precisely where Islamic schools had greater presence historically.¹⁰ Panel (a) illustrates the SD INPRES policy rule: the num-

⁸The Presidential Decrees for 1973–74 (INPRES 10/1973 and 6/1974), 1975–76 (6/1975 and 3/1976), 1977–78 (3/1977 and 6/1978) and 1979–80 (12/1979 and 6/1980) authorized grants for 6,000, 10,000, 15,000, and 14,000 new schools, respectively.

⁹According to Zuhdi (2006, p. 89), Muslim leaders believed the Decrees "intended, among other things, to weaken the status of the Islamic educational institutions ... they assumed that the government was trying to eliminate these latter ...".

¹⁰The SD INPRES guidelines were vague about how Islamic education should be treated. Decrees were only addressed to the

ber of schools allocated to a district is proportional to non-enrolled children in 1971. Panel (b) shows that Islamic primary schools are more likely to operate in areas underserved by the state. This induces a strong correlation between the number of SD INPRES built and the pre-existing stock of Islamic schools (panel c).¹¹ Table 1 corroborates the graphical evidence in Figure 1. First, we find similar targeting patterns regardless of the measure of Islamic primary education (columns 1–3). Second, conditional on the prevalence of Islamic education, the vote share of Islamic parties in the 1950s is also positively correlated with SD INPRES construction (column 4), which is consistent with the state allocating more schools to markets with more religious preferences. Finally, column 5 provides more localized evidence of confrontation: INPRES schools were more likely to be built in villages with an Islamic primary school and less likely in villages with a non-Islamic primary school.¹²

Qualitative accounts describe how those in the Muslim community perceived SD INPRES to be targeting Islamic sector strongholds (see Appendix C). Islamic school staff were required to take courses in *Pancasila* and accused of mobilizing for the Islamic PPP. In some communities, preachers urged congregants not to send their children to SD INPRES, which were derided as “school in hell” (*sekolah dalam neraka*) using a twist on the official acronym (*sekolah dasar negeri* or SDN).

While education was a central element of Suharto’s homogenizing nation-building agenda, other policies also affected the landscape of ideological conflict. These include (i) a large population resettlement program, known as Transmigration, that moved millions of individuals from the Inner Islands of Java and Bali to the religiously and ethnically diverse Outer Islands of the country (see Bazzi et al., 2016, 2019), (ii) several administrative reforms aimed at harmonizing governance across the archipelago, culminating in a Village Law of 1979 that forced a single homogenous structure on village bureaucracies and may have helped extend the reach of Suharto’s *Golkar* party (Kato, 1989), and (iii) suppression of separatist movements from Aceh to Papua to East Timor. In our empirical analysis, we account for potential confounding effects of these other events in the SD INPRES era.

2.3 Predictions: School Entry, School Choice, and Ideology

Before turning to our empirical analysis, we briefly outline the main hypotheses we aim to test. We explore the multifaceted effects of SD INPRES on three types of outcomes: Islamic school entry, school choice along the secular–religious dimension, and downstream ideological impacts.

First, we study how SD INPRES affected Islamic school entry at different levels of policy variation

Minister of Education and not the Minister of Religion who oversaw *madrasa*. An article early in the original decree (10/1973) references students not accommodated in public elementary schools, but later discussions of the proportionality rule merely refer to children who have not been accommodated without specifying the type of school. Furthermore, the proportional targeting was informed by the 1971 Census, which did not distinguish Islamic school enrollment. Observers at the time noted that official “targets have no reference to children enrolled in primary Madrasah” (Beeby, 1979, p. 196) and that the low enrollment rates in official data for some regions “could well be a function of the number of children who attend madrasah instead of sekolah dasar” (Orr et al., 1977, p. 133).

¹¹In panel (d), we additionally control for the vote share of Islamic parties in the 1955 and 1957 elections, the last democratic contests before our study period. Estimates remain similar as in panel (c).

¹²In Appendix Table A.1, we show that the estimates in Table 1 are robust to controlling more flexibly for population. We include indicators for each decile of the 1971 child population and the 1971 enrollment rate in which each district’s measure falls. These controls leave our main results on the confrontation between secular and Islamic schools unchanged.

and market aggregation (Section 3.1). Mass public schooling intensified competition in local education markets. This could have led to crowding in or crowding out of Islamic schools. At the primary level, competitive frictions might have arisen if the Islamic sector attempted to push back against the growing cultural influence of the state’s secular schools in the same markets. At the same time, SD INPRES might have generated strategic complementarities by increasing demand for secondary education, on which Islamic schools were well positioned to capitalize. We thus explore entry responses at both the primary and the secondary instruction level. Since the strength of these competitive responses depended on the Islamic sector’s ability to mobilize resources of its own, we also ask whether its schools entered markets where revenue-raising capacity, through informal Islamic taxation, was higher (Section 3.2). We provide additional evidence that formal Islamic schools gained influence at the expense of informal schools, and show, more suggestively, that new formal religious schools may have further differentiated their curriculum to maintain enrollment (Section 3.3). These findings are consistent with a Hotelling model of competition in which students differ in their preferences for religious schooling, and schools of both types decide which markets to enter and how religious to make their curriculum (see Appendix B for formal derivations and discussion of key insights from this framework).

We then examine the policy’s nuanced effects on religious school choice (Section 4). We ask whether the evolution of religious school choice mirrors the observed patterns of school entry: increased competition at the primary level might have reduced the market share of Islamic schools at this level, but this could have been offset by demand effects at the secondary level, if the Islamic sector managed to absorb many INPRES graduates in its newly built secondary institutions. We also explore whether heterogeneous preferences by gender and by ideology shaped religious schooling decisions.

Finally, we study the downstream effects of mass schooling on identity, ideology, and nation building (Section 5). Students choosing between a state and a religious school after SD INPRES eventually became citizens who supported either the ruling secular regime or the religious opposition. We ask whether the market-level shifts went hand-in-hand with deeper individual-level shifts in religiosity and ideology among exposed cohorts and their children. In doing so, we shed light on the extent to which the state’s mass schooling policy succeeded in advancing its secular, nation-building objectives.

3 Religious School Entry and Differentiation

This section studies the dynamic effects of SD INPRES on education markets. First, Muslim society, equipped with a mechanism for mobilizing private resources (*waqf*), expanded religious schooling in locations with greater SD INPRES entry. Second, newly entering Islamic schools in these locations provided, over the long run, more religious content instead of making their curriculum closer to the state’s. Third, SD INPRES induced formalization within the Islamic sector. We study these effects in turn.

3.1 Islamic School Entry

We use data from administrative school registries and two distinct identification strategies to characterize the Islamic sector entry response to SD INPRES. The first relies on cross-sectional policy variation at

the district level. The second exploits the staggered entry of SD INPRES at the village level.

Data on School Registries. We use newly compiled administrative data from MORA comprising the universe of *madrassa* and *pesantren* active in 2019 (see Appendix D for details). In total, there are 52,398 formal *madrassa* across different grade levels, 82,871 informal *madrassa diniyah* (Qur’an study schools), and 25,938 *pesantren*, with establishment dates spanning more than 100 years. We rely on an analogous MEC registry of secular schools active in 2019. These data comprise 219,145 schools and include date of establishment, grade level, and private/public status. We address potential concerns about survival bias in these registries using a triennial census of villages (known as *Podes*) beginning in 1980.¹³

District-Level Identification. We estimate a balanced panel specification at the district-year level:

$$y_{jt} = \theta_j + \theta_t + \beta(\text{INPRES}_j \times \text{post1972}_t) + (\mathbf{X}'_j \boldsymbol{\theta}_t)' \boldsymbol{\eta} + \varepsilon_{jt}, \quad (1)$$

where y_{jt} denotes the number of Islamic schools built in district j and year $t \in [1960, 1999]$, per 1,000 children in 1971, θ_j and θ_t are corresponding fixed effects, INPRES_j equals SD INPRES schools built from 1973–1978 per 1,000 children in 1971, and post1972_t is a dummy for years after 1972. With $\mathbf{X}'_j \boldsymbol{\theta}_t$, we flexibly account for differential trends by interacting year fixed effects with (i) the INPRES targeting variables (i.e., the district’s 1971 child population, school enrollment and a concurrent water and sanitation program), and (ii) the prevalence in 1959 of Islamic elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary, and boarding schools, each separately. As in Duflo (2001), controlling flexibly for the INPRES targeting variables ensures that Islamic school entry effects are not driven by time-varying correlates of the enrollment levels used to determine program eligibility. The effects we estimate are therefore conditional on initial enrollment and population levels. Standard errors are clustered at the district level.

We also estimate equation (1) using the synthetic differences-in-differences (SDID) approach from Arkhangelsky et al. (2021). The SDID approach reweights and matches pre-INPRES trends in Islamic school construction across high- and low-INPRES exposure districts. This delivers estimates that are more robust than standard difference-in-differences (DID) to violations of parallel trends. For implementation, SDID requires a binary regressor; we set INPRES_j equal to 1 for districts above the 51st percentile in INPRES school construction.¹⁴

Table 2 shows greater entry of Islamic schools in high-INPRES districts: formal *madrassa* at the elementary (column 1), junior secondary (column 2), and senior secondary level (column 3), the informal *pesantren* (column 4) and *diniyah* (column 5), and the total number of Islamic schools of all types (column 6). In the standard DID (panel a), a one standard deviation increase in INPRES schools leads to 0.013 more Islamic schools per district-year and per 1,000 children, i.e., 1.4 additional Islamic school entries in the average district relative to a mean entry of 1.9 Islamic schools per district in 1972. The SDID

¹³While *pesantren* constitute an important part of the response to SD INPRES, their higher level of informality makes them more difficult to study than *madrassa*. Our main data for studying school choice in Section 4 below, *Susenas*, does not record *pesantren* attendance as *pesantren* do not follow the national exams. Nor does the MORA registry clarify the level at which a given *pesantren* organizes its instruction; many, in fact, teach students of all ages under one roof.

¹⁴While SDID uses less INPRES variation, by necessity of this discretization, it offers more compelling “local” comparisons across districts and time periods in which parallel trends are more likely to hold.

specification delivers positive and slightly larger estimates (panel b). This suggests that the increased supply of Islamic schools in high-INPRES districts is not an artifact of diverging pre-trends. Rather, the point estimates in panels (a) and (b) are consistent with a break in trend around the mid-1970s as religious leaders and organizations mobilized in locations with greater public primary school entry.

We provide further evidence of this trend break in Figures 2 and 3, which plot event studies showing the dynamic response to the state’s primary school expansion. Figure 2 allows β in equation (1) to vary by semi-decade in the standard DID, and Figure 3 reports an analogous visualization for SDID. The latter tracks the annual variation in the high-INPRES (in red) and low-INPRES districts (in blue), and the straight lines and black arrow indicate the magnitude of the entry differential in the mid-1980s. Across both approaches, high-INPRES districts experience greater secondary *madrasa* and *pesantren* entry after 1973. A similar pattern holds for elementary *madrasa*. The village-based results below offer a clearer, more granular window into the entry response at this grade level.

Robustness. Several robustness checks are consistent with a causal interpretation of the Islamic sector response. First, in addition to the SDID results being robust to violations of parallel trends, the Roth and Rambachan (2022) procedure provides further suggestive evidence consistent with the visual impression from Figure 2 of a lack of pre-trends in the standard DID (see Appendix Figure A.1).¹⁵ Second, the patterns are unlikely to be an artifact of survivor bias in the 2019 registry of Islamic schools. Appendix Table A.3 shows that the increase in Islamic school entry after the 1970s can be seen in historical administrative data (from *Podes* 1980, 1983, 1990, 1993) that is not subject to the attrition inherent to contemporary school registries. Third, we show robustness to interacting year FE with predetermined factors associated with religious schooling historically, including *waqf* endowments in 1960, the Muslim population share in 1972, Islamic party support in the 1955-57 elections, historical Arab immigration, Islamist insurgency activities in the 1950s, and the intensity of Transmigration resettlement through the 1980s.¹⁶ In this set of controls we also include an indicator for districts involved in an experimental compulsory schooling program after 1957 (see Section 4.1). Some of these factors shaped the Islamic sector response to SD INPRES as we show later, but Appendix Table A.2 shows that the core results in Table 2 are robust to allowing for differential trends with respect to these controls.

¹⁵Roth and Rambachan (2022) propose a method that formalizes the motivation behind pre-trends tests, namely that the counterfactual post-intervention trends cannot depart too much from the pre-trends. Their method circumvents the need for pre-trends testing, instead allowing for uncertainty over the magnitude of the true trends in the pre-period. In Appendix Figure A.1, we report confidence sets that answer how much the post-INPRES trends in Islamic school entry would need to differ from the pre-trends in order to nullify the findings. We compute these confidence sets allowing this “how much” factor $\bar{m}$ to vary from 0 to 1.5 and find that for most outcomes the results break down at rather large values of $\bar{m}$, suggesting that our findings are unlikely to be driven by non-parallel trends. To invalidate the aggregate Islamic school entry results, we would need to allow for a post-INPRES violation of parallel trends that is more than 1.5 times larger than the maximal pre-treatment violation. We emphasize, however, that this test and the visual evidence of null pre-trends coefficients in Figure 2 are merely suggestive as both are formally valid for binary treatments and not continuous ones like the INPRES measure we use here.

¹⁶In the Indonesian context, support for Islamic parties correlates strongly with support for greater religious influence in various public domains including education (see Pepinsky et al., 2018). We draw on data compiled by Bazzi et al. (2020) to measure (i) Islamic political party support in the 1955 and 1957 legislative elections, (ii) ethnic Arab populations in the colonial era, and (iii) the presence of the Darul Islam movement, an insurgency aimed at establishing an Islamic state in Indonesia. We measure Transmigration prevalence using data from (Bazzi et al., 2016, 2019). Although these settlements had uniform, exclusively public schooling systems in the early years, their Inner Island populations were disproportionately Muslim relative to the more religiously diverse Outer Islands regions in which they were established.

Village Level. The district-level estimates capture Islamic sector entry effects averaged across several local education markets. We now use a village-level specification to identify more local entry dynamics:

$$y_{vt} = \theta_v + \theta_t + \sum_{\tau=-5}^{10} \gamma_{\tau} \text{INPRES}_{v,t-\tau} + (\mathbf{X}'_v \boldsymbol{\theta}_t) \boldsymbol{\eta} + \varepsilon_{vt}, \quad (2)$$

where y_{vt} denotes Islamic schools built in village v in year t with corresponding FE, θ_v and θ_t . $\text{INPRES}_{v,t-\tau}$ is a binary indicator for each year until/after the first SD INPRES is built from 1973–78 (entry is normalized to $\tau = 0$). The $\mathbf{X}'_v \boldsymbol{\theta}_t$ vector includes the numbers of public and Islamic schools in village v in 1959, each interacted with year FE. Standard errors are clustered at the village level.

We estimate equation (2) on a balanced panel from 1960 to 1999 using the [Borusyak et al. \(2024\)](#) estimator.¹⁷ In robustness checks, we use a shorter panel from 1968–83. By allowing for arbitrary effect heterogeneity, this estimator addresses potential biases in staggered entry DID designs, which might arise here if, for example, the Islamic sector responded more effectively later in the 1970s once the government’s secularization push through SD INPRES became more widely understood.

This specification provides more granular evidence of strategic Islamic school entry, but does so by eschewing the policy variation across districts and instead relying on differences in the timing of SD INPRES entry. While much of the timing variation is driven by idiosyncratic factors such as local administrative frictions and availability of funds, some of it may be endogenous with respect to potential religious schooling. Reassuringly, the [Borusyak et al. \(2024\)](#) estimator shows no evidence suggestive of pre-trends for Islamic (Figure 4) or non-Islamic private schools (Appendix Figure A.4). In Appendix Table A.4, we show that the *timing* of SD INPRES entry at the village level between 1973–78 is uncorrelated with the presence of Islamic schools in 1972, as well as predetermined agricultural productivity (potential crop yields) and natural advantages (e.g., elevation, distance to the coast).

Figure 4 provides further evidence of a dynamic Islamic sector response that varies across types and levels of schooling. The construction of an INPRES school is followed by a jump in Islamic school entry (panel a), which is driven in the short run by primary *madrassa* (MI) entering at twice the baseline annual rate (panel b). The latter persists for six years, after which MI entry rates revert back to baseline. Thus, Islamic providers competed head-on with new public primary schools in their communities.¹⁸ Meanwhile, Islamic junior secondary school (MTs) entry peaks around years 6–9 after SD INPRES construction (panel c). As INPRES students graduate (alongside those from newly built MI), MTs entered in order to capture demand for continued education. In panel (d), we find smaller responses at the senior secondary (MA) level, perhaps in part because these schools tend to serve multiple villages.

In addition to greater entry of formal *madrassa*, SD INPRES construction is also associated with greater entry of informal Islamic schools. The effects are stronger for Qur’anic study schools (panel f) than for Islamic boarding schools (panel e). Entry of the former ratchets upwards around the time when SD INPRES students would have acquired sufficient reading skills to engage with the Qur’an (2nd or

¹⁷This procedure (i) estimates fixed effects using untreated observations (i.e., villages with no SD INPRES entry from 1973 to 1978), then (ii) imputes untreated outcomes for treated observations, and finally (iii) computes estimates of γ_{τ} parameters as weighted averages over the differences between actual and imputed outcomes.

¹⁸The immediate Islamic elementary response, within a year of SD INPRES being built, is consistent with the very short time required to establish an Islamic school at that level through the use of informal financing (see Appendix C for examples).

3rd grade). This is consistent with the common practice of attending SD INPRES in the morning and Qur’anic study school, *madrasa diniyah* (MD), in the afternoon. Moreover, at the local level, formal elementary MI and informal MD appear to be substitutes: the post-INPRES entry dynamics are mirror images across panels (a) and (f), and 86% of the MD entering from 1973–78 were built in villages without any MI construction, while 91% of the entering MI were built in villages without any MD construction.

Panels (c) and (d) of Table 2 summarize the graphical evidence in a single DID estimate consistent with the district-level results in panels (a) and (b). These village-level results hold using the standard DID (panel c) and Borusyak et al. (2024) estimators (panel d), which suggests limited bias due to time-varying heterogeneity (see also Appendix Figure A.3).¹⁹ Overall, these findings suggest that SD INPRES did not displace Islamic schools but instead increased options for both secular and religious education.

Islamic and Other School Entry. While other types of schools may have also entered in response to SD INPRES, the Islamic sector’s response appears distinctive and confrontational. In Appendix Figure A.2, we consider the district-level entry of private non-Islamic schools, of which there are 41,969 as of 2019. Some of these secular schools enter in response to SD INPRES, but their entry responses appear relatively muted at each instruction level.²⁰ Appendix Figure A.4 provides further, village-level evidence of distinctive entry by primary *madrasa* when compared to private non-Islamic primary schools.

Alongside these dynamics at the primary level, more secular junior secondary schools entered markets with greater SD INPRES construction (Appendix Figure A.5). Combined with our earlier findings, these results suggest efforts by the three sectors—Islamic, private non-Islamic, and state—to meet the rising demand for secondary education. Yet, such efforts largely took place in distinct markets, avoiding the local confrontation seen at the primary level: among villages with any SD INPRES construction, the correlation between subsequent construction of Islamic and public (private) junior secondary schools is 0.04 (0.05). Put simply, there was enough excess demand for junior secondary education that the Islamic sector could avoid head-on competition with the state while still growing its aggregate market share.

3.2 Financing New Islamic Schools

How did the Islamic education sector finance its expansion in the aftermath of SD INPRES? For decades, private Muslim actors, both individuals and organizations, funded schools through *waqf* endowments (Bazzi et al., 2020). In addition to endowing as *waqf* the land on which Islamic schools are built, Muslims in rural areas also endow agricultural land and regularly offer harvest revenue to support religious infrastructure (see Section 2.1). Given this common practice, large swings in commodity prices might affect charitable giving. Fortuitously for Islamic leaders, the initial year of SD INPRES coincided with a large spike in the price of rice, Indonesia’s main agricultural commodity.²¹

¹⁹Appendix Table A.5 shows that the Borusyak et al. (2024) estimates are robust to removing time-varying controls, using a shorter panel window spanning 1968–83, and clustering standard errors by district.

²⁰Moreover, the downward pre-trend in panel (a) might suggest that SD INPRES did crowd out non-Islamic primary schools built before the program. This stands in stark contrast with the corresponding estimates in Figure 2: unlike their secular counterparts, Islamic schools proved resilient against the mass entry of public elementary schools.

²¹Prices increased by 280% from 1972 to 1973 and remained unprecedentedly high for the remaining years of the 1970s (see Appendix Figure A.6). Although many rice farmers are net consumers, larger, net producers are those most likely to con-

Using granular village-level data, we show that these informal financing mechanisms may have helped catalyze and sustain the Islamic sector response to SD INPRES. In Table 3, we examine the role of *waqf* endowments as well as exposure to the 1970s rice price boom in supporting Islamic school construction. We estimate these heterogeneous effects using the following balanced panel specification:

$$y_{vt} = \theta_v + \theta_t + \beta_0 \text{INPRES}_{vt} + \beta_1 (\text{INPRES}_{vt} \times \text{rice yield}_{v0}) + \beta_2 (\text{INPRES}_{vt} \times \text{waqf}_{v0}) + (\mathbf{X}'_v \boldsymbol{\theta}_t) \boldsymbol{\eta} + \varepsilon_{vt}, \quad (3)$$

where the *rice yield* funding proxy is based on a time-invariant and standardized measure from FAO-GAEZ and averages over dry and wet rice yields (we construct a dummy equal to 1 if a village has a value of potential rice yields above the sample median), and the *waqf* funding proxy is constructed using data on land endowed in mosques as of 1960 (we construct a dummy equal to 1 if the district has *waqf* endowments above the sample median). The specification is otherwise based on the DID analogue of equation (2), with additional controls, in $\mathbf{X}'_v \boldsymbol{\theta}_t$, for year FE interacted with the two funding proxies.

Table 3 reveals stronger entry responses in villages with greater capacity to fund new Islamic schools. Villages with more *waqf* endowments and higher potential rice yield exhibit a greater likelihood of building an Islamic school of all types and at all levels after the construction of SD INPRES. Overall, these results point to a mobilization mechanism whereby local institutions and resources enabled the Islamic sector to compete with the rapidly expanding state sector.

Robustness and Validation Checks. Additional evidence supports our interpretation of these results. First, the heterogeneous response to public primary school entry does not similarly arise in other periods (1960–68 or 1990–98, Appendix Table A.7) when the relationship between Islamic leaders and the regime was less conflictual *and* when rice prices were lower.²² Second, during the SD INPRES era, entry of non-Islamic private schools did not vary systematically with *waqf* prevalence (Appendix Table A.8). Third, Islamic school entry is not primarily driven by large-NGO-affiliated schools (Appendix Table A.9).

In further support of a local financing channel, we find that informal private contributions may have sustained the Islamic sector response to SD INPRES. Appendix Table A.10 reports higher rates of informal taxation to finance educational infrastructure in villages with Islamic schools built in this period. Such rates do not vary and may, in fact, be lower in villages with public schools built at that time. These associations, based on survey data from 2007–13 (see Olken and Singhal, 2011), are consistent with religious schools relying more heavily on private funding and faith-based charitable giving.

Finally, we find suggestive evidence of resource constraints as informally-financed religious schools crowd out other local public goods. Appendix Table A.10 reveals crowd-out of non-religious goods: in villages with Islamic schools, informal taxation to finance schools (and houses of worship) crowds out informal financing of roads and bridges. Appendix Table A.11 reveals crowd-out of other religious goods: in districts with greater SD INPRES construction, Islamic schools comprise a larger share of total

tribute large sums to fund local religious infrastructure and to endow *waqf* properties. Even small net consumers may have contributed to such infrastructure: we encountered several Islamic school founders describe a so-called “cash *waqf*” wherein villagers offer very small contributions out of agricultural income to support local Islamic schools (see Appendix C).

²²The rice-price-shock mechanism is also broadly consistent with rice-growing areas having a more collectivistic culture that enables faster community-based mobilization in response to shocks (Geertz, 1963; Talhelm et al., 2014).

waqf-endowed land as of 2019, and this comes at the expense of mosques.²³ In sum, SD INPRES induced greater mobilization of *waqf* resources to support an expansion of religious schooling, and, in prioritizing education, the Muslim community partially crowded out other *waqf*-based religious public goods.

3.3 Curriculum Differentiation and Formalization

In response to SD INPRES, Islamic schools could have shifted their curriculum or pedagogy in a more secular direction to attract a larger student base. This section shows how the Islamic education sector adjusted along these margins. We first study curriculum changes using an online registry of schools, called *Sistem Informasi Aplikasi Pendidikan* (SIAP), which provides hour-by-hour timetables for *madrasa* during the 2018–19 school year. While the data cover nearly 20% of *madrasa*, secular schools do not report to SIAP, in large part because those schools offer much more standardized curricula, leaving little scope for marketable differentiation.²⁴ The timetables provide a unique window into the learning environment at Islamic schools. Our main interest lies in time allocated to (i) Islamic subjects, including Arabic language and literature, (ii) *Pancasila* and civic education, and (iii) Indonesian language and literature.

Curriculum Responses. We estimate an unbalanced panel analogue to equation (1) where each outcome is a mean curriculum subject share among all entering *madrasas*. Since we only observe a single cross-section of curriculum timetables, we construct a retrospective panel of mean curriculum subject shares at the district×grade×year level, using information on each school’s year of establishment. The estimates identify differences in long-run curriculum between *madrasa* built before and after SD INPRES, across markets with varying INPRES intensity. Table 4 shows that Islamic schools created in high-INPRES districts after 1972 provide, if anything, more religious content. Each additional SD INPRES is associated with a 1.2 percentage point (p.p.) increase in the share of classroom time devoted to religious content among newly created Islamic schools (panel a, column 1), with increases of 1.3 p.p. and 2.4 p.p. at the primary and junior secondary levels, respectively (panel a, columns 2–3). These are sizable effects relative to curriculum among schools built before 1972, e.g., the 2.4 p.p. increase equals 9% of the mean and 82% of the standard deviation. We find similar effect sizes for Arabic instruction (panel b). Appendix Table A.12 (panels a and b) shows that these patterns hold for total instruction hours.

The estimates in panels (c) and (d), albeit noisy, suggest that some of the increase in religious content at the junior secondary level comes at the expense of *Pancasila*/civic education and national language (*Bahasa Indonesia*) instruction. At the primary level, there is limited scope to observe substitution with these two subjects given the generic curriculum structure wherein these are subsumed under a catch-all “thematic” subject matter. In our data, very few Islamic primary schools report dedicated hours for *Pancasila*/civic education, *Bahasa Indonesia*, mathematics or science on their timetables. At that level,

²³ These results are based on administrative data from the Indonesian *Waqf* Board, which provides detailed breakdown of the type of infrastructure but does not provide reliable measures of the time at which the *waqf* was founded.

²⁴ These data provide a long-run snapshot of curriculum for schools entering in different years. A school’s curriculum is closely attached to its ideology, which arguably has persistent features tied to the identity of founders. Given the legacy of conservative schools’ opposition to state oversight, we suspect that the *madrasa* included in SIAP are those with less Islamic content. This could work against our findings if such selective reporting varies with INPRES intensity. Yet, we find no evidence of differential reporting: *madrasa* created after 1972 in high-INPRES districts are no more or less likely to report to SIAP.

the increase in Islamic and Arabic instruction may partly be accommodated by an increase in instruction hours (Appendix Table A.12, panels a–b). At the senior secondary level, we find different patterns where SD INPRES is associated with a reduction, albeit statistically insignificant, in Islamic content and an increase in both Arabic and *Pancasila* instruction (panels a–c, column 4). This hints at a possible specialization of senior secondary Islamic schools aimed at capturing junior secondary graduates intent on continuing to non-Islamic universities and who did not acquire the necessary skills in testable subjects until reaching that level. Appendix Table A.13 supports this line of reasoning: the slight decrease in the Islamic subject share at that level helps accommodate instruction of mathematics and humanities (panels a and c, column 4), in addition to Arabic.

Although curricular outcomes are only measured in 2019, these findings nevertheless suggest that, over the long run, Islamic schools did not converge to secular school curricula in response to state competition. If anything, the results are consistent with Islamic schools introducing more religious curricula in order to attract students from more conservative families as options for secular education become more pervasive locally. Appendix Table A.14 supports this interpretation by showing, especially at the secondary level, a stronger curriculum differentiation response in markets with greater historical support for conservative Islam (proxied by Islamic political party vote shares in the 1950s).

Using the curriculum data and school names, we further construct a proxy for the religious ideology of all schools in the country. School names reflect a key branding decision by school founders and provide a window into ideology in the contemporaneous historical era. We first identify 100 common words or acronyms appearing in the names of Islamic schools.²⁵ We then regress total hours of Islamic content or the curriculum share dedicated to Islamic subjects on a vector of dummy variables indicating whether the school name contains a given word, interacted with the instruction level and province dummies. To avoid overfitting, we select a subset of these covariates using a ridge shrinkage estimator. We then predict the ideology of schools for which we do not observe actual curriculum using the penalized coefficients estimated in the previous step, combined with information on school names. Finally, we estimate a specification analogous to that in Table 4, now using the standardized religious ideology of all entering *madrasas* in a given district–year as the dependent variable. Appendix Table A.15 shows that Islamic schools entering high-INPRES districts after the program onset have a more religious ideology, based on this approach. While suggestive, these findings further indicate that the new *madrasa* built after SD INPRES did not offer a more secular educational approach to compete with state schools.

Formalization of the Islamic Sector. The above analysis focuses on *madrasa*, the main type of Islamic schools in operation today. However, *pesantren* also played a major role within the Islamic school system historically. After SD INPRES, these informal schools continued to enter systematically (see Section 3.1), while the newly built *madrasa diniyah* offered extracurricular religious instruction in communities where young children were now spending most of their day in secular public schools.

While informal religious education expanded in high-INPRES markets, formal religious education

²⁵This list includes Arabic words such as *nur* ('light'), *ulum* ('knowledge' or 'science'), *huda* ('guidance' or 'right path'), *maarif* ('knowledge'), *hidaya* ('guide' or 'leader'), *falah* ('success') and *salam* ('peace') as well as Islamic concepts such as *islam* or *islamiyah*, *salam*, *sunnah*, *umma*, *mujahidin*, and *salafiyah*.

expanded even faster. Figure 5 shows that these markets saw growing influence of *madrasa* at the expense of the more informal *pesantren* and *diniyah*. Among entrants, the share of *madrasa* was relatively lower in high-INPRES districts during the height of the program in the late 1970s. By the early 1980s, however, formal *madrasa* entry outpaced non-Islamic school entry. The reverse is true for informal Islamic schools. Appendix Table A.6 corroborates this set of results: *madrasa* entry increased as a share of all new school entry (column 1), while the entry of informal Islamic schools (*pesantren* and *diniyah*) declined as a share of all new schools (column 2) and all new Islamic schools (column 3).

Unlike *pesantren*, the formal *madrasa* are organized along the same primary-to-secondary trajectory as state schools. This ensures progression across grade levels and allows for switching between public and religious schools, providing option value to moderate but still religious parents.²⁶ The ability of the newly entering *madrasa* to introduce more religious curriculum than incumbent *madrasa* ensured that the gradual formalization of the Islamic sector did not come at the expense of religious instruction.

4 Religious School Choice

This section explores dynamics of religious school choice, offering an individual-level perspective on the changes in education markets uncovered in Section 3. First, we show that changes in Islamic school choice closely align with the Islamic sector entry response to SD INPRES. Second, we identify heterogeneous effects across genders and across regions that are consistent with Islamic schools providing a differentiated educational option after SD INPRES.

4.1 Religious Schooling Response to SD INPRES

Survey Data on Schooling. We measure Islamic school attendance and other information on education status using six rounds of the National Socioeconomic Survey (*Susenas*) from 2012–18. These surveys report breakdowns of *madrasa* and secular education as well as information on birthplace, which is needed to identify childhood exposure to SD INPRES. *Susenas* does not record informal (*pesantren*) Islamic education, and it only identifies school type for the final level of attainment and hence misses switching across Islamic and secular schools. We revisit this in robustness checks below, where we also use the Indonesia Family Life Survey (IFLS) for validation. The IFLS is a longitudinal survey spanning 1993 to 2014, which, unlike *Susenas*, records schooling type for each year of education. However, the IFLS has limited geographic scope, which complicates analyses of policies with spatial variation like SD INPRES.

Estimating Exposure Effects. We identify effects of SD INPRES on religious school choice as follows:

$$y_{ijt} = \theta_j + \theta_t + \beta(\text{INPRES}_j \times \text{young}_{it}) + (\mathbf{X}'_j \boldsymbol{\theta}_t)' \boldsymbol{\eta} + \varepsilon_{ijt}, \quad (4)$$

where y_{ijt} is a schooling outcome for individual i born in district j in year t . We examine Islamic school exposure irrespective of one's final education level and, separately, conditional on completing a given

²⁶Hefner (2009) provides examples of *pesantren* leaders that built formal *madrasa* on *pesantren* grounds in order to attract families who were averse to the informal, religion-centric *pesantren* curriculum but open to the *madrasa* alternative to state schools.

level. $INPRES_j$ is measured as either (i) SD INPRES schools constructed per 1,000 children from 1973–1978, in the DID estimation, or (ii) an indicator for districts above the 51st percentile in SD INPRES construction, in the SDID; $young_{it} = 1$ for individuals aged 2–6 in 1974 and zero otherwise; θ_j and θ_t are district and cohort FE, respectively; and $\mathbf{X}'_j\theta_t$ includes cohort FE interacted with the same set of variables as in equation (1) with baseline Islamic schools measured as of 1957, the birth year of the oldest comparison cohort. As in equation (1), we control for the INPRES targeting variables to ensure that correlates of the initial enrollment levels used to determine SD INPRES intensity are not driving the effects of the program on religious school choice. Like Duflo (2001), we compare individuals aged 2–6 (i.e., those born between 1968–72) with those already of school age, but no older than 17 when the program began. In the DID estimation, we exclude partially exposed cohorts, aged 7–11 in 1974, as in Duflo (2001). In SDID, these cohorts are used in the construction of the synthetic control group.²⁷

Table 5 reports the effects of SD INPRES on *madrassa* attendance. Panels (a) and (b) report DID and SDID estimates, respectively. The outcomes equal one if the respondent’s highest level of education is Islamic primary (column 1), junior secondary (column 2), senior secondary (column 3), or any Islamic (column 4). SD INPRES pulled students away from primary *madrassa* and pushed them towards non-Islamic schools. Among cohorts aged 2–6 in 1974, one additional SD INPRES reduces the likelihood of Islamic primary by 7% (column 1). At the secondary level, Islamic schools absorbed some of the increased demand for post-primary education (columns 2 and 3). Together, these effects combine to a net increase in exposure to Islamic education: each additional SD INPRES increased the likelihood of attending an Islamic school by roughly 5% (column 4).²⁸

Time-Varying Effects. These exposure effects are even clearer when looking across cohorts. Figure 6 reports cohort-specific Islamic school completion rates separately for high- and low-INPRES districts, and Figure 7 reports cohort-specific β from equation (4). In both cases, we see SD INPRES leading to a shift away from Islamic primary schools and towards Islamic secondary schools, both in the short (panels a, c, and e) and medium run (panels b, d, and f).²⁹ The effects grow steadily for younger cohorts, including those born during and shortly after the SD INPRES era. This is consistent with later cohorts having greater opportunity to attend newly built Islamic schools as the religious sector, especially at the secondary level, expanded significantly in the early 1980s in high-INPRES areas (see Figures 2–4).

Islamic School Graduation Shares. One concern with the outcomes in Table 5 is that the likelihood of completing an Islamic education could be increasing simply because SD INPRES increases overall education. Thus, in Table 6, we look at Islamic schooling conditional on graduating with a degree at the given level of education (primary, junior secondary, and senior secondary). These measures capture the share of Islamic graduation at each level and help clarify that the results in Table 5 are not driven solely by the INPRES-induced increase in overall education. Table 6 shows that the same patterns hold in this

²⁷Our core sample comprises 275 districts based on boundaries at the time of SD INPRES in the 1970s. Duflo (2001) reports 283 districts based on boundaries in 1995, by which time four districts from the 1970s had split in two.

²⁸These results are driven in part by those moving from public elementary to Islamic junior secondary. *Susenas* allows us to observe a subset of these transitions, namely for those that attend but do not graduate from Islamic junior secondary. Appendix Table A.17 shows that indeed SD INPRES increased the likelihood of such transitions.

²⁹The corresponding graphical evidence for the SDID estimates can be found in Appendix Figure A.7.

conditional specification: students shift out of Islamic schools at the elementary level (column 1) and into junior secondary Islamic schools (column 2). The effects on senior secondary Islamic are weaker (column 3), perhaps because these schools are less differentiated on Islamic curriculum (Table 4). The net effect across instruction levels is an increase in the likelihood of graduating from an Islamic school (column 4). Here, too, the standard DID (panel a) and synthetic DID (panel b) agree, with few exceptions.

Accounting for Selection. SD INPRES increased total years of education *and* Islamic schooling.³⁰ Tables 5 and 6 suggest that these outcomes are jointly determined: greater schooling brings more opportunities for exposure to Islamic schools. Framed as a selection issue, only those continuing to secondary education have the potential to attend Islamic secondary schools. If those continuing on are more religious, this could introduce bias. Panels (c) and (d) of Table 6 address this type of selection bias.

We consider parametric (Heckman, 1976) and semiparametric (Newey, 2009) selection-correction procedures. First, we estimate the likelihood of completing a given level of education. Second, we estimate the likelihood of completing Islamic education for those reaching that level. The second-step includes selection-correction terms. In the Heckman (1976) case, this is the inverse Mills ratio. In the Newey (2009) case, this is a series approximation to the true correction term; in practice, we use a cubic polynomial in first-step probabilities based on flexible covariates (i.e., taking quintiles in each continuous regressor, interacted with cohort FE).³¹ Key to both strategies is the exclusion from the second stage of at least one variable correlated with grade completion but otherwise unrelated to Islamic school choice. For this purpose, we rely on measures of exposure to a pilot compulsory schooling program in the 1960s.³² This program shifted demand for education just prior to SD INPRES and was not systematically related to predetermined Islamic schooling or correlates thereof (see Appendix Table A.20).

The selection-adjusted estimates in panels (c) and (d) of Table 6 are in line with the unadjusted estimates in panel (a). Some of the estimates are larger (and noisier), but overall the magnitudes and signs are consistent, especially at the elementary and junior secondary level. Together, the selection-adjusted estimates approximately identify a local average treatment effect of INPRES exposure on Islamic schooling among compliers, namely children who received additional education as a result of the policy. For those induced to reach elementary school, this meant less exposure to Islamic education (column 1), but for those induced to go beyond elementary, SD INPRES increased the likelihood of attending Islamic junior secondary (column 2). This is again intuitive and in line with the newly built Islamic secondary schools absorbing excess demand for continued education among new primary graduates.

³⁰Column 1 of Table A.22 shows that each SD INPRES increased years of schooling by 0.13 years. The male-specific estimate of 0.18 in panel (b) of Table 7 lies between the range of estimates in Duflo (2001)—0.12 to 0.19—based on the 1995 *Supas* data. Appendix A.5 additionally shows that in markets where elementary *madrassa* also entered, the two types of schools acted as substitutes in increasing total years of education.

³¹We select the polynomial order based on consistency results in Newey (2009), which imply an upper bound of 3 on the order of the approximating power series in a sample with effective size of 275 (i.e., the level of policy variation). We conduct inference with a percentile-*t* bootstrap shown to work well with two-step selection estimators (Yamagata, 2006).

³²This compulsory primary education (*Wajib belajar*) pilot program, which applied to children aged 8 to 14, was rolled out in 35 pilot districts in the late 1950s and early 1960s (Sarumpaet, 1963). We identified in government reports from 1958–1960 the 35 affected districts. In the first step of the selection-correction procedure, we include interactions of cohort FE with the extensive and intensive margin (total teachers and schools allocated) of the program in respondents’ district of birth. Appendix Tables A.2 and A.19 show that our results on Islamic school entry and choice, respectively, are robust to these controls as well.

Robustness Checks. We further address remaining identification concerns. First, we account for district-specific factors correlated with SD INPRES intensity and latent potential for Islamic schooling. Recall that cohort FE interacted with Islamic schools in 1957 are already in our baseline specification. In Appendix Table A.19, we also include interactions of cohort FE with proxies for the potential strength of the Islamic sector prior to SD INPRES (see the discussion of Appendix Table A.2). With a few minor exceptions, the key finding of increased Islamic school choice in high-INPRES regions remains. In this table, we additionally report results obtained after adding fifteen cohorts to the exposure group, covering one generation of students born between 1968–87 who were exposed to the Islamic sector response to SD INPRES. As expected, we find slightly larger effects on Islamic school choice among these cohorts.

Second, we show that SD INPRES was not systematically allocated towards districts with differential trends in Islamic schooling. Figure 7, described above, shows little indication of systematic pre-trends in Islamic school attainment and, moreover, exhibits an intuitive *S*-shaped exposure curve across cohorts. Thus, although the state built more SD INPRES in districts with more Islamic schools, they did not target areas where Islamic school choice was already growing faster.

Finally, we address measurement error in Islamic school choice reported in *Susenas*. Appendix Table A.16 shows that exposure to Islamic schooling is considerably higher in other sources.³³ There are three reasons why the *Susenas* data may lead to underestimates of SD INPRES effects on Islamic education. First, *Susenas* indicates whether the highest graduation level and/or the final year of education took place in a *madrasa*, thus missing Islamic school attendance earlier in one’s educational life. Second, *Susenas* does not allow respondents to indicate *pesantren* education. Third, many students attend state schools in the morning and *madrasa* in the afternoon while, for enumeration purposes, only the former is official. Given that informal Islamic schools also entered to compete with SD INPRES (see Section 3.1), our estimates likely provide a lower bound on the total effect of SD INPRES on Islamic school choice.³⁴

As a validation exercise, in Appendix Table A.18, we estimate the effects of SD INPRES in the IFLS. Unlike *Susenas*, the IFLS reports the type of education completed at every level. SD INPRES decreased the likelihood and total years of Islamic elementary (columns 1 and 3, respectively) and increased the likelihood and total years of Islamic junior secondary (columns 2 and 4, respectively). Although noisy given the coverage limitations of IFLS, these results mirror those in *Susenas*.

4.2 Heterogeneous Preferences and Religious Education

Heterogeneous preferences may play an important role in shaping religious school entry and individual school choice. We characterize here two important sources of heterogeneity in gender norms and religious ideology, both of which speak to salient cultural divides in many societies.

Gender. Parents from more conservative families may have been reluctant to send their daughters to secular INPRES schools, while Islamic schools, which adopt more conservative approaches to gender

³³In the IFLS, Islamic education rates range from 11% in primary to 23% in junior secondary (20% overall). Administrative enrollment records for 2019 show rates ranging from 13% in primary to 23% in junior secondary (21% overall).

³⁴The strong *pesantren* entry results in Section 3.1 make it unlikely that the growth in *madrasa* enrollment arose through an absolute decline in *pesantren*. Although individual-level *pesantren* attendance data does not exist, we can show, using registry data, that *pesantren* entering in response to SD INPRES enroll more students in the long run (see Appendix Figure A.8).

relations at school, could have been viewed as an acceptable alternative.³⁵ These gender norms became especially salient when the Suharto regime banned the Islamic veil (*hijab*) in public schools in the early 1980s, in a context of heightened tensions around veiling following the Iranian Revolution. A 1982 MEC regulation standardized the use of school uniforms, which amounted to a crackdown on veiling (see Jo, 2020; Shofia, 2020, and the illustration in Appendix Figure A.9). School-aged women who veiled thus faced a choice between transferring to a *madrasa* or dropping out of school.

In Table 7, we examine school choice outcomes separately by gender. We also introduce in our sample fifteen student cohorts born between 1973 and 1987, and we distinguish between women who would have completed their primary education before the veil ban, namely the cohorts born between 1968–72, and women who would still have been enrolled in school by the time the ban came into force, namely those born after 1973. Thus, our exposed cohorts in this table include boys and girls allocated to two groups: those born between 1968–72 and those between 1973–87. We interact our previous measure of SD INPRES exposure with a gender dummy and with two indicators for either age group. This provides a test of heterogeneous effects by gender, separately for women who were exposed or not exposed to the veil ban. Note that the effects of SD INPRES on boys’ outcomes may also differ across those two age groups: the later cohorts from 1973–87 were exposed not only to the initial public school expansion but also to subsequent responses by the Islamic sector, which unfolded over several years.

The results in Table 7 are intuitive. First, SD INPRES-exposed boys of all cohorts are less likely to complete Islamic elementary (column 2), more likely to complete Islamic secondary (column 3), and more likely to complete any Islamic schooling overall (column 4). However, this effect is much more pronounced when we consider cohorts born sufficiently late to have benefited from the increased Islamic school entry: the point estimate for cohorts born 1973–87 is more than twice larger than that for cohorts born 1968–72. This aligns with the visual impression from the cross-cohort dynamics in Figures 6 and 7 (b, d, f). Second, there is evidence of heterogeneity by gender, but the extent of this heterogeneity varies between women who were affected by the veil ban and those who were not. Female students born between 1968–72 are relatively more likely than male students from those cohorts to complete Islamic schooling at all levels, but these point estimates are not statistically significant (third row, columns 2–4). However, female students born between 1973–87 are significantly more likely to complete secondary Islamic schooling (column 3) and Islamic schooling at any level (column 4). For these cohorts, the additional, differential effect of gender is roughly two thirds of the base effect we measure for boys.

Thus, Islamic schools may have helped address diverse religious preferences and gender norms. These effects are most pronounced after the regime crackdown on Islamic veiling: it is among the cohorts of women exposed to the ban that we find evidence that Islamic schools, which adopt more conservative approaches to gender relations at school, provided an acceptable alternative to secular INPRES schools.

Baseline Ideology. Although 90% Muslim, Indonesia has long been home to diverse views on the role of religion in public life. Beyond gender norms, elections offer another lens on this diversity as we show

³⁵An early insight into this possibility comes from Oey-Gardiner (1991), who reports strongly female-biased sex ratios in religious schools and male-biased ratios in public schools, especially at the primary level, in administrative data from 1984–5. She interprets this difference as evidence of more conservative parental preferences for schooling girls than boys. We find a similar sex ratio differential among SD-INPRES-exposed cohorts in our *Susenas* data.

here, again using the 1950s vote share for Islamic parties to proxy for conservative ideology.

In Appendix Table A.21, we find stronger Islamic school choice responses to SD INPRES in districts with deeper historical support for Islamic politics. In districts with one standard deviation higher support for Islamic parties, exposed cohorts are nearly 50% more likely to attend Islamic schools (column 5). This heterogeneity materializes at the secondary level (columns 3–4), which is where we identified the strongest average responses. While Islamic school choice is more affected in these areas, total years of schooling is not (column 1). This is consistent with the conceptual framework in Appendix B: Islamic school construction and curriculum differentiation ensured that religiously conservative parents would have greater scope to educate their children in religious schools as mass public schooling expanded.

5 Mass Schooling and Nation Building

Like most mass schooling reforms, Indonesia's entailed ideological objectives. This section shows that many of these objectives were not fully attained. First, greater SD INPRES construction was associated with reduced electoral support for the Suharto regime in the short run, and this persisted as younger cohorts entered voting age. Second, these market-level electoral shifts went hand-in-hand with individual-level shifts in religiosity and ideology, among exposed cohorts and their children. Together, these results suggest that the equilibrium Islamic sector response (Section 3) and families' schooling decisions (Section 4) may have ultimately worked against the regime's secular nation-building agenda.

5.1 Electoral Impacts of SD INPRES

We explore the political impact of SD INPRES using legislative election results during Suharto's reign (1971, 1977, 1982, 1987, 1992) and after his demise (1999, 2004, 2009).³⁶ Only three parties were allowed to compete in elections after 1971: Suharto's *Golkar* party, the Muslim umbrella United Development Party (PPP),³⁷ and the nationalist Indonesian Democratic Party (PDI). As we discuss below, these elections were not fully free and fair. *Golkar* obtained 70% of the vote on average across all elections from 1977–92, while the PPP was the main opposition with 21% of the vote. After 1999, both parties waned in influence as others entered across the ideological spectrum.

We estimate the time-varying relationship between SD INPRES intensity and the *Golkar* vote share in a district×election panel. The 1971 round was the only Suharto-era election before school construction ensued and the first with *Golkar* candidates. As such, we cannot fully account for possible pre-trends in *Golkar* support. However, we can allow for differential trends based on vote shares for key party blocs in 1955 and 1957, the last pre-Suharto elections. Note that cohorts educated in INPRES schools (aged less than 6 in 1974) would have first voted in 1987, but INPRES could also have affected elections in 1977 and 1982 (e.g., through the increased presence of public schools in one's community).

³⁶The final election of the Suharto era was in 1997, but we could not obtain district-level records from this round.

³⁷In the 1971 election, we capture the Islamic vote share by combining all four Islamic parties that were subsumed in 1973 by regime decree under the PPP: *Nahdatul Ulama* (NU), the Muslim Party of Indonesia (Parmusi), the Islamic Association Party of Indonesia (PSII) and the Islamic Education Movement (Perti). NU was the second-highest ranked party in that election (after *Golkar*) with 18% of the vote.

Figure 8 shows that SD INPRES did not increase electoral support for the regime. Panel (a) shows a marked decline in *Golkar* vote shares from 1971 to 1977 in high-INPRES districts: each additional INPRES school per 1,000 children is associated with a 2.5 percentage point (p.p.) decline in the *Golkar* vote share (relative to the mean of 65% in 1971). This effect persists thereafter and is unchanged when including interactions of election-year FE with the vote share for Communist and Islamic parties in the 1950s elections (panel b). This provides suggestive evidence against pre-trends insofar as support for *Golkar* in 1971 may be correlated with later school construction and with voting behavior in the 1950s.

The Islamic opposition captured some of the declining support for *Golkar*. We see this for the PPP vote share in absolute terms (panels c and d) and relative to *Golkar* (panels e and f). One explanation is that the Islamic education sector, and its political backers in the PPP, pushed back against secularization, which was most salient in districts with greater SD INPRES construction. The decline in *Golkar* support as early as 1977 is consistent with this pushback.³⁸ If instead these electoral shifts had been slower to materialize, it would have been difficult to rule out the alternative explanation that INPRES created a more educated and politically conscious citizenry that was simply opposed to the regime.

An important caveat to these results is the reliability of the electoral data from elections held between 1971 and 1992. Appendix Figure A.11 shows the distributions of the total number of votes cast, total *Golkar* votes, and the *Golkar* vote share by district in 1977 and 1982. While there are historical accounts of election tampering and voter intimidation in Suharto-era elections (King, 1992; Liddle, 1978a,b), the relevant concern for our analysis is whether voter fraud was correlated with SD INPRES intensity. To examine this, we construct indicators of suspicious support for *Golkar* and vote tallies. We define districts as having experienced suspicious support for *Golkar* if the *Golkar* vote share is either more than one or more than 1.5 standard deviation above the sample mean in a given election year. We analogously define two measures of suspiciously high vote tallies. Reassuringly, the estimates in Appendix Tables A.25 and A.26 suggest that districts with greater SD INPRES construction between 1973–78 did not experience suspiciously higher (or lower) support for *Golkar* or vote tallies in elections held after the program.

5.2 National and Religious Identity

The electoral impacts of SD INPRES were accompanied by deeper cultural changes. Table 8 reports cohort-level exposure effects on dimensions of secular national (panel a) and religious (panel b) identity.

We first examine a standard marker of attachment to the national identity in multilingual countries: the use of the national language at home. This is distinct from speaking ability. In the 2010 Census, nearly 90% of Indonesians can speak *Bahasa Indonesia*, but only 20% use it as the main language at home, reflecting greater attachment to national as opposed to ethnic or religious identity (see Bazzi et al., 2019, for validation). Column 1 reports null effects of SD INPRES using the exposed versus control cohort

³⁸These patterns resonate with insights from the leading scholar of Indonesian elections. Liddle (1978a) suggests that the Islamic school system played an important role in shaping electoral outcomes, especially after the 1971 election when “*Golkar* had had a strongly anti-Islamic image.” During the 1970s, both *Golkar* and the Islamic opposition parties fought for the hearts of minds of religious voters by mobilizing Islamic school teachers, who had long been a mainstay of political Islam in Indonesia, dating to the important role they played in the 1950s elections. The backlash interpretation of Figure 8 is consistent with stronger counter-mobilization to *Golkar* in high-INPRES districts where the affront to religious schools was more salient.

design (equation 4). Behind this null lies a religious divide: 15% of Muslims prefer using Indonesian at home compared to 28% of non-Muslims.³⁹ Among Muslims, exposed cohorts are less likely to use *Bahasa* Indonesia at home (column 2), while non-Muslims exhibit a smaller response (column 3). These weak, and even negative effects are striking given that INPRES schools aimed to promote a single Indonesian identity built around one language. Although SD INPRES increased Indonesian proficiency (Appendix Table A.23, columns 1–3), it did not increase vernacular attachment to the national language.

For those exposed to Islamic education, immersion in *Bahasa* Indonesia (or Indonesian) may have been crowded out by Arabic study. Table 4 showed that schools created in high-INPRES districts after 1972 devote more classroom time to Arabic and less to Indonesian. Table 8 shows that SD INPRES increased Arabic knowledge among exposed cohorts (column 4), driven by those with some Islamic education (two-thirds of whom report Arabic literacy, compared to one-third with secular education).⁴⁰ While SD INPRES increased literacy in the Latin alphabet on which Indonesian is based, it did not do so for other languages besides Arabic (Appendix Table A.23, columns 4–9). This is consistent with the unique role of Arabic among Muslims and the importance of Islamic education in transmitting such knowledge (see Appendix Table A.24 on the strong association of Islamic education with Arabic literacy).

These language shifts align closely with broader changes in piety. In Table 8 (panel b), we look at Islamic practices using a nationally-representative survey conducted in 2008 by Pepinsky et al. (2018). These include praying 5 times a day (column 1), fasting during Ramadan (column 2), reading the Qur'an (column 3), attending Friday prayer (column 4), performing non-obligatory *Sunna* prayers (column 5), joining prayer groups known as *pengajian* (column 6), and paying *zakat* (column 7). Respondents' practices vary widely, e.g., 62% report praying 5 times daily, while only 25% always regularly read the Qur'an. We find positive exposure effects across most measures, and each additional INPRES school is associated with a sizable 19% increase in a mean index across all practices (column 8).

Together, the results in Table 8 suggest that SD INPRES bolstered religious identity, which may have come at the expense of secular national identity.⁴¹ For those attending Islamic schools, this could have occurred through learning Arabic and Islamic thought. For those attending state schools, this could have occurred through greater exposure to Islamic-educated peers in one's community or engagement with the Islamic sector outside formal schooling (e.g., through parental inputs or attendance of *madrasa diniyah* or mosque-based youth groups). We explore some of these mechanisms in the next section.

³⁹Using this same data, we find a precise zero effect of SD INPRES on the likelihood of being Muslim: -0.0003 (0.0011).

⁴⁰We switch between sample splitting on religion and on religious schooling across outcomes in panel (a) because *Susenas* does not record religion, and the 2010 Population Census does not report type of schooling.

⁴¹Appendix Table A.27 shows that SD INPRES had a null effect on support for *Pancasila* (column 1), the secular national ideology advanced through state schools. Although exposure to mass schooling did not deepen support for *Pancasila*, nor did it increase support for conservative Islamist ideology as an alternative. We use several measures of support for Islamist ideology from Pepinsky et al. (2018). Columns 2 and 3 indicate whether individuals report strong or very strong support for Islamic principles to govern public life. The index in column 4 combines these two questions with two others about subjective support for *sharia* law. Column 5 averages across six objective dimensions of *sharia*: corporal punishment for crime, prohibition of interest, mandatory *hijab*, legalized polygamy, stoning for adultery, and death for apostates. Across measures, we find null, albeit also imprecise, effects of SD INPRES on exposed cohorts of Muslim citizens.

5.3 Intergenerational Transmission of Religious Values

Finally, we highlight the role of intergenerational cultural transmission in shaping the legacy of mass schooling. Two generations after Indonesia’s landmark policy, one in five students remained enrolled in *madrasa* or *pesantren*. This suggests that the shifts in religious values set in motion by SD INPRES were likely passed on to future generations.

Table 9 examines household-based mechanisms for such transmission, focusing on whether those directly exposed to SD INPRES changed their familial investments in religion as adults. For example, parents might engage in greater religious socialization at home for fear that children would lose religious values in a fast-secularizing society. We explore two main pathways for vertical religious transmission, which, in theory, could either complement or substitute for religious school choice.

First, men exposed to SD INPRES as kids were more likely to marry women educated in Islamic schools (column 1). This could be explained by assortative matching among the religiously educated. It could also be a consequence of the larger effect of SD INPRES on *madrasa* education for girls (Section 4.2). The effects are null for women’s marital choice (column 2), perhaps because they face greater constraints (see Rubio, 2014, on arranged marriage). Regardless, the greater presence of religiously educated people in the marriage market could have increased religious transmission to children.

The remaining columns of Table 9 elaborate how such transmission flowed within the household. We proxy for engagement with Islam using the Arabic literacy of parents and children measured in *Susenas*. We saw in Section 5.2 that SD INPRES increased Arabic literacy. In columns 3–4, our dependent variable is a dummy for a father, a mother, and their child all being literate in Arabic. Both paternal and maternal exposure to SD INPRES increase the likelihood that the entire household is literate in Arabic, which is consistent with assortative mating and greater religious transmission. In columns 5–6, we restrict attention to Arabic-literate parents and show that children formally educated in non-Islamic schools are more likely to be literate in Arabic if the parents were exposed to SD INPRES. Although endogenous, this sample restriction provides further suggestive evidence of religious transmission outside the Islamic school system, which might occur, for example, through instruction at home or extracurricular education at the local mosque or *madrasa diniyah*. Overall, parents exposed to mass public schooling ensured, through socialization choices, that their children maintain a strong religious identity.

6 Conclusion

One of the most ambitious educational interventions ever implemented, SD INPRES pursued developmental as well as ideological objectives. A large literature documents the policy’s effects on human capital. In contrast, we provide the first comprehensive investigation of its impacts on education markets. As much as the policy itself, competitive responses from the Islamic school system shaped education markets for years to come and also plausibly counteracted the advance of secular nation building.

Our findings point to some surprising and unintended consequences of mass public schooling in the presence of competing religious institutions. The policy failed to crowd out religious schools, as the Muslim community raised funds to build new schools in response to the state’s investments. We

find suggestive evidence that over the long run, these new Islamic schools offered more rather than less religious curriculum, and became more formal. These responses ensured that children raised in the Muslim faith continued to gain exposure to formal Islamic teachings. Such responses were particularly beneficial to more conservative families and their daughters, whose education levels may have increased in part due to Islamic schools being a substitute, especially after a ban on Islamic veiling came into force in secular public schools. This allowed many Indonesian families to reconcile the challenges of “modernization” with a strong continued adherence to religious values.

Our paper raises important questions for countries striving to find the optimal mix between centralizing and outsourcing public goods provision. On the one hand, Islamic schools helped the central state cater to heterogeneous preferences for different types of schooling and meet the excess demand for secondary schooling coming from universal primary education. This is reminiscent of the “division of responsibility for education” in diverse societies conceptualized by [James \(1987a,b\)](#). At the same time, the robust response by local Muslim communities illustrates the persistent challenges of centralized policies in settings with limited state capacity. These challenges were already salient during our period of interest in Indonesia: as a leading education expert noted, “the existence of two parallel and relatively independent [school] systems . . . poses very real problems for the reform and modernization of education” ([Beeby, 1979](#), pp. 34-35). Similar challenges abound in the uneasy coexistence between the state and informal authorities in many developing countries where dual systems of governance persist.

The challenges associated with such dual systems are especially pronounced in conservative societies where religion provides a strong alternative source of political legitimacy to that of the state. Religious institutions are often perceived as more compatible with local preferences than institutions bequeathed by colonization or Western influence. Organizations that derive legitimacy from strict adherence to religious faith actively compete with central authorities by providing alternative forms of justice, taxation, and service provision. Our paper offers a new perspective on how these competitive frictions unfold, and what they imply for state- and nation-building efforts in diverse societies.

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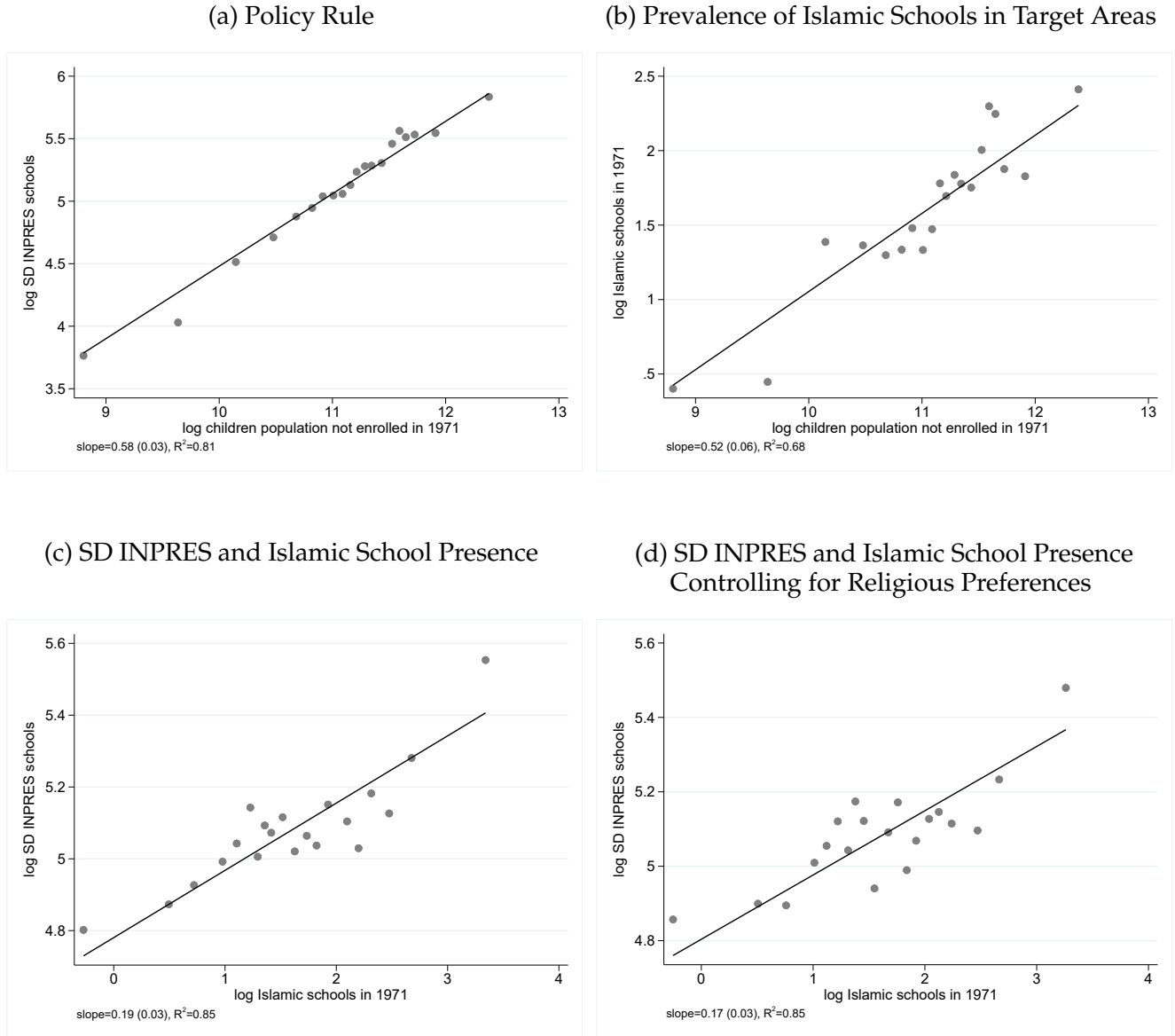
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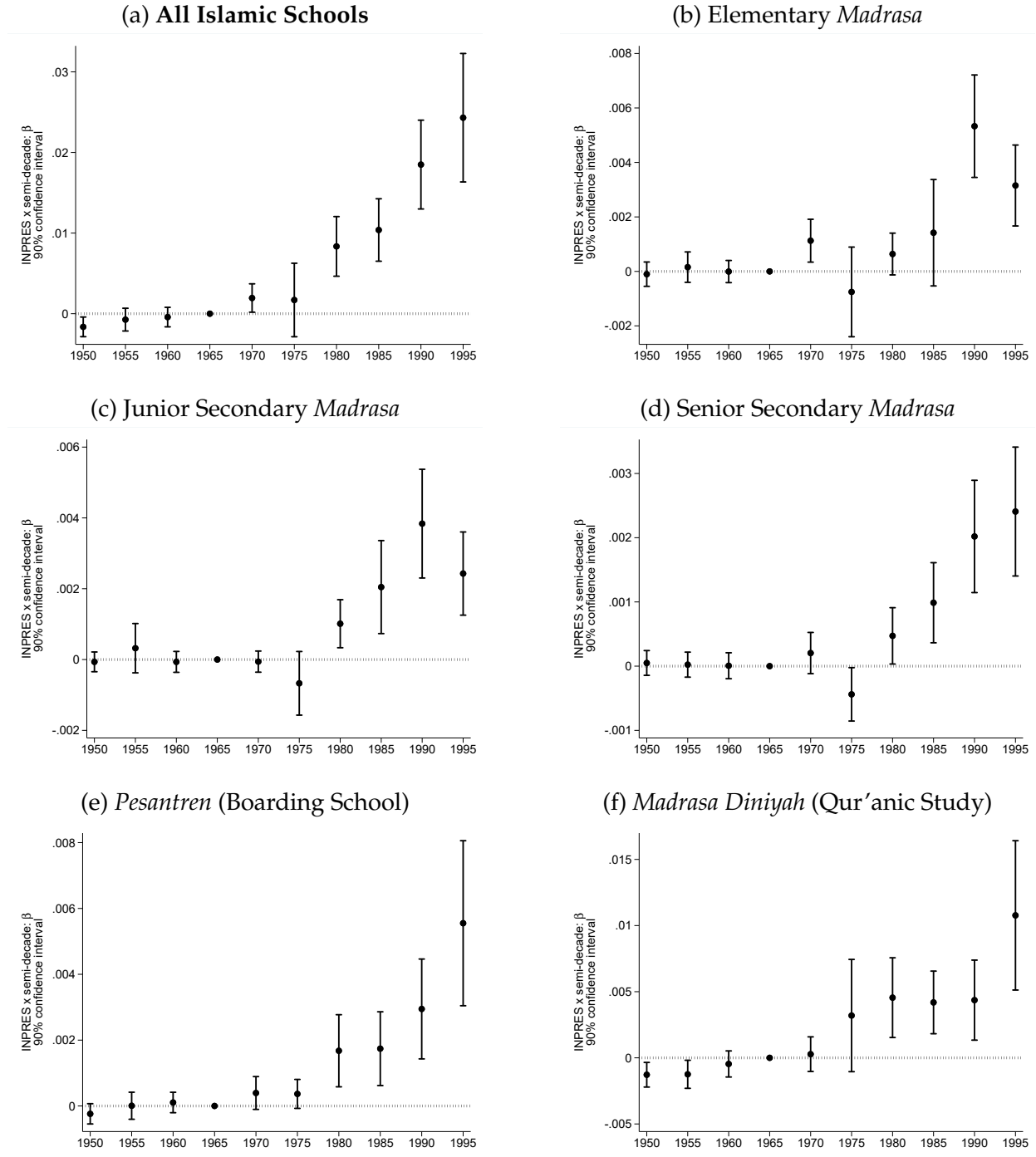
Figures

Figure 1: Targeting of INPRES School Construction



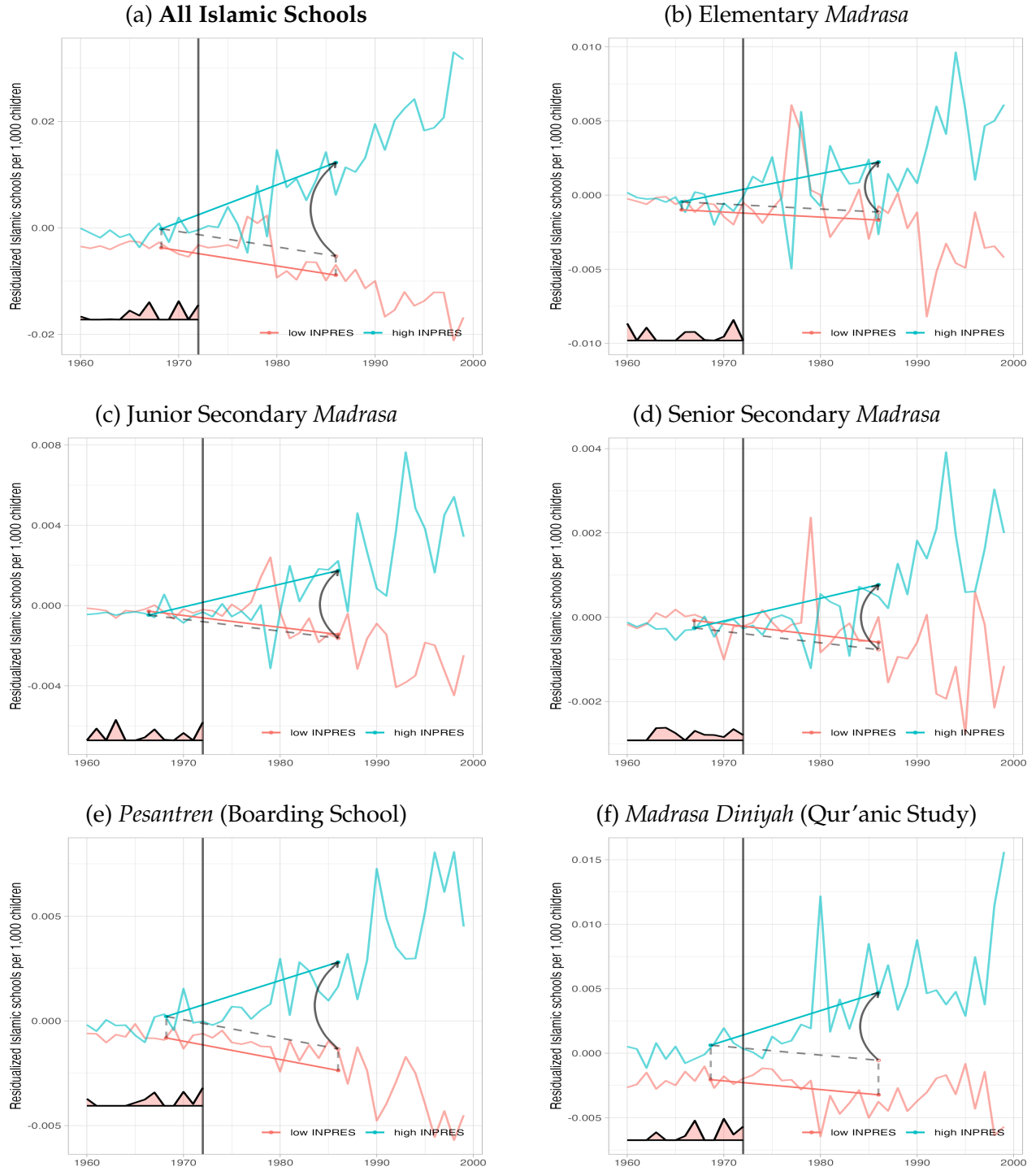
Notes: This figure displays district-level bincscatter plots between SD INPRES school construction, the population of children not enrolled in school in 1971, and the baseline presence of Islamic schools (elementary *madrasa* and *pesantren*) measured in 1971. Panel (a) illustrates the government's policy rule: SD INPRES school construction is proportional to the population of children not enrolled in 1971. In Panel (b), we regress the log of Islamic schools in 1971 on the log population of children not enrolled in 1971. In Panel (c), we regress log SD INPRES school construction on the log of Islamic schools in 1971, controlling for the population of children not enrolled and province dummies. In Panel (d), we estimate the same regression controlling for the vote share of Islamic parties in the 1955 and 1957 legislative elections, the last before the Suharto era.

Figure 2: INPRES Intensity and Entry of Islamic Schools
New schools per 1,000 children



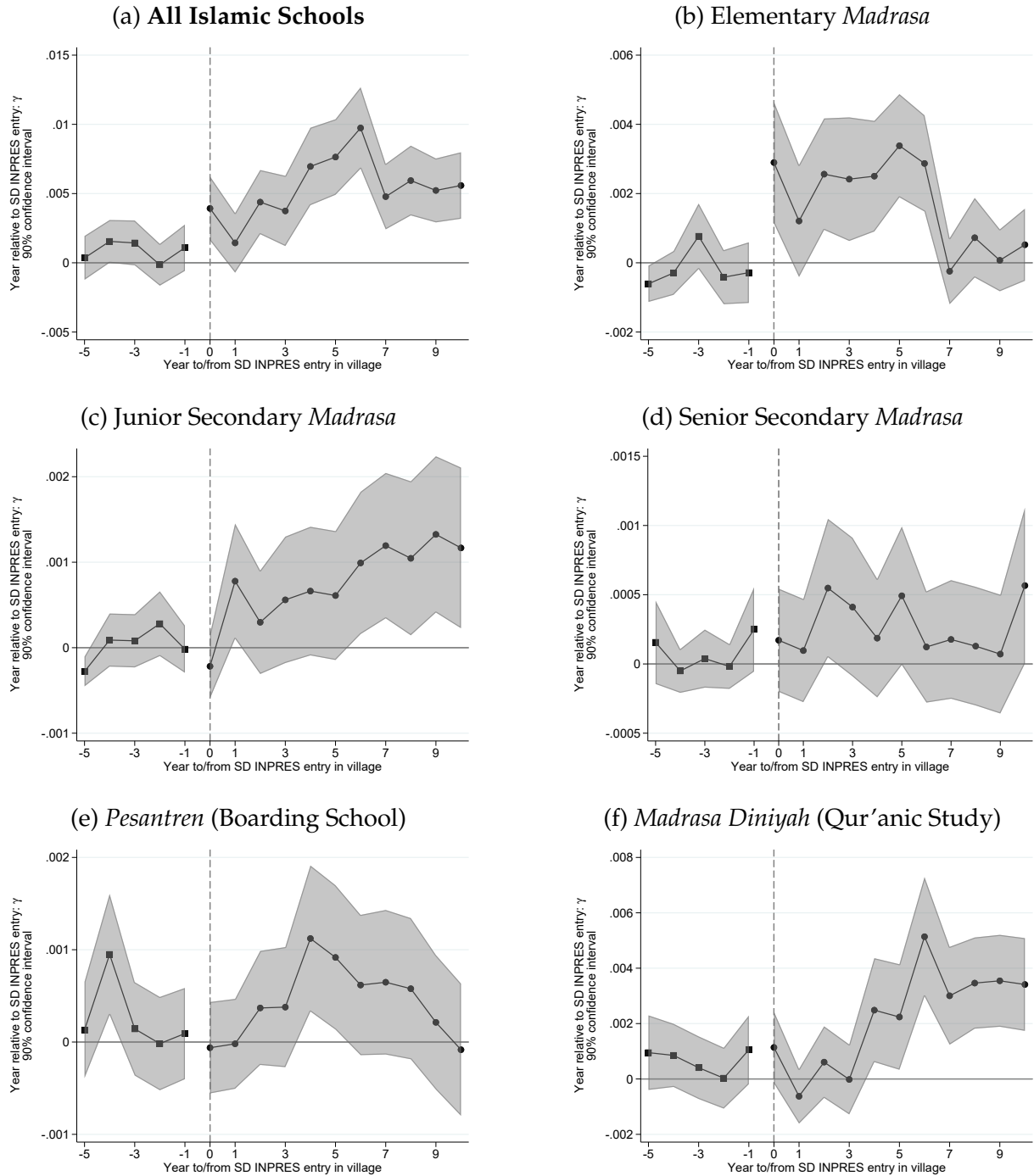
Notes: This figure reports semi-decade-specific estimates of β in equation (1) on a balanced district-year panel. INPRES intensity is defined as the number of SD INPRES schools constructed from 1973–78 per 1,000 children in 1971. The dependent variable measures the total number of Islamic schools (panel a), elementary *madrassa* (b), junior secondary *madrassa* (c), senior secondary *madrassa* (d), *pesantren* (Islamic boarding schools across all levels) (e), and *madrassa diniyah* (Qur'anic afternoon schools) (f) established by semi-decade and by district per 1,000 children in 1971. The 1965–69 period is the reference period given district fixed effects. The dots correspond to the period-specific β , and the bars to 90% confidence intervals with standard errors clustered by district, of which there are 275. All specifications include district fixed effects and year fixed effects interacted with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, district-level exposure to the water and sanitation program, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrassa* in 1949, and the number of *pesantren* in 1949.

Figure 3: Islamic School Entry: Synthetic Difference-in-Differences



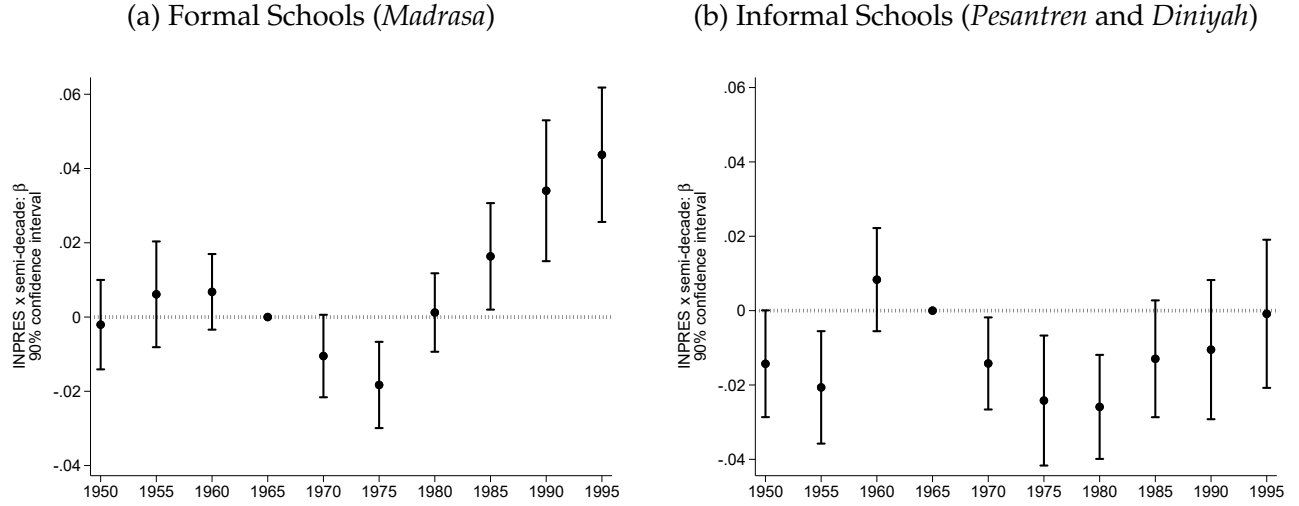
Notes: This figure reports synthetic difference-in-differences (SDID) estimates of the effect of SD INPRES on Islamic school entry at the district-year level from 1960–99. Each figure shows trends in entry of Islamic schools over time for districts above the 51st percentile of SD INPRES intensity (“high INPRES” in blue) and the relevant weighted average of comparison districts below the 51st percentile (“low INPRES” in red), with the weights used to average pre-INPRES time periods at the bottom of each panel (in red). The dashed diagonal line indicates the counterfactual parallel trend, and the arrow indicates the estimated effect. Following [Arkhangelsky et al. \(2021\)](#), we apply the SDID estimator to the residuals from equation (1): $y_{jt}^{res} = y_{jt} - (\mathbf{X}_j' \boldsymbol{\theta}_t)' \hat{\boldsymbol{\eta}} - \hat{\theta}_j - \hat{\theta}_t$, where y_{it} is the total number of Islamic schools (panel a), elementary *madrassa* (b), junior secondary *madrassa* (c), senior secondary *madrassa* (d), *pesantren* (e), and *madrassa diniyah* (f) built per district-year and per 1,000 children in 1971; $\mathbf{X}_j' \boldsymbol{\theta}_t$ includes year fixed effects interacted with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrassa*, and the number of *pesantren* in 1959.

Figure 4: Islamic School Entry at the Village Level



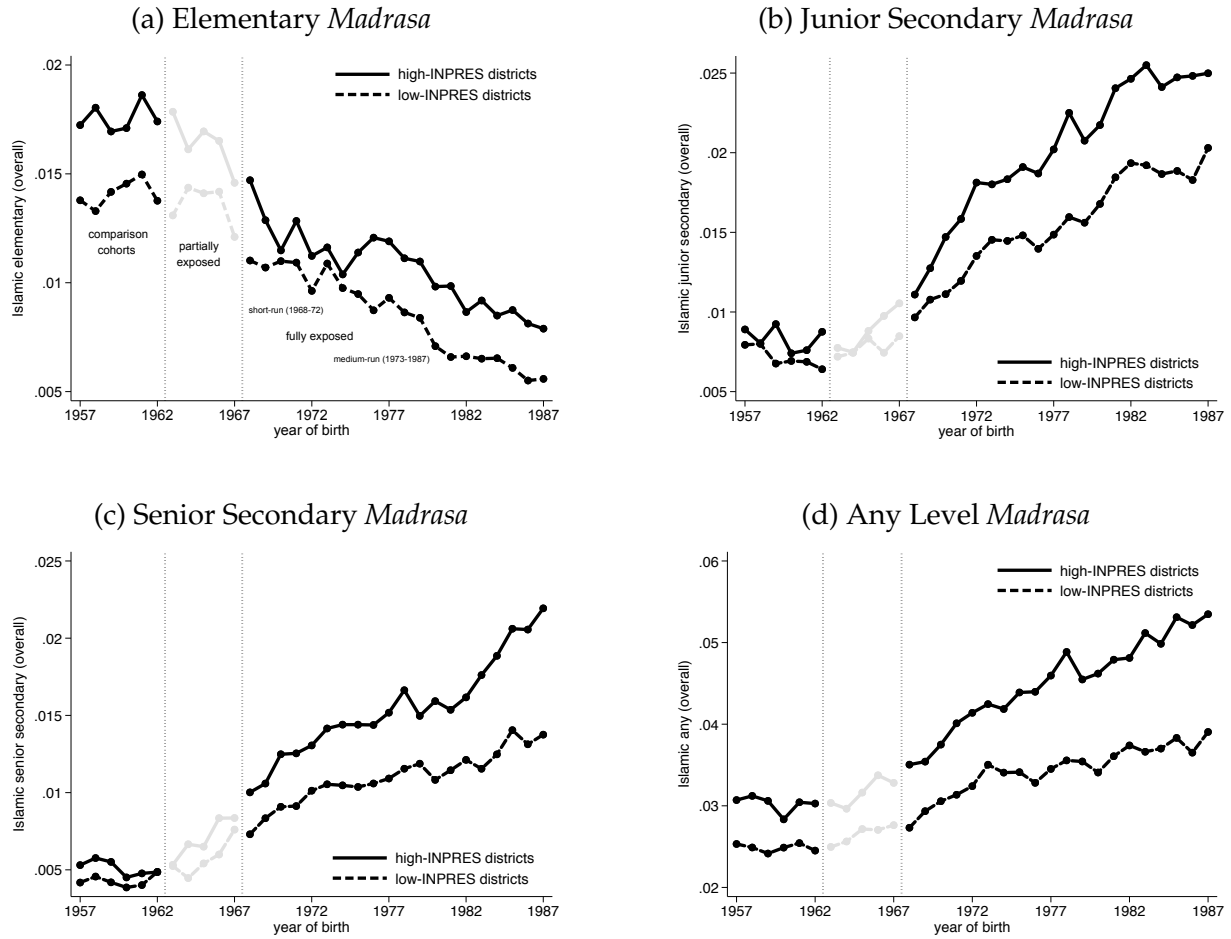
Notes: This figure reports estimates of γ in equation (2) using the robust and efficient estimator from [Borusyak et al. \(2024\)](#) and a balanced panel of villages spanning 1960–99. The dependent variable measures the total number of Islamic schools (panel a), elementary *madrassa* (b), junior secondary *madrassa* (c), senior secondary *madrassa* (d), *pesantren* (e), and *madrassa diniyah* (f) established per village–year. All specifications include village fixed effects and year fixed effects interacted with the number of secular elementary schools and Islamic schools in the village as of 1959. The gray shading corresponds to 90% confidence intervals with standard errors clustered by village.

**Figure 5: Entry of Formal and Informal Islamic Schools
As a Share of All School Entry**



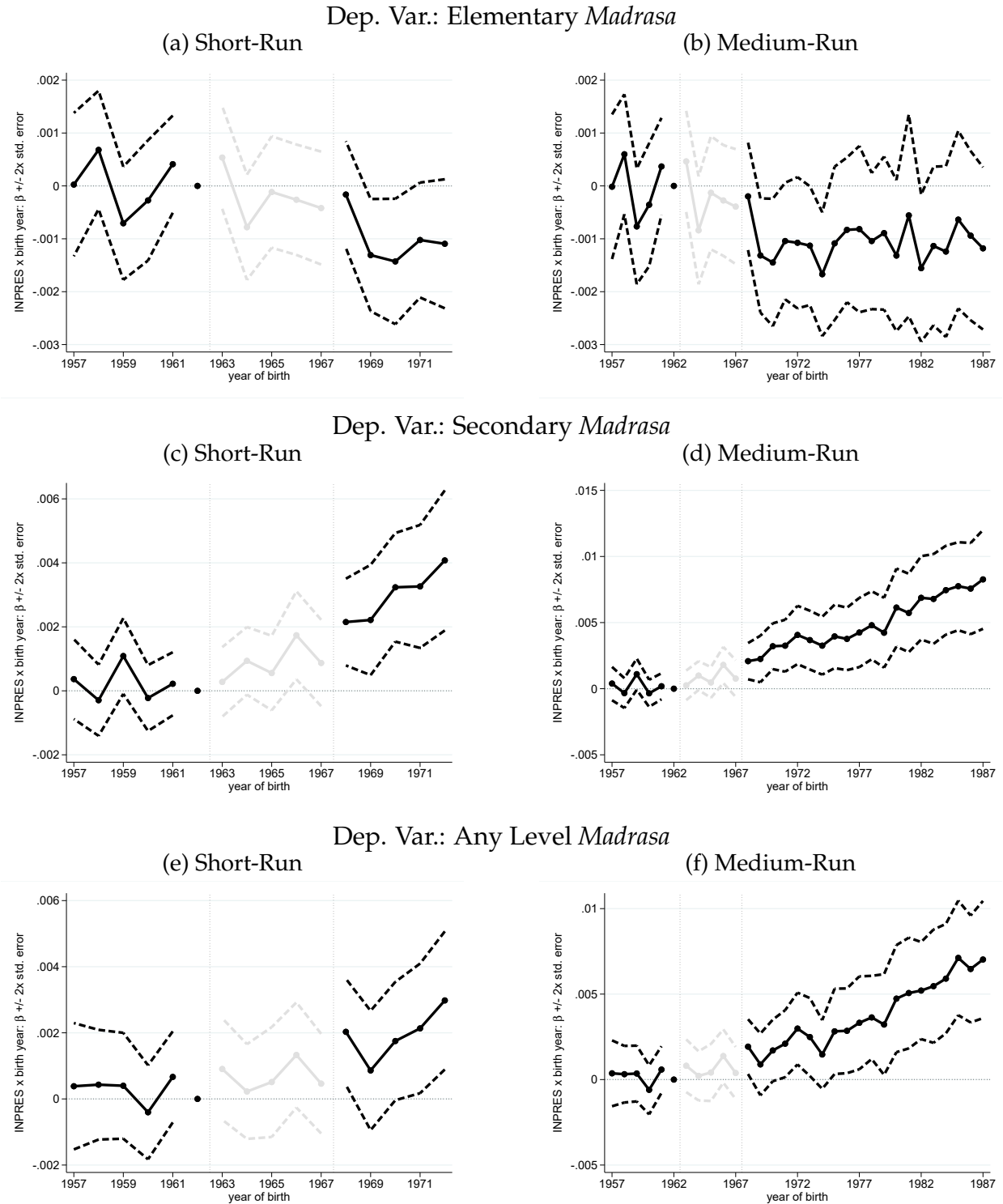
Notes: This figure reports semi-decade-specific estimates of β in equation (1). The dependent variable measures: (a) *madrasa* at all instruction levels built per district-year as a fraction for all formal schools (including secular public, private, and Islamic schools), and (b) *pesantren* and *madrasa diniyah* built per district-year as a fraction of all schools (including formal and informal schools). As in Figure 2, the 1965–69 period is the reference period given district fixed effects. The dots correspond to the period-specific β , and the bars to 90% confidence intervals with standard errors clustered by district. All specifications include district fixed effects and year fixed effects interacted with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, district-level exposure to the water and sanitation program, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa* in 1949, and the number of *pesantren* in 1949.

Figure 6: INPRES Exposure and Islamic Schooling – Raw Summary



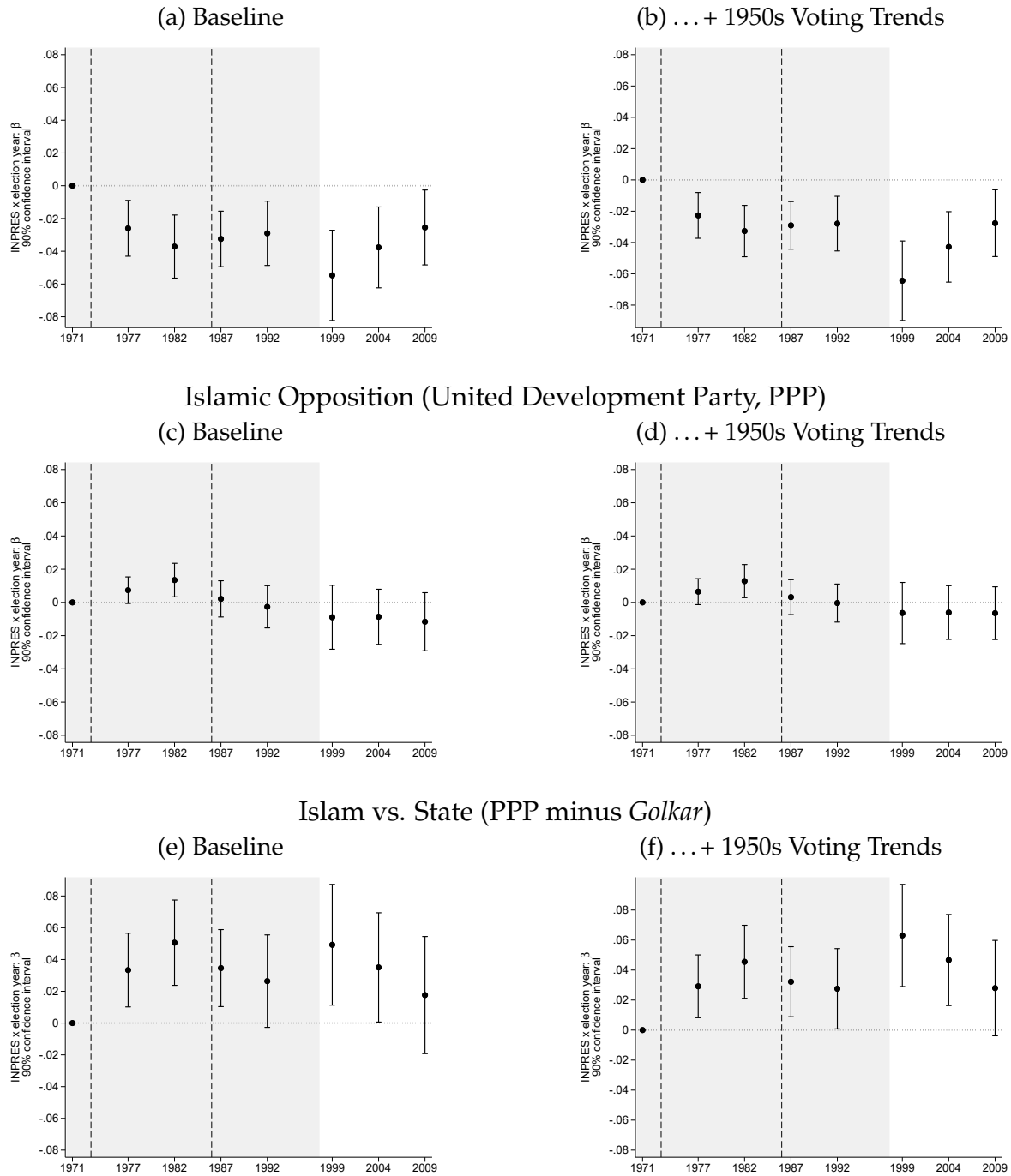
Notes: This figure reports mean Islamic school completion rates over time for districts with above-median (high) and below-median (low) INPRES intensity from 1973–78. INPRES intensity is defined as the number of SD INPRES schools constructed from 1973–78 per 1,000 children in 1971. The rates are computed for cohorts from 1957 to 1987, pooling across annual *Susenas* data from 2012 to 2018, and they indicate whether the final level of education is (a) elementary *madrasa*, (b) junior secondary *madrasa*, (c) senior secondary *madrasa*, and (d) any level *madrasa*. The outcomes are the same as those in Table 5. The cohorts born before 1963 would have fully completed primary schooling before SD INPRES was rolled out in 1973. The cohorts born from 1968 onwards would have been fully exposed to SD INPRES given that they would have been no more than 6 years old just prior to school construction ensuing. The cohorts born from 1963 to 1967 (greyed out) correspond to the partially-exposed cohorts. See Section 4 for further discussion of these distinctions across cohorts.

Figure 7: INPRES Exposure and Islamic Schooling – Estimated Effects by Cohort



Notes: This figure reports age-specific estimates of β in equation (4). INPRES intensity is defined as the number of SD INPRES schools constructed from 1973-78 per 1,000 children in 1971. The dependent variable in panels (a) and (b) is an indicator equal to one if the individual's final year of schooling was completed in an Islamic elementary school. Panels (c) and (d) are for an Islamic secondary school, and panels (e) and (f) for any Islamic school. Panels (a), (c), and (e) correspond to the original cohort specification: fully-exposed born 1968–1972 (black), partially-exposed born 1963–1967 (gray), and unexposed born 1957–1962 (black). Panels (b), (d), and (f) expand exposed cohorts to 1987. The 1962 cohort serves as the reference age, given age fixed effects, in both the short- and long-run specifications. All specifications include survey year $\times$ district of birth dummies and year of birth with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, district-level exposure to the water and sanitation program, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa* in 1957, and the number of *pesantren* in 1957. The dashed lines correspond to 90% confidence intervals with standard errors clustered by district of birth.

Figure 8: Electoral Impacts of SD INPRES
State Regime (*Golkar*, Suharto's Party)



Notes: This figure reports legislative-election-year-specific estimates and 90% confidence intervals around β in equation (1) on a balanced district-election-year panel. INPRES intensity is defined as the number of SD INPRES schools constructed from 1973–78 per 1,000 children in 1971. The dependent variable measures vote shares for *Golkar*, the party of Suharto and the New Order regime (panels a–b), the Islamic opposition party/ies (panels c–d), and the difference in vote shares between the two (panel d–e). All specifications include district fixed effects and election-year fixed effects interacted with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa*, and the number of *pesantren* in 1972. The specifications in panels b, d, and f additionally control for election-year fixed effects interacted with the respective vote shares for Islamic and Communist parties in the 1950s legislative elections. In 1971, there were four Islamic parties that we group together, but from 1973 onward, the regime only allowed a single umbrella Islamic party, the United Development Party or PPP. The 1971 election was the last just prior to SD INPRES and serves as the reference election given district fixed effects. The gray area captures elections conducted under the New Order regime. The elections in 1987 and 1992 are the first in which INPRES-exposed cohorts would have been eligible to vote. The elections from 1999 onward took place after the fall of Suharto when the country democratized and both secular and Islamic parties proliferated.

Tables

Table 1: Correlates of INPRES Elementary School Allocation

	Dependent Variable:				
	log SD INPRES in district				SD INPRES in village
<i>District Level</i>	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
% Islamic primary enrollment, 1967-72	0.039*** (0.009)	0.028*** (0.009)		0.011 (0.008)	
log school-aged children not enrolled, 1971	0.684*** (0.076)		0.622*** (0.080)	0.628*** (0.072)	
% Non-Islamic primary enrollment, 1967-72		-0.016*** (0.005)		-0.014*** (0.005)	
log Islamic primary schools, 1971			0.130*** (0.030)	0.079*** (0.025)	
Islamic parties vote share, 1950s				0.004*** (0.001)	
<i>Village Level</i>					
any public elementary in village, 1971					-0.028** (0.012)
any private non-Islamic elementary in village, 1971					-0.046*** (0.015)
any private Islamic elementary in village, 1971					0.052*** (0.019)
Number of Districts or Villages	275	275	275	275	75,208
Targeting Policy Controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.872	0.812	0.872	0.893	0.030

Notes: This table reports correlates of SD INPRES school construction at the district and village levels. The dependent variable is the log number of INPRES elementary schools constructed at the district level between 1973–78 (columns 1–4) and an indicator for any SD INPRES built in the village during that same period (column 5). All regressions control for the variables that informed the policy rule for INPRES school allocations: province fixed effects, the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, and exposure to the water and sanitation program.

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors in parentheses, clustered by district in column 5.

Table 2: SD INPRES Intensity and Islamic School Entry

	Formal <i>Madrasa</i>			Informal		All
	Elementary (1)	Junior Sec. (2)	Senior Sec. (3)	<i>Pesantren</i> (4)	<i>Diniyah</i> (5)	Islamic (6)
(a) Difference-in-Differences, District Level						
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.0017*** (0.0005)	0.0016*** (0.0004)	0.0009*** (0.0002)	0.0021*** (0.0005)	0.0041** (0.0016)	0.0104*** (0.0023)
(b) Synthetic Difference-in-Differences, District Level						
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.0034*** (0.0013)	0.0034*** (0.0009)	0.0015*** (0.0004)	0.0041*** (0.0011)	0.0053* (0.0027)	0.0176*** (0.0039)
1959 Islamic Schools $\times$ Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
District FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of District–Years	11,000	11,000	11,000	11,000	11,000	11,000
Dep. Var. Mean	0.007	0.005	0.002	0.007	0.018	0.039
R ² (panel a)	0.178	0.169	0.166	0.313	0.565	0.463
(c) Difference-in-Differences, Village Level						
SD INPRES Entry	0.0021*** (0.0003)	0.0018*** (0.0002)	0.0007*** (0.0001)	0.0017*** (0.0003)	0.0043*** (0.0007)	0.0105*** (0.0011)
(d) Robust Difference-in-Differences Estimator, Village Level						
SD INPRES Entry	0.0022*** (0.0002)	0.0017*** (0.0001)	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0013*** (0.0002)	0.0035*** (0.0003)	0.0094*** (0.0005)
1959 Islamic Schools $\times$ Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Village FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Village–Years	3,334,560	3,334,560	3,334,560	3,334,560	3,334,560	3,334,560
Dep. Var. Mean	0.0009	0.0001	0.0001	0.0006	0.0025	0.0041
R ² (panel c)	0.035	0.029	0.029	0.068	0.063	0.075

Notes: The dependent variables are measured as new schools of a given type created per district–year and per 1,000 children in 1971 in panels (a) and (b) and per village–year in panels (c) and (d). Panel (a) reports difference-in-differences estimates of β in equation (1). INPRES refers to SD INPRES schools constructed from 1973–78 per 1,000 children in 1971. Panel (b) reports synthetic DID estimates computed using Arkhangelsky et al. (2021); see the notes to Figure 3 for details on the implementation. In panels (a) and (b), all specifications include district fixed effects and year fixed effects interacted separately with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa* in 1959, and the number of *pesantren* in 1959. Both (a) and (b) are estimated on a panel at the district–year level spanning 1960–99. Panels (c) and (d) report estimates of the average of post-SD-INPRES-entry coefficients τ in equation (2). Panel (c) reports standard difference-in-differences estimates and panel (d) reports estimates computed using the robust imputation method from Borusyak et al. (2024). SD INPRES Entry is a binary indicator equal to one in the first year of public primary school construction from 1973–78 and remains one in all years thereafter. All specifications include village fixed effects and year fixed effects interacted separately with the number of secular elementary schools and Islamic schools in the village as of 1959.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors are clustered by district in panel (a), and using the cluster bootstrap described in Algorithm 2 of Arkhangelsky et al. (2021) in panel (b). Robust standard errors are clustered by village in panels (c) and (d).

Table 3: Funding of Islamic School Entry, Village Level

	Formal <i>Madrassa</i>		Informal		All
	Elementary	Secondary	<i>Pesantren</i>	<i>Diniyah</i>	Islamic
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
SD INPRES	0.0007*** (0.0002)	0.0012*** (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0016*** (0.0004)
SD $\times$ high potential rice yield	0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0008*** (0.0002)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0016*** (0.0005)	0.0032*** (0.0007)
SD $\times$ high <i>waqf</i> endowment	-0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0004 (0.0002)	0.0015*** (0.0002)	0.0025*** (0.0004)	0.0033*** (0.0006)
<i>SD villages with high funding base</i>	0.0009*** (0.0003)	0.0016*** (0.0002)	0.0016*** (0.0003)	0.0040*** (0.0004)	0.0081*** (0.0006)
Village FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE $\times$. . .	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Islamic Schools in 1959	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Secular Primary Schools in 1959	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
high potential rice yield	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
high <i>waqf</i> endowment	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Village-Years	3,007,920	3,007,920	3,007,920	3,007,920	3,007,920
Dep. Var. Mean	0.0009	0.0001	0.0005	0.0029	0.0045
R ²	0.041	0.037	0.068	0.064	0.077

Notes: The dependent variables are measured as new schools of a given type created per village-year. SD INPRES Entry is a binary indicator equal to one in the first year of public primary school construction from 1973–78 and remains one in all years thereafter. The estimates are based on an augmented version of panel (c) in Table 2, including interactions of SD INPRES Entry with two proxies for underlying Islamic school funding potential. Rice yields are based on a time-invariant and standardized measure from FAO-GAEZ and averages over dry and wet rice yields. We construct a dummy equal to 1 if a village has a value of potential rice yields above the sample median. *Waqf* endowments are constructed using data on land endowed in mosques as of 1960. We then construct a dummy equal to 1 if the district has *waqf* endowments above the sample median. These data are not available for a small subset of districts and hence the difference in sample size with Table 2. All specifications include village fixed effects and year fixed effects interacted separately with the number of secular elementary schools and Islamic schools in the village as of 1959 as well as the two funding proxies. The estimates in the final row, “SD villages with high funding base,” are based on the linear combination of the other three terms, reflecting the effects of SD INPRES in villages with high potential yield and high *waqf* endowments.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by village.

Table 4: SD INPRES Intensity and Curriculum Differentiation in Islamic Schools

	All Levels (1)	Primary (2)	Jun. Sec. (3)	Sen. Sec. (4)
(a) Islamic Subject Share				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.012* (0.007)	0.013** (0.006)	0.022*** (0.008)	-0.040 (0.024)
Dep. Var. Mean	0.246	0.238	0.261	0.242
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.047	0.033	0.028	0.036
Number of Observations	4,243	1,404	1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
(b) Arabic Share				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.002* (0.001)	0.003** (0.001)	0.008*** (0.002)	0.017*** (0.002)
Dep. Var. Mean	0.053	0.050	0.068	0.054
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.013	0.009	0.010	0.007
Number of Observations	4,243	1,404	1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
(c) <i>Pancasila</i> /Civic Share				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	-0.002 (0.002)	n/a	-0.003 (0.003)	0.008*** (0.002)
Dep. Var. Mean	0.052		0.060	0.039
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.012		0.008	0.004
Number of Observations	2,775		1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	237		213	178
(d) <i>Bahasa</i> Indonesia Share				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	-0.004** (0.002)	0.000 (0.003)	-0.005 (0.005)	0.002 (0.002)
Dep. Var. Mean	0.027	0.001	0.123	0.084
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.047	0.008	0.016	0.008
Number of Observations	4,243	1,404	1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
District FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Grade-Level FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year-of-Entry FE	✓	✓	✓	✓

Notes: This table presents estimates from a modified version of equation (1). We use an unbalanced panel at the school-grade (primary, jun. sec., sen. sec.) $\times$ district $\times$ year level, including only years in which the given district had any school-grades enter. The estimating equation is $y_{sijt} = \beta(INPRES_j \times Post1972_t) + (\mathbf{X}_j \times Post1972_t)' \Theta + \delta_s + \delta_j + \delta_t + \varepsilon_{sijt}$, where s is a school-grade level and other terms are defined as in equation (1). The dependent variable measures the mean share of weekly instruction time devoted to Islamic subject material in panel (a), Arabic instruction in panel (b), *Pancasila* and civic education in panel (c), and instruction of the national language and literature, *Bahasa* Indonesia in panel (d). The measures come from the SIAP registry for the 2018–19 school year, and we categorize subject material using a procedure detailed in Appendix D. It is not possible to identify *Pancasila* and civic subjects for primary schools as this subject is not covered in elementary schools and hence the omission of column 2 in panel (b); column (1) for this outcome necessarily omits primary schools. All specifications include district fixed effects, grade-level fixed effects, year-of-entry fixed effects, and a post-1972 dummy interacted with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program, and the baseline number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa*, and *pesantren*.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

Table 5: SD INPRES Exposure and Islamic School Choice

	Highest Education Level: [...] <i>Madrasa</i>			
	Elementary (1)	Junior Secondary (2)	Senior Secondary (3)	Any Level (4)
(a) Difference-in-Differences				
INPRES $\times$ young	-0.0011** (0.0004)	0.0019*** (0.0004)	0.0010*** (0.0003)	0.0017** (0.0007)
(b) Synthetic Difference-in-Differences				
INPRES $\times$ young	-0.0025*** (0.0008)	0.0034*** (0.0008)	0.0020*** (0.0007)	0.0026* (0.0014)
District $\times$ Survey Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
1957 Islamic Schools $\times$ Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Individuals	839,026	839,026	839,026	839,026
Number of Districts	275	275	275	275
Dep. Var. Mean	0.014	0.011	0.008	0.031
R ² (panel a)	0.031	0.014	0.009	0.033

Notes: This table reports estimates of equation (4) based on annual *Susenas* data from 2012 to 2018. INPRES refers to SD INPRES schools constructed from 1973–78 per 1,000 children in 1971. The dependent variables include an indicator equal to one if the individual’s final year of schooling took place in an Islamic elementary (column 1), junior secondary (column 2), senior secondary (column 3), or any level Islamic (column 4). Panel (a) reports standard DID estimates. All specifications include district of birth times survey–year fixed effects and cohort fixed effects interacted separately with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program in the district of birth, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa* in 1957, and the number of *pesantren* in 1957. The sample is composed of all individuals aged 2–6 (young) or 12–17 in 1974. Robust standard errors are clustered by district of birth. Panel (b) reports synthetic DID estimates. The dependent variables are residualized outcomes obtained using the same set of covariates as in panel (a); see Figure 3 for generic details on SDID implementation. Analogous to Appendix Figure A.7, partially exposed cohorts aged 7–11 in 1974 are used in the construction of the synthetic control group; thus the sample is composed of all individuals aged 2–6 (young) or 7–17 in 1974 in odd-numbered columns.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Standard errors are clustered by district of birth in both panels and, in panel (b), are computed using the cluster bootstrap described in Algorithm 2 of Arkhangelsky et al. (2021).

Table 6: SD INPRES Exposure and School Choice, Conditional Estimates

	Highest Education Level: [...] <i>Madrasa</i> Graduating at that Level			
	Elementary (1)	Junior Secondary (2)	Senior Secondary (3)	Any Level (4)
(a) Difference-in-Differences (DID)				
INPRES $\times$ young	-0.0017** (0.0007)	0.0057*** (0.0020)	-0.0000 (0.0014)	0.0011 (0.0007)
(b) Synthetic Difference-in-Differences				
INPRES $\times$ young	-0.0043*** (0.0016)	0.0117*** (0.0044)	-0.0003 (0.0028)	0.0016 (0.0017)
(c) DID with Selection Correction (Parametric)				
INPRES $\times$ young	-0.0031** (0.0012) [0.049]	0.0040 (0.0027) [0.347]	0.0020 (0.0022) [0.481]	0.0003 (0.0009) [0.731]
Selection Terms, p-value	0.197	0.429	0.284	0.261
(d) DID with Selection Correction (Semiparametric)				
INPRES $\times$ young	-0.0018** (0.0008) [0.001]	0.0055*** (0.0021) [0.001]	0.0001 (0.0015) [0.986]	0.0005 (0.0009) [0.479]
Selection Terms, p-value	0.928	0.001	0.413	0.386
District $\times$ Survey Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
1957 Islamic Schools $\times$ Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Individuals (panel a)	283,359	100,874	130,546	514,784
Number of Districts	275	275	275	275
Dep. Var. Mean	0.024	0.070	0.044	0.038

Notes: This table estimates the specifications in Table 5 on dependent variables defined conditional on graduating from a given level of education. These binary outcomes equal one for *madrasa* among elementary graduates (column 1), among junior secondary graduates (column 2), among senior secondary graduates (column 3), and any level graduates (column 4). The sample only includes individuals at the given graduation level. In panels (a) and (b), specification details for the DID and the SDID estimation are otherwise identical to those in panels (a) and (b) of Table 5, respectively. In panels (c) and (d), we report estimates from the second step of a two-step selection model that adjusts for the non-random sample selection, i.e., conditioning on those that reached the given level. Panel (a) estimates a parametric Heckman (1976) two-step procedure, which includes the inverse Mills Ratio in the second-step. Panel (b) estimates a semiparametric Newey (2009) procedure, which includes a cubic polynomial in flexibly estimated first-step probabilities; the cubic order is based on consistency results in Newey (2009), which imply an upper bound of 3 on the order of the approximating power series in a sample with effective size of 275 (i.e., the level of policy variation). In both cases, we exclude from the second step a set of covariates that capture exposure to a compulsory schooling pilot program in the 1950s and early 1960s: cohort FE $\times$ (i) an indicator equal to one if the individual's district of birth was one of 35 pilot sites, (ii) the number of schools allocated to the district as part of the program, and (iii) the number of teachers allocated to the district as part of the program. In panel (d), to better approximate the true selection correction function, we create quintiles of all continuous regressors in the first step estimation, i.e., (ii) and (iii) plus the continuous regressors in the baseline specification.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district of birth in all specifications. Panels (c) and (d) deploy a percentile- t cluster bootstrap procedure proposed by Yamagata (2006) and shown to work well with two-step selection estimators. The standard errors in those panels are based on non-bootstrap inference, but the significance levels on the coefficients and p-values reported below the standard errors are based on the asymmetric percentile- t confidence intervals derived from 250 cluster bootstrap repetitions.

Table 7: Medium-Run Effects and Heterogeneity by Gender

	Years of School (1)	Highest Education Level: [...] <i>Madrassa</i>		
		Elementary (2)	Secondary (3)	Any (4)
INPRES $\times$ born 1968-72	0.1766*** (0.0309)	-0.0015*** (0.0005)	0.0029*** (0.0007)	0.0014* (0.0007)
INPRES $\times$ born 1973-87	0.2058*** (0.0398)	-0.0017*** (0.0006)	0.0053*** (0.0012)	0.0035*** (0.0012)
INPRES $\times$ born 1968-72 $\times$ female <i>completed primary before the 1982 veiling ban</i>	-0.1002*** (0.0285)	0.0006 (0.0005)	0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0010 (0.0007)
INPRES $\times$ born 1973-87 $\times$ female <i>in school when the veiling ban came into effect</i>	0.0188 (0.0397)	0.0007 (0.0007)	0.0016** (0.0007)	0.0022** (0.0009)
Number of Individuals	2,315,933	2,315,949	2,315,949	2,315,949
Number of Districts	275	275	275	275
Dep. Var. Mean	8.424	0.011	0.028	0.038
R ²	0.189	0.025	0.029	0.039

Notes: This table reports estimates of a modified version of equation (4). The sample includes all children born between 1957–1962 (control cohorts) and 1968–1987 (exposed cohorts). Compared to the baseline DID specification, we interact INPRES intensity with either a dummy for individuals born between 1968–1972 or a dummy for individuals born between 1973–1987. We use the latter cohorts to identify the medium-run effects of the program, inclusive of Islamic school entry responses and exposure to the 1982 ban on Islamic veiling in public schools. We also include two interactions of each age group with female dummies while also interacting the cohort FE and all baseline controls with a female indicator, i.e., all coefficients and FE are allowed to vary with gender. The specification is otherwise identical to that in panel (a) of Table 5 (see the notes therein).

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district of birth.

Table 8: SD INPRES Exposure, Identity, and Religiosity

	(a) Identity, Proxied by Language					
	National Language Use at Home			Arabic Literacy		
	All	Muslims	Non-Muslims	All	Islamic-Educated	Secular-Educated
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
INPRES $\times$ young	-0.0011 (0.0015)	-0.0030* (0.0017)	-0.0019 (0.0021)	0.0113*** (0.0026)	0.0147 (0.0108)	0.0024 (0.0025)
Number of Individuals	31,680,947	27,811,517	3,869,430	839,026	25,819	813,087
Number of Districts	273	273	273	275	264	275
Dep. Var. Mean	0.166	0.150	0.275	0.343	0.689	0.332

	(b) Islamic Piety and Practice							
	Pray 5x daily (1)	Fast during Ramadan (2)	Reads the Qur'an (3)	Friday (4)	Prayer: Sunna (5)	Group (6)	Pay Zakat (7)	Index (8)
INPRES $\times$ young	0.1368** (0.0606)	-0.0030 (0.0501)	0.0990** (0.0481)	0.1562** (0.0619)	0.0953* (0.0489)	0.0364 (0.0465)	0.0357 (0.0456)	0.0792*** (0.0296)
Number of Individuals	1,282	1,283	1,281	1,276	1,268	1,280	1,281	1,284
Number of Districts	144	144	144	144	144	144	144	144
Dep. Var. Mean	0.623	0.797	0.251	0.187	0.140	0.230	0.834	0.415

Notes: This table reports estimates of equation (4) using data from multiple sources. The dependent variable in columns 1–3 of panel (a) is an indicator for whether the individual speaks the national language, *Bahasa* Indonesia, as his/her main language at home. The data come from the complete-count 2010 Population Census. Columns 4–6 in panel (a) look at an indicator for whether an individual reports literacy in Arabic in the annual *Susenas* data from 2012 to 2018. Panel (a) sample splits across Muslims and non-Muslims in the Population Census (where we do not observe Islamic education) and across Islamic-educated and non-Islamic-educated in *Susenas* (where we do not observe religion). The specifications in panel (a) are restricted to mothers and fathers (husbands and wives) that fall within the original birth cohorts: aged 2–6 (young) or 12–17 in 1974. The dependent variables in panel (b) include indicators for whether an individual reports partaking in a range of Islamic practices as reported in the [Pepinsky et al. \(2018\)](#) survey data from 2008. The final column is a mean index across all 7 prior outcomes. The sample in panel (b) is restricted to Muslim respondents from 1957 to 1987, excluding the partially exposed cohorts born 1963–67. The specification is otherwise identical to panel (a) in Table 5, which includes district of birth (times survey–year) fixed effects and cohort fixed effects interacted separately with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program in the district of birth, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa* in 1957, and the number of *pesantren* in 1957 (see the notes therein).

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district of birth.

Table 9: SD INPRES Exposure and Religious Cultural Transmission

	<i>Marriage Matching</i>		<i>Arabic Literacy</i>			
	Islamic-Educated Partner		Arabic in the Home Parents & Children		Child's Arabic No Islamic Schooling	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
INPRES $\times$ young (Father)	0.0020** (0.0009)		0.0043* (0.0025)		0.0072** (0.0036)	
INPRES $\times$ young (Mother)		-0.0002 (0.0007)		0.0048* (0.0026)		0.0054 (0.0046)
Number of Individuals	725,803	544,143	304,048	246,049	95,678	77,064
Number of Districts	275	275	275	275	272	272
Dep. Var. Mean	0.039	0.024	0.213	0.268	0.877	0.887
R ²	0.038	0.026	0.112	0.138	0.048	0.043

Notes: This table reports estimates of a modified version of equation (4) where *young* now denotes the INPRES exposure of a parent (father or mother). INPRES refers to SD INPRES schools constructed from 1973–78 per 1,000 children in 1971. The dependent variable in columns 1–2 is an indicator for whether the spouse has an Islamic education, in columns 3–4 an indicator for all 3 members of the household (father, mother, and child) being literate in Arabic, and in columns 5–6 an indicator equal to 1 if the child is literate in Arabic, conditional on the parent being literate in Arabic and the child having received no Islamic schooling. All specifications are restricted to children with mothers and fathers (or to husbands and wives) that fall within the original birth cohorts: aged 2–6 (young) or 12–17 in 1974. We restrict to co-resident children that are at least 18 years old and hence likely to have completed their education. The regressions additionally control for child birth cohort fixed effects. The specification is otherwise identical to panel (a) in Table 5 (see the notes therein).

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by the parent's district of birth.

Online Appendix

A	Additional Empirical Results	A-1
A.1	Additional Results on School Entry	A-1
A.2	Further Results on the Financing of the Islamic Education Sector	A-12
A.3	Further Background and Results on Religious Curriculum	A-18
A.4	Further Results on Islamic School Choice	A-21
A.5	Further Results on the Substitutability of Public and Islamic Primary Schools	A-29
A.6	Probing Linguistic Ability and Identity	A-31
A.7	Additional Figures and Tables	A-32
B	Conceptual Framework: Full Discussion and Derivations	B-1
B.1	Setup	B-1
B.2	Baseline Equilibrium	B-2
B.3	Budget Windfall	B-3
B.4	Proofs	B-4
B.4.1	Baseline Setup	B-4
B.4.2	Introducing Religious Secondary Education	B-9
C	Oral History Accounts of School Construction in the 1970s	C-1
C.1	Setup	C-1
C.2	Key Lessons	C-1
D	Data Sources and Construction	D-1

List of Figures

A.1	Credible Confidence Sets under Varying Departure from Parallel Trends	A-1
A.2	SD INPRES Intensity and Entry of Private non-Islamic Schools	A-2
A.3	Islamic School Entry at the Village Level, Standard DID	A-3
A.4	Islamic versus Secular Private School Entry at the Village Level	A-4
A.5	Entry of non-Islamic Junior Secondary Schools	A-5
A.6	Agricultural Commodity Price Shocks	A-13
A.7	Islamic School Choice, Synthetic DID Estimates	A-21
A.8	Informal (<i>pesantren</i>) Islamic School Enrollment	A-22
A.9	Mandatory School Uniforms in the 1982 MEC Regulation	A-32
A.10	Education and Religiosity Across Countries	A-33
A.11	Distribution of Key Electoral Outcomes in 1977 and 1982	A-34

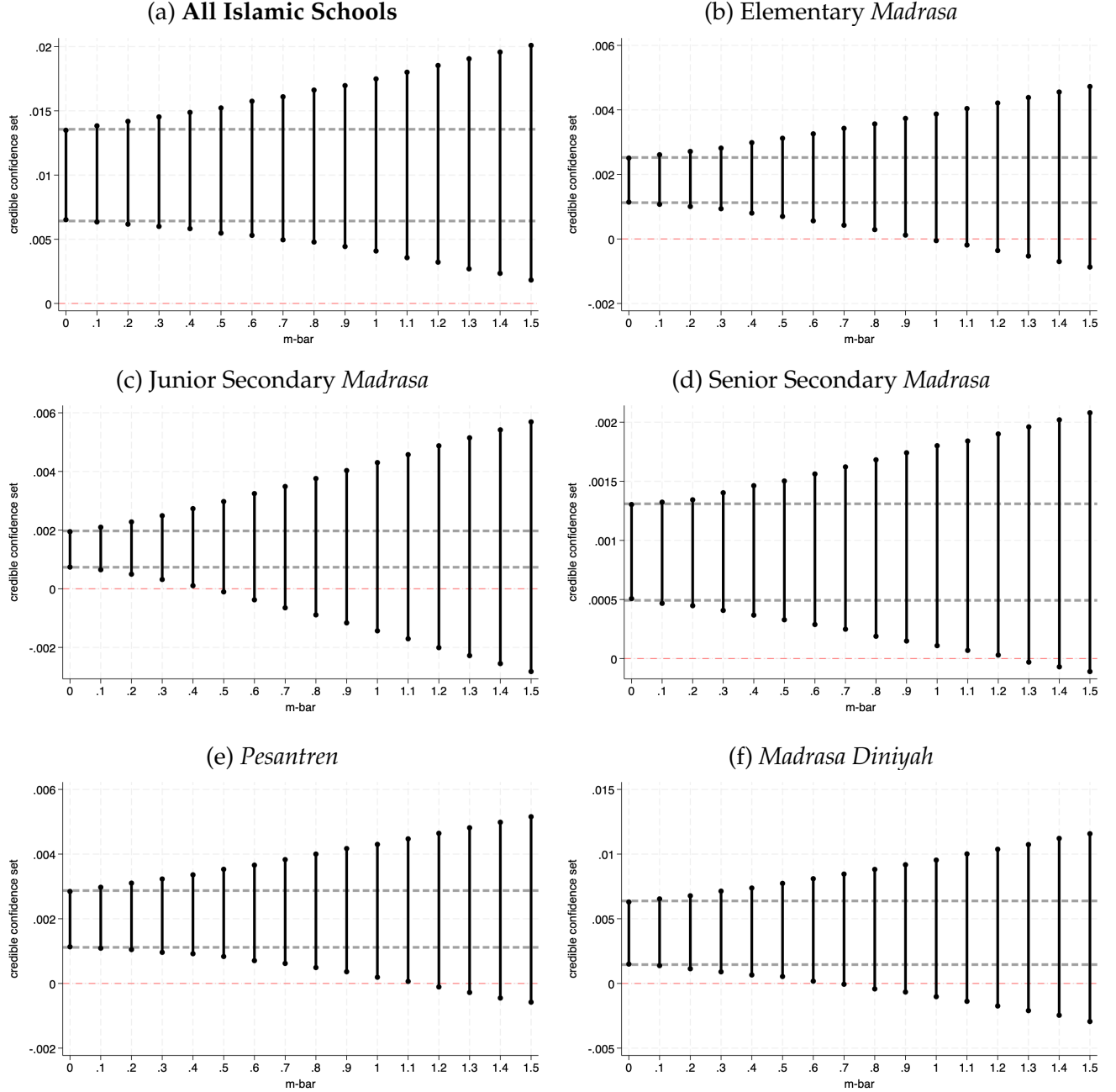
List of Tables

A.1	Correlates of INPRES School Allocation, Flexible Targeting Policy Controls	A-6
A.2	SD INPRES Intensity and Entry of Islamic Schools (Robustness)	A-7
A.3	New Islamic Schools Over Time in Historical Administrative Data	A-8
A.4	Exogeneity of Timing of SD INPRES Entry at the Village Level	A-9
A.5	Islamic School Entry at the Village Level	A-10
A.6	Formalization of the Islamic Education Sector	A-11
A.7	Placebo: Islamic School and Public Primary (SD) Entry in Other Periods	A-14
A.8	Placebo: Private Non-Islamic Elementary School and SD INPRES Entry	A-15
A.9	SD INPRES and Islamic School Entry – NGO-Affiliated Schools	A-15
A.10	School Entry in the 1970s and the Legacy of Informal Taxation	A-16
A.11	INPRES and <i>Waqf</i> Endowment Substitution across Islamic Infrastructure	A-17
A.12	Curriculum Differentiation in Islamic Schools (Total Hours)	A-18
A.13	SD INPRES Intensity and Curriculum Differentiation in Islamic Schools	A-19
A.14	Heterogeneous Curriculum Differentiation in Islamic Schools	A-20
A.15	INPRES Exposure and Name-Based Ideology of New Schools	A-20
A.16	Islamic Education Rates	A-23
A.17	Transitions Between Public and Islamic Schools	A-24
A.18	INPRES Exposure and Islamic Schooling in the IFLS	A-25
A.19	SD INPRES Exposure and Islamic School Choice (Robustness)	A-26
A.20	Exogeneity of the Compulsory Schooling Pilot Program	A-27
A.21	Heterogeneity in Islamic School Choice by Religious Preferences	A-28
A.22	Substitution between Public and Islamic Elementary Schools	A-30
A.23	INPRES Exposure and Linguistic Ability	A-31
A.24	Correlations of Islamic Education and Literacy	A-31
A.25	Electoral Data Checks: Excess <i>Golkar</i> Vote Share	A-35
A.26	Electoral Data Checks: Excess Vote Tallies	A-35
A.27	SD INPRES Exposure and Ideology	A-36

A Additional Empirical Results

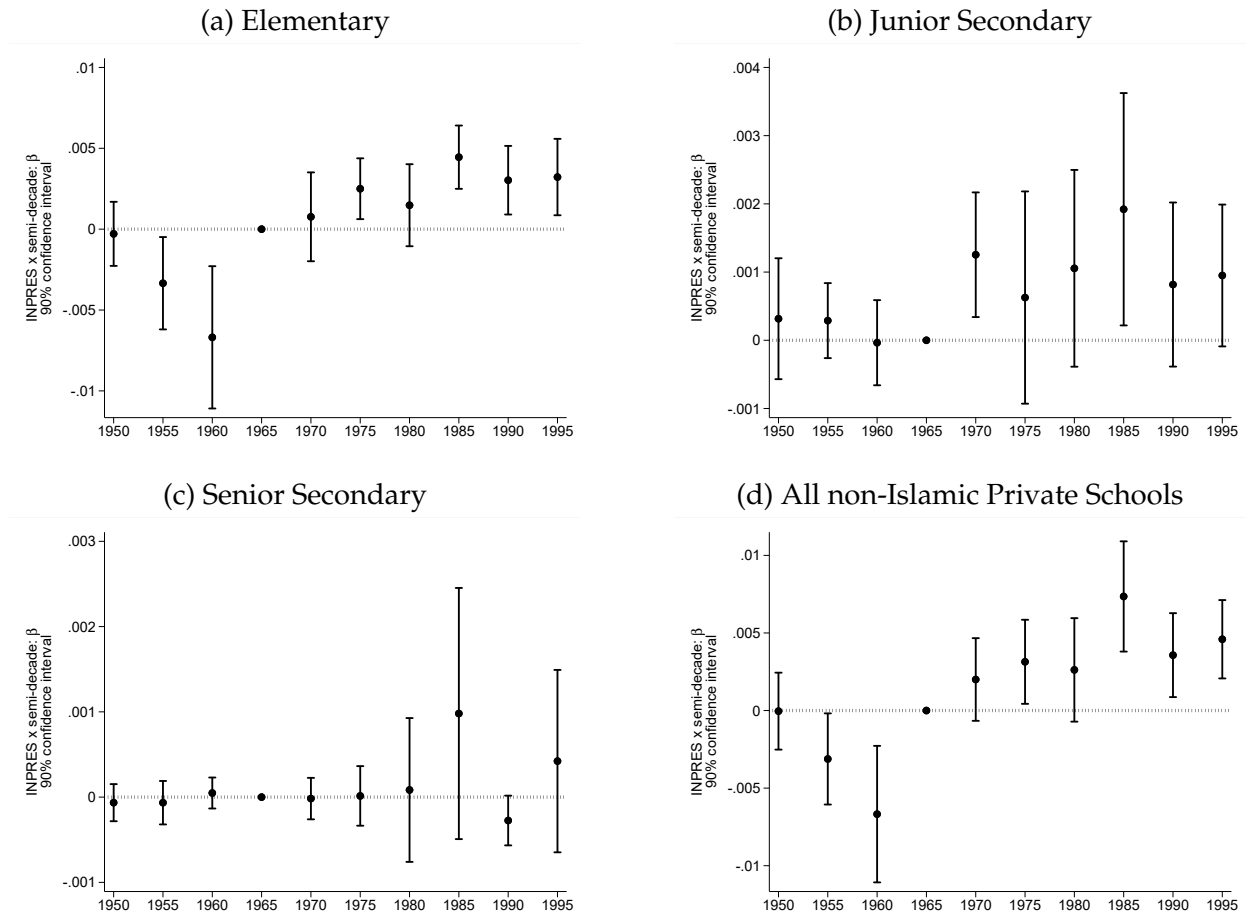
A.1 Additional Results on School Entry

Figure A.1: Credible Confidence Sets under Varying Departure from Parallel Trends
Robustness Check on District-Level Supply Results in Figure 2



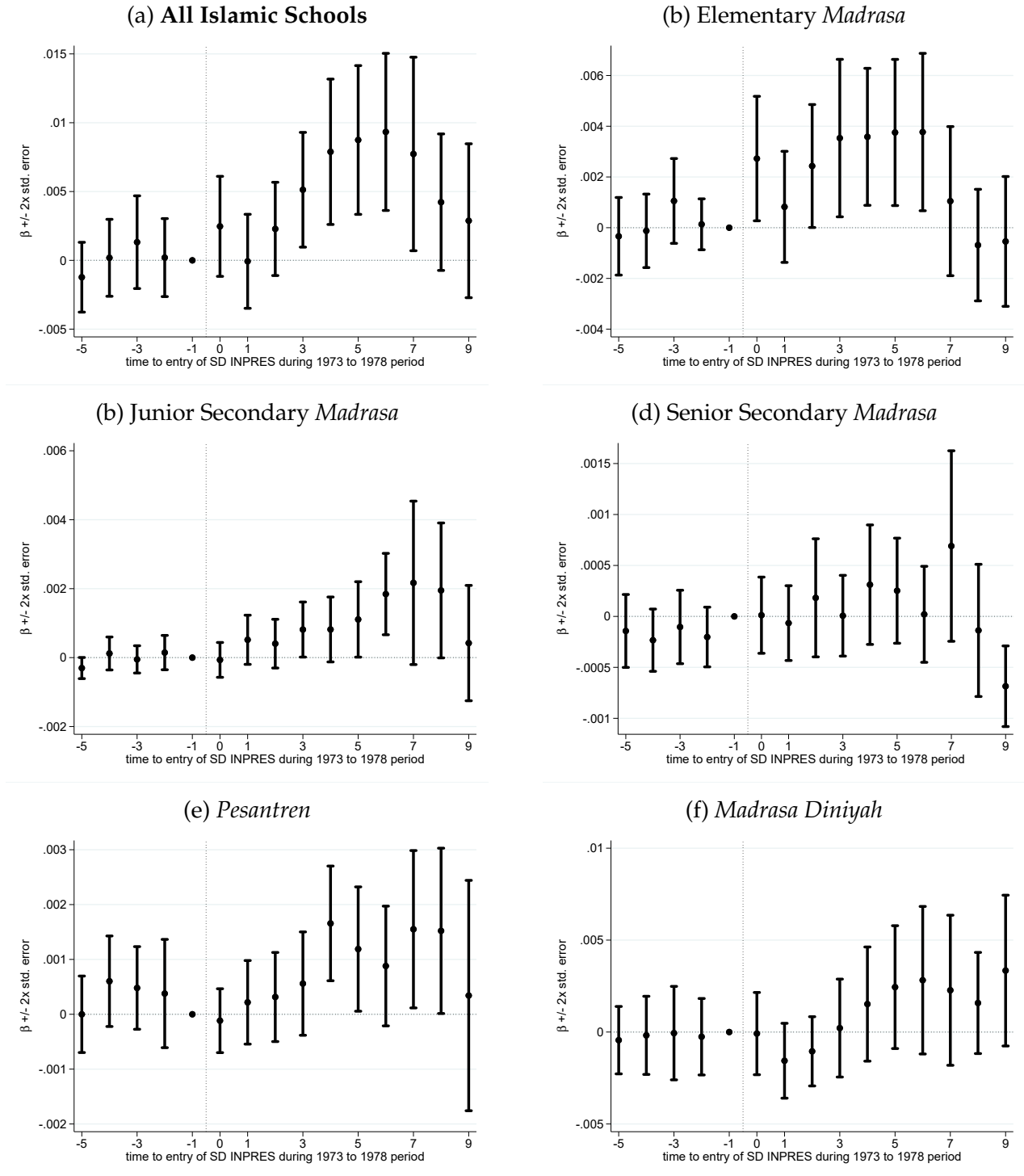
Notes: This figure reports credible 90% confidence sets based on [Roth and Rambachan \(2022\)](#). These sets allow the post-INPRES maximum violations of parallel trends to be up to $\bar{m}$ times larger than the maximum pre-treatment violation for different values of $\bar{m}$ that answer how much the post-INPRES trends in Islamic school entry would need to differ from the pre-trends in order to nullify the findings at zero (horizontal, red dashed line). The horizontal, gray dashed lines, and the credible confidence set at $\bar{m} = 0$, correspond to the baseline 90% confidence intervals from Table 2.

Figure A.2: SD INPRES Intensity and Entry of Private non-Islamic Schools



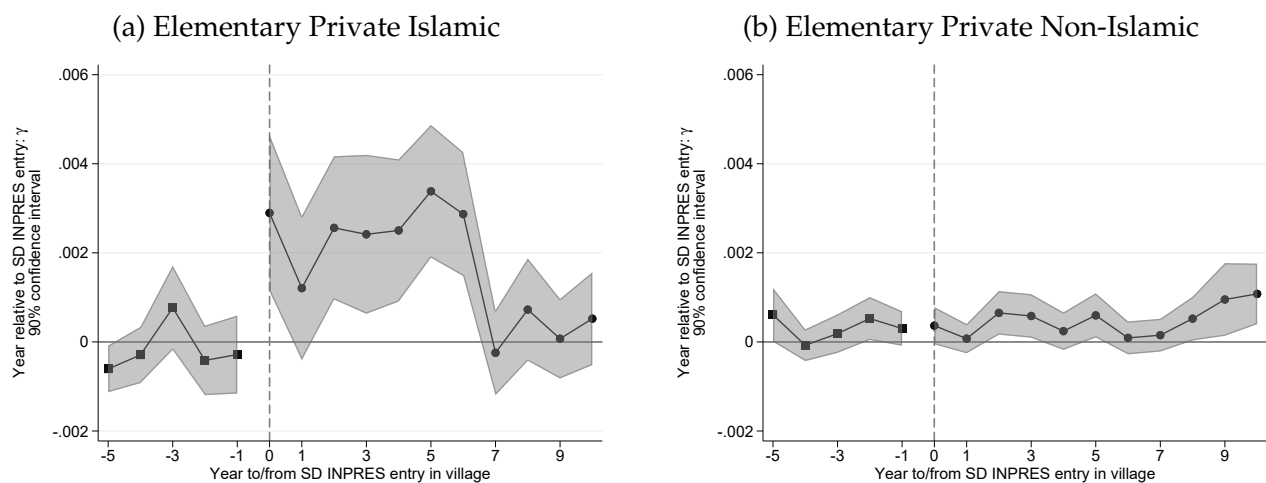
Notes: This figure reports semi-decade-specific estimates of β in equation (1) on a balanced district-year panel. The dependent variable measures: the number of entering private non-Islamic schools at the elementary (a), junior secondary (b), and senior secondary (c) level, or across all levels (d), each normalized per 1,000 children in 1971. All other specification details are as in Figure 2. Appendix D describes how we identify private non-Islamic schools in the MEC registry. The figure reports 90% confidence intervals with standard errors clustered at the district level.

Figure A.3: Islamic School Entry at the Village Level, Standard DID



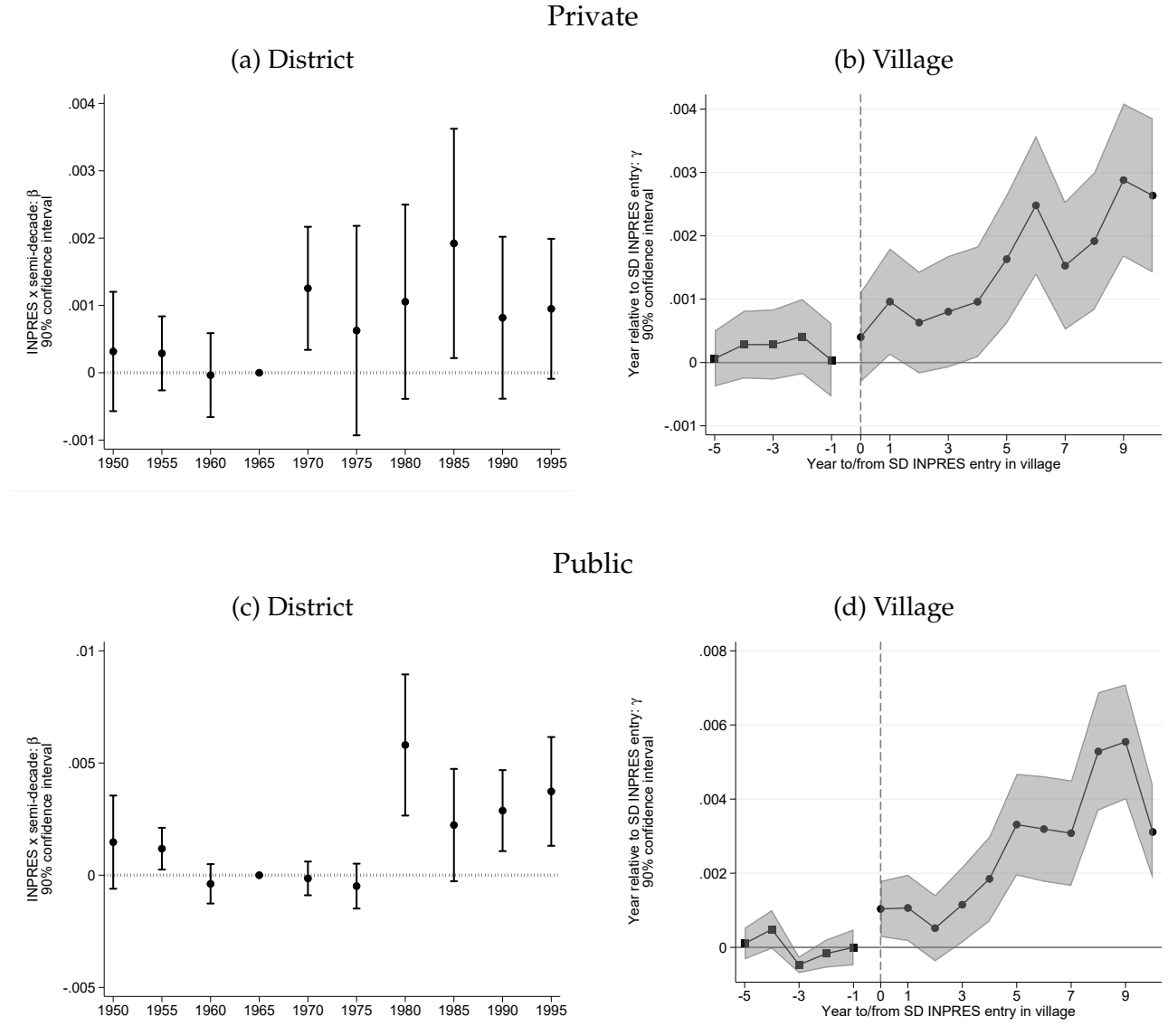
Notes: This figure reports the event-study analogue to the standard DID estimates in panel (c) of Table 2, based on equation (2). The event-study setup and controls are otherwise similar to the one in Figure 4. The figure reports coefficients +/- two times the standard errors, which are clustered at the village level.

Figure A.4: Islamic versus Secular Private School Entry at the Village Level



Notes: This figure reports estimates of γ in equation (2). All the specification and estimation details are as in Figure 4. In panel (a), the dependent variable measures the number of elementary *madrasa* built per village-year, as in panel (a) of Figure 4. In panel (b), the dependent variable measures the number of private non-Islamic elementary schools built per village-year. The gray shading corresponds to 90% confidence intervals with standard errors clustered by village.

Figure A.5: Entry of non-Islamic Junior Secondary Schools



Notes: Panels (a) and (c) report semi-decade-specific estimates of β in equation (1). The dependent variable is the number of junior secondary private (panel a) or public schools (c) built by semi-decade and by district per 1,000 children in 1971. All specification details are as in Figure 2. Panels (b) and (d) report estimates of γ in equation (2). The dependent variable is the number of private (panel b) or public junior secondary school (d) built per village-year. The specification and estimation details are as in Figure 4.

Table A.1: Correlates of INPRES School Allocation, Flexible Targeting Policy Controls

	Dependent Variable:				
	log SD INPRES in district				SD INPRES in village
<i>District Level</i>	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
% Islamic primary enrollment, 1967–72	0.034*** (0.007)	0.030*** (0.007)		0.014** (0.007)	
% Non-Islamic primary enrollment, 1967–72		-0.004 (0.004)		-0.003 (0.004)	
log Islamic primary schools, 1971			0.134*** (0.030)	0.101*** (0.031)	
Islamic parties vote share, 1950s				0.005*** (0.001)	
<i>Village Level</i>					
any public elementary in village, 1971					-0.051*** (0.011)
any private non-Islamic elementary in village, 1971					0.005 (0.010)
any private Islamic elementary in village, 1971					0.027* (0.016)
Number of Districts or Villages	275	275	275	275	75,208
Flexible Targeting Policy Controls	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
R ²	0.898	0.898	0.903	0.910	0.073

Notes: This table reports correlates of SD INPRES school construction at the district and village levels. The dependent variable is the log number of INPRES elementary schools constructed at the district level between 1973–78 (columns 1–4) and an indicator for any SD INPRES built in the village during that same period (column 5). All regressions control for the variables that informed the policy rule for INPRES school allocations: province fixed effects, decile of the 1971 children population, decile of the 1971 enrollment rate, and exposure to the water and sanitation program. Note that unlike the analogous Table 1 in the paper, this table does not include the measure of log school-aged children not enrolled in 1971 as this nonlinear transformation of the 1971 child population and the 1971 enrollment rate has little residual variation once we condition, in this flexible specification, on deciles of those two underlying components.

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors in parentheses, clustered by district in column 5.

Table A.2: SD INPRES Intensity and Entry of Islamic Schools (Robustness)
Additional Controls: Latent Potential Growth in Islamic Education

	Formal <i>Madrasa</i>			Informal		All
	Elementary (1)	Junior Sec. (2)	Senior Sec. (3)	<i>Pesantren</i> (4)	<i>Diniyah</i> (5)	Islamic (6)
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.0016*** (0.0004)	0.0015*** (0.0003)	0.0008*** (0.0002)	0.0020*** (0.0005)	0.0042** (0.0016)	0.0101*** (0.0020)
1959 Islamic Schools $\times$ Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Additional Controls $\times$ Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
District FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of District–Years	10,920	10,920	10,920	10,920	10,920	10,920
Dep. Var. Mean	0.007	0.005	0.002	0.007	0.018	0.039
R ²	0.241	0.262	0.227	0.349	0.588	0.509

Notes: This table augments the baseline specification from panel (a) of Table 2 with the following predetermined controls interacted with year fixed effects: the prevalence of *waqf* endowments in 1960, the Muslim population share in the 1972 census, Islamic political party support in the 1955 elections, historical Arab minority populations, the occurrence of an Islamist armed insurgency in the 1950s, an indicator for districts involved in an experimental compulsory schooling program after 1957, and the total number of Transmigration villages and settlers before and after 1978. The dependent variables are measured as new schools of a given type created per district-year and per 1,000 children in 1971. INPRES refers to SD INPRES schools constructed from 1973–78 per 1,000 children in 1971. All specification details are as in panel (a) of Table 2; in particular, all specifications also include district fixed effects and year fixed effects interacted with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa* in 1959, and the number of *pesantren* in 1959.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors are clustered by district.

Table A.3: New Islamic Schools Over Time in Historical Administrative Data

	Islamic Schools				Secular Schools		
	Prim. (1)	Jun. Sec. (2)	Sen. Sec. (3)	<i>pesantren</i> (4)	Prim. (5)	Jun. Sec. (6)	Sen. Sec. (7)
Effect of No. of INPRES Schools on... 1980 level	0.258*** (0.063)	–	–	0.044* (0.023)	0.492*** (0.088)	-0.064*** (0.020)	-0.060*** (0.015)
Δ 1980 - 1983	0.022 (0.019)	–	–	0.008 (0.006)	-0.077 (0.056)	0.023 (0.016)	-0.006 (0.008)
Δ 1983 - 1990	0.126*** (0.032)	–	–	0.015 (0.012)	0.282*** (0.086)	0.011 (0.030)	0.005 (0.021)
Δ 1990 - 1993	0.015 (0.022)	0.009* (0.005)	0.012*** (0.004)	0.011** (0.004)	-0.028 (0.047)	0.015 (0.017)	0.011 (0.013)
Number of Districts	273	273	273	273	273	273	273
Mean 1980 level	93.4	–	–	19.1	424.1	46.9	18.7
Mean Δ1980 - 1983	-0.05	–	–	0.7	47.5	15.2	9.9
Mean Δ1983 - 1990	20.5	–	–	9.1	52.9	8.9	11.6
Mean Δ1990 - 1993	-4.3	1.8	0.9	2.0	0.3	-1.3	-2.3

Notes: This table examines supply-side responses to INPRES using historical administrative data from the 1980, 1983, 1990 and 1993 rounds *Podes*, which asked about the number of schools of different types. Each cell shows the coefficient from a separate district-level cross-sectional regression of the given outcome on the number of SD INPRES primary schools constructed from 1973 to 1978. The first row looks at the number of schools of each level in 1980, and subsequent rows look at the difference in the stock reported between the initial and final year of the difference. The district-level number of *pesantren* are computed by adding up the number of villages that report having any *pesantren*. Secondary Islamic schools were not recorded until the 1990 round of *Podes*. The regressions control for the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, and exposure to the water and sanitation program.

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors.

Table A.4: Exogeneity of Timing of SD INPRES Entry at the Village Level

	Year of entry 1973-78 (1)	Early entry: 1973-74 (2)	Entry in: 1975-76 (3)	Late entry: 1977-78 (4)
Elementary <i>madrassa</i>	-0.0909 (0.1079)	0.0052 (0.0308)	0.0298 (0.0340)	-0.0350 (0.0328)
Secondary <i>madrassa</i>	0.0799 (0.2074)	-0.0328 (0.0581)	0.1216 (0.0779)	-0.0889 (0.0697)
<i>Pesantren</i>	0.0563 (0.0966)	0.0066 (0.0221)	-0.0247 (0.0218)	0.0181 (0.0258)
Waqf land	-0.0467 (0.0424)	0.0164 (0.0117)	0.0011 (0.0131)	-0.0175 (0.0133)
Potential rice yield	-0.0360 (0.1961)	0.0260 (0.0519)	0.0168 (0.0587)	-0.0428 (0.0616)
Potential palm oil yield	0.0190 (0.0514)	0.0021 (0.0139)	-0.0168 (0.0164)	0.0148 (0.0167)
Potential cocoa yield	-0.5374 (0.4569)	0.0850 (0.1242)	0.1218 (0.1437)	-0.2068 (0.1508)
Potential coffee yield	1.1610* (0.6183)	-0.2593 (0.1675)	-0.1264 (0.1906)	0.3857* (0.1999)
Potential maize yield	0.3161 (0.2199)	-0.0343 (0.0588)	-0.0201 (0.0672)	0.0544 (0.0680)
Coastal location	-0.0214 (0.0677)	-0.0012 (0.0177)	0.0036 (0.0207)	-0.0023 (0.0209)
Elevation	0.0125 (0.0325)	0.0038 (0.0085)	-0.0113 (0.0099)	0.0075 (0.0102)
Land area	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)
F-stat: joint significance	0.36	0.41	0.80	0.78
p-value	0.92	0.90	0.59	0.60
R ²	0.082	0.081	0.068	0.074

Notes: This table reports cross-sectional correlations between the timing of SD INPRES entry and observable characteristics at the village level measured as of 1972. The dependent variable is measured as the year of construction of the first SD INPRES school in the village between 1973–78 (column 1) or as a dummy for the first SD INPRES school being built in the village between 1973–74 (column 2), 1975–76 (column 3), or 1977–89 (column 4). Elementary *madrassa* (MI), secondary *madrassa* (MTs and MA), and *waqf* land are measured as of 1972, and *waqf* land is trimmed at the 95th percentile. Crop yields are measured as standardized measures of potential yield from the FAO-GAEZ based on predetermined agroclimatic characteristics. Geographic characteristics (coastal location, elevation, and village land area) are from *Podes*. The bottom panel reports the F-statistic and corresponding p-value from a test of joint significance of all right-hand side regressors. All regressions include district fixed effects.

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A.5: Islamic School Entry at the Village Level
Robustness Checks

	Formal <i>Madrasa</i>			Informal		All
	Elementary (1)	Junior Sec. (2)	Senior Sec. (3)	<i>Pesantren</i> (4)	<i>Diniyah</i> (5)	Islamic (6)
(a) Baseline estimates (Table 2, panel d)						
SD INPRES Entry	0.0022*** (0.0002)	0.0017*** (0.0001)	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0013*** (0.0002)	0.0035*** (0.0003)	0.0094*** (0.0005)
(b) Removing time-varying controls						
SD INPRES Entry	0.0021*** (0.0002)	0.0016*** (0.0001)	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0012*** (0.0002)	0.0032*** (0.0003)	0.0088*** (0.0005)
(c) Shorter panel 1968-1983						
SD INPRES Entry	0.0026*** (0.0004)	0.0005*** (0.0002)	0.0002* (0.0001)	0.0004* (0.0002)	0.0015*** (0.0004)	0.0052*** (0.0007)
(d) Clustering by district						
SD INPRES Entry	0.0022*** (0.0004)	0.0017*** (0.0002)	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0013*** (0.0003)	0.0035*** (0.0008)	0.0094*** (0.0012)
Village FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Village-Years	3,334,560	3,334,560	3,334,560	3,334,560	3,334,560	3,334,560
Dep. Var. Mean	0.0009	0.0001	0.0001	0.0005	0.0025	0.0011

Notes: This table reports estimates of the average of post-SD-INPRES-entry coefficients τ in equation (2) computed using the robust imputation method from [Borusyak et al. \(2024\)](#). The dependent variables are measured as new schools of a given type created per village-year. Panel (a) reports the baseline estimates shown in panel (d) of Table 2. The following panels report estimates obtained after: removing the time-varying controls included in the baseline estimation, i.e., public and Islamic schools in the village by 1959 (panel b), using a shorter panel window spanning 1968–1983 (c), and clustering standard errors by district (d). In panel (c), we control for for interactions of year FE with public and Islamic schools in the village as of 1967, and there are 1,333,824 village-year observations.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors are clustered by village in panels (a)–(c) and by district in panel (d).

Table A.6: Formalization of the Islamic Education Sector

As a share of:	Formal <i>Madrasa</i>	Informal schools	
	New Formal Schools (1)	All New Schools (2)	New Islamic Schools (3)
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.0156*** (0.0052)	-0.0196*** (0.0075)	-0.0615*** (0.0148)
1959 Islamic Schools $\times$ Year FE	✓	✓	✓
District FE	✓	✓	✓
Year FE	✓	✓	✓
Number of District–Years	9,950	10,200	6,365
Dep. Var. Mean	0.158	0.203	0.652
R ²	0.422	0.593	0.403

Notes: This table examines the entry of formal of informal Islamic schools as a fraction of all schools built per district–year. The dependent variable measures: formal *madrasa* at all instruction levels built per district–year as a fraction fo all formal schools (including secular public, private, and Islamic schools) in column 1, and the more informal *pesantren* and *madrasa diniyah* built per district–year as a fraction of all schools (column 2) or as a fraction of all Islamic schools (column 3). Differences in the number of observations across columns reflect years with no entry of schools of the given school type. All specification details as in panel (a) of Table 2.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

A.2 Further Results on the Financing of the Islamic Education Sector

Rice Price Shock. Appendix Figure A.6 demonstrates the large shock to the world price of rice coincidental with the SD INPRES policy.¹ Rice is the most important producer commodity across Indonesia in terms of aggregate production and geographic scope.²

Placebo Check on Table 3. Appendix Table A.7 shows that the heterogeneous Islamic sector supply response to SD INPRES is unique to the period of mass schooling and does not arise for entry of public primary schools in other periods (1960–68 and 1990–98) when rice prices were lower. This is also consistent with the much different and more confrontational period of mass public school construction in the 1970s.

Informal Taxation. In Appendix Table A.10, we report estimates of the following individual-level regression, pooling across four surveys conducted in 4,080 villages from 2007–13:³

$$\mathbb{P}(\text{informal tax}_{ivdt}) = \theta_{dt} + \mathbf{x}'_i \boldsymbol{\beta} + f(\text{Islamic school entry}_v) + \varepsilon_{ivdt}, \quad (\text{A.1})$$

where the dependent variable equals one if the Muslim respondent contributed any informal tax to the given type of public good, θ_{dt} is a set of district×survey-year fixed effects, $\mathbf{x}$ is a vector of controls for age and age squared and gender, and $f(\cdot)$ is a vector of binary indicators for the entry of Islamic schools in the village during different time periods (pre-1973, 1973–78, and post-1978).

The estimates suggest that Islamic school entry in the 1973–78 period is associated over the long run with greater informal taxation to support Islamic infrastructure (schools and houses of worship) and less taxation to support roads and bridges. The same holds when introducing controls for Islamic school entry in other periods before and after the SD INPRES era. Together, these estimates (i) point to a persistent role of informal taxation to support the Islamic education sector, and (ii) provide suggestive evidence that such informal contributions might crowd out support for other non-religious infrastructure.

Waqf Substitution Across Islamic Infrastructure. In Appendix Table A.11, we report estimates from the following cross-sectional, district-level regression

$$\frac{\text{waqf}_d^c}{\text{waqf}_d} = \alpha + \delta \text{INPRES}_d + \mathbf{x}'_d \boldsymbol{\beta} + \varepsilon_d, \quad (\text{A.2})$$

where $\frac{\text{waqf}_d^c}{\text{waqf}_d}$ captures the share of total *waqf* land in district d allocated to Islamic infrastructure category c , INPRES is the number of SD INPRES schools constructed per 1,000 children from 1973 to 1978, and $\mathbf{x}$ is the usual vector of controls along with, in some specifications, controls for Islamic school construction per 1,000 children from 1973–78. The main categories of *waqf*-endowed institutions include schools, houses of worship, cemeteries, and other, which includes a variety of institutions like local health clinics.

In districts with greater SD INPRES intensity in the 1970s, more *waqf* land is allocated to Islamic schools over the long run (columns 1–2), and this comes at the expense of allocations to mosques (columns 3–4). Each additional SD INPRES per 1,000 children is associated with 1.7 p.p. more *waqf* land allocated to Islamic schools (relative to a mean of 16%) and 2.4 p.p. less *waqf* land allocated to Muslim houses of worship (relative to a mean of 42%). Reassuringly, we see that districts with greater

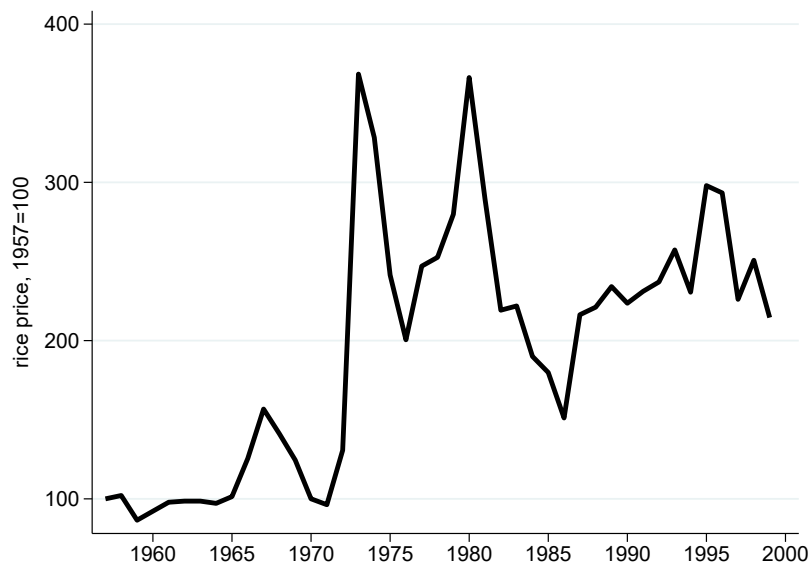
¹See Bazzi (2017) for general evidence of passthrough from world rice price shocks to domestic producers.

²In the early 1970s, the Ministry of Agriculture reported roughly 22.4 million tons of rice compared to 3 million tons of maize, the next most important commodity. In 1983, rice was produced in 73% of villages compared to 56% for maize (according to the 1983 Agricultural Census jointly conducted as part of the triennial *Podes* survey of village officials).

³The data were used by Olken and Singhal (2011) and come from a series of Health and Education Surveys as part of a larger evaluation study reported in Olken et al. (2014).

Islamic school construction in the 1970s also have a significantly higher share of *waqf* land held in religious schools today. This is consistent with the role of *waqf* endowments in support the local Islamic sector response to SD INPRES, as we saw in earlier results.

Figure A.6: Agricultural Commodity Price Shocks



Notes: This figure plots the evolution of the world price of rice from 1957 (=100) to 1990. Data come from the [Bazzi and Blattman \(2014\)](#) commodity price database.

Table A.7: Placebo: Islamic School and Public Primary (SD) Entry in Other Periods

	Formal <i>Madrasa</i>		Informal		All
	Elementary (1)	Secondary (2)	<i>Pesantren</i> (3)	<i>Diniyah</i> (4)	Islamic (5)
(a) 1960–1968					
SD	0.0014** (0.0007)	0.0004 (0.0002)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	0.0003 (0.0012)	0.0016 (0.0016)
SD × high potential rice yield	-0.0028** (0.0011)	-0.0009* (0.0005)	0.0013 (0.0009)	0.0005 (0.0021)	-0.0019 (0.0027)
SD × high <i>waqf</i> endowment	0.0011 (0.0008)	0.0006* (0.0003)	-0.0009 (0.0006)	-0.0018 (0.0015)	-0.0011 (0.0019)
<i>SD villages with high funding base</i>	-0.0003 (0.0007)	0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0010 (0.0010)	-0.0013 (0.0013)
Village FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE × . . .	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Islamic Schools in 1959	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Secular Primary Schools in 1959	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
high potential rice yield	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
high <i>waqf</i> endowment	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Village-Years	676,782	676,782	676,782	676,782	676,782
Dep. Var. Mean	0.0027	0.0000	0.0009	0.0043	0.0079
R ²	0.115	0.115	0.128	0.143	0.141
(b) 1990–1998					
SD	-0.0017 (0.0013)	0.0015 (0.0012)	0.0029** (0.0014)	0.0016 (0.0011)	0.0042* (0.0025)
SD × high potential rice yield	-0.0042 (0.0045)	-0.0029 (0.0025)	-0.0050 (0.0041)	-0.0049 (0.0031)	-0.0169** (0.0073)
SD × high <i>waqf</i> endowment	0.0044 (0.0030)	-0.0017 (0.0019)	-0.0007 (0.0031)	0.0096*** (0.0029)	0.0116** (0.0056)
<i>SD villages with high funding base</i>	-0.0015 (0.0031)	-0.0031 (0.0029)	-0.0028 (0.0057)	0.0063 (0.0038)	-0.0011 (0.0080)
	-0.0015 0.0031	-0.0031 0.0029	-0.0028 0.0057	0.0063 0.0038	-0.0011 0.0080
Village FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE × . . .	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Islamic Schools in 1989	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Secular Primary Schools in 1989	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
high potential rice yield	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
high <i>waqf</i> endowment	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Village-Years	676,782	676,782	676,782	676,782	676,782
Dep. Var. Mean (in 1990)	0.0045	0.0042	0.0066	0.0134	0.0287
R ²	0.122	0.132	0.224	0.158	0.191

Notes: This table re-estimates the exact same specifications in Table 3 (see the notes therein) but restricts the analysis to the periods (a) 1960–68 and (b) 1990–98, i.e., before and after SD INPRES. The SD Entry variable turns on the first year of a public elementary school (SD) entering in the given period and then stays on thereafter. In addition to the controls listed in the table, all specifications include interactions of year FE and the stock of public elementary schools in the village in the year prior to the panel beginning.

A-14

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors clustered by village.

Table A.8: Placebo: Private Non-Islamic Elementary School and SD INPRES Entry

	Dep. Var.: Private Non-Islamic Primary Entry			
	1973-78		1968-83	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
SD INPRES	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0002 (0.0002)
SD $\times$ high <i>waqf</i> endowment		-0.0009* (0.0005)		-0.0001 (0.0003)
Initial Schools $\times$ Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Village FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Village-Years	451,188	451,188	1,203,168	1,203,168
Dep. Var. Mean	0.0006	0.0006	0.0014	0.0014
R ²	0.177	0.177	0.072	0.072

Notes: This table re-estimates the village-level panel specification in Table 3 (see the notes therein) looking at how SD INPRES and its interaction with predetermined *waqf* endowments affect entry of non-Islamic private elementary schools from (a) 1973–78 and (b) 1968–83.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by village.

Table A.9: SD INPRES and Islamic School Entry – NGO-Affiliated Schools

	Formal <i>Madrasa</i>			Informal	All
	Elementary (1)	Junior Sec. (2)	Senior Sec. (3)	<i>Pesantren</i> (4)	Islamic (5)
(a) Baseline for All Schools, Table 2					
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.0017*** (0.0005)	0.0016*** (0.0004)	0.0009*** (0.0002)	0.0021*** (0.0005)	0.0104*** (0.0023)
Observations	11,000	11,000	11,000	11,000	11,000
Dep. Var. Mean	0.007	0.005	0.002	0.007	0.039
(b) Excluding Religious-NGO-Affiliated Schools					
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.0016*** (0.0004)	0.0016*** (0.0003)	0.0010*** (0.0002)	0.0018*** (0.0005)	0.0101*** (0.0022)
Observations	11,000	11,000	11,000	11,000	11,000
Dep. Var. Mean	0.006	0.004	0.002	0.006	0.036

Notes: The dependent variables are measured as new schools of a given type created per district-year and per 1,000 children in 1971. Panel (a) includes five columns reported in Table 2. Panel (b) restricts the outcome to Islamic schools not affiliated with the two large religious NGOs, *Muhammadiyah* and *Nahdlatul Ulama*. We do not report estimates for the informal *madrasa diniyah* (column 5 in Table 2) as these schools' names do not follow the same naming convention as the others that allowed us to identify NGO school affiliation.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors are clustered by district.

Table A.10: School Entry in the 1970s and the Legacy of Informal Taxation

	Dep. Var.: Any Informal Taxation for ...				
	Roads Bridges	Water Sanit.	Irrigation	Schools	Houses Worship
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
(a) Regressors for School Entry, 1973-78					
SD INPRES Entry, 1973-78	-0.004 (0.008)	-0.004 (0.004)	-0.002 (0.002)	-0.001 (0.002)	-0.007 (0.007)
Islamic School Entry, 1973-78	-0.041*** (0.014)	-0.004 (0.005)	0.002 (0.003)	0.008** (0.004)	0.021** (0.009)
(b) Regressors for School Entry, All Periods					
SD INPRES Entry, pre-1973	0.016* (0.009)	0.001 (0.003)	-0.002 (0.002)	-0.002 (0.002)	0.002 (0.005)
SD INPRES Entry, 1973-78	-0.003 (0.008)	-0.004 (0.004)	-0.002 (0.002)	-0.002 (0.002)	-0.007 (0.007)
SD INPRES Entry, post-1978	0.003 (0.007)	-0.004 (0.003)	-0.002 (0.002)	-0.001 (0.002)	-0.002 (0.006)
Islamic School Entry, pre-1973	-0.034*** (0.013)	-0.014*** (0.005)	-0.002 (0.002)	0.003 (0.005)	0.031*** (0.010)
Islamic School Entry, 1973-78	-0.040*** (0.014)	-0.005 (0.005)	0.002 (0.003)	0.007* (0.004)	0.021** (0.009)
Islamic School Entry, post-1978	-0.013 (0.008)	0.004 (0.005)	-0.000 (0.002)	0.005** (0.002)	0.006 (0.007)
Number of Individuals	61,486	61,486	61,486	61,486	61,486
Number of Villages	4,080	4,080	4,080	4,080	4,080
Number of Districts	64	64	64	64	64
Dep. Var. Mean	0.604	0.075	0.022	0.018	0.206

Notes: This table reports estimates of equation (A.1) relating village-level school entry in different periods to the likelihood of Muslim survey respondents in 2007–14 reporting informal taxation to support different types of public goods listed at the top of each column. The regressions control for district $\times$ survey-year fixed effects, individual age and age squared, and gender. The school entry variables are indicators equal to one if the given type of school entered in a given period. Islamic schools include all *madrasa* and *pesantren*.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

Table A.11: INPRES and *Waqf* Endowment Substitution across Islamic Infrastructure

	Schools		Share of Total <i>Waqf</i> Endowed Land in ...				Other	
	(1)	(2)	Houses of Worship (3)	(4)	Cemetery (5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
SD INPRES, 1973-78	0.0167*	0.0166*	-0.0236**	-0.0237**	0.0094	0.0095	-0.0024	-0.0024
	(0.0097)	(0.0096)	(0.0114)	(0.0116)	(0.0094)	(0.0094)	(0.0083)	(0.0084)
Islamic Schools, 1973-78		0.0788**		0.1364***		-0.2124***		-0.0028
		(0.0374)		(0.0489)		(0.0513)		(0.0353)
Number of Districts	275	275	275	275	275	275	275	275
Dep. Var. Mean	0.159	0.159	0.421	0.421	0.121	0.121	0.114	0.114
R ²	0.270	0.278	0.551	0.558	0.161	0.210	0.127	0.127

Notes: This table reports estimates of equation (A.2) relating district-level school construction intensity in the SD INPRES era to the share of total *waqf* land allocated to different types of Islamic infrastructure listed at the top of each pair of columns. The regressions control for the usual INPRES policy targeting variables. The school entry variables capture the total number of schools constructed from 1973–78 normalized by 1,000 children in 1971. Islamic schools include all *madrasa* and *pesantren*.

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

A.3 Further Background and Results on Religious Curriculum

Table A.12: Curriculum Differentiation in Islamic Schools (Total Hours)

	All Levels (1)	Primary (2)	Jun. Sec. (3)	Sen. Sec. (4)
(a) Islamic Subject Hours				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.255 (0.161)	0.263* (0.147)	0.094 (0.357)	-1.751*** (0.570)
Dep. Var. Mean	6.144	5.412	7.821	8.484
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	1.729	0.815	0.914	1.491
Number of Observations	4,243	1,404	1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
(b) Arabic Hours				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.052* (0.026)	0.062** (0.031)	0.075 (0.084)	0.436*** (0.060)
Dep. Var. Mean	1.332	1.119	2.020	1.886
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.431	0.187	0.283	0.257
Number of Observations	4,243	1,404	1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
(c) <i>Pancasila</i> /Civic Hours				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	-0.064 (0.060)	n/a	-0.243* (0.124)	0.208*** (0.053)
Dep. Var. Mean	1.621		1.813	1.390
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.334		0.315	0.185
Number of Observations	2,775		1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	237		213	178
(d) <i>Bahasa</i> Indonesia Hours				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	-0.107** (0.054)	0.001 (0.061)	-0.428*** (0.161)	0.052 (0.092)
Dep. Var. Mean	0.819	0.035	3.685	2.946
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	1.437	0.183	0.526	0.137
Number of Observations	4,243	1,404	1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
District FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Grade-Level FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year-of-Entry FE	✓	✓	✓	✓

Notes: This table reports analogous specifications to those in Table 4 with the dependent variable measured in total hours of instruction time per subject rather than subject-specific shares of total instruction time. The specification is otherwise identical to Table 4 (see the notes therein).

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

Table A.13: SD INPRES Intensity and Curriculum Differentiation in Islamic Schools
Other Subject Categories

	All Levels (1)	Primary (2)	Jun. Sec. (3)	Sen. Sec. (4)
(a) Math Subject Share				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	-0.002 (0.002)	0.000 (0.002)	0.000 (0.003)	0.026*** (0.005)
Dep. Var. Mean	0.027	0.001	0.106	0.091
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.046	0.008	0.006	0.027
Number of Observations	4,242	1,404	1,661	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
(b) Science Share				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	-0.002 (0.005)	0.000 (0.002)	0.002 (0.004)	-0.025 (0.038)
Dep. Var. Mean	0.029	0.001	0.106	0.128
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.057	0.006	0.008	0.086
Number of Observations	4,242	1,404	1,661	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
(c) Humanities Share				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	-0.002 (0.007)	0.001 (0.002)	0.005 (0.006)	0.092*** (0.031)
Dep. Var. Mean	0.068	0.031	0.135	0.277
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.083	0.009	0.009	0.126
Number of Observations	4,242	1,404	1,661	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
(d) Thematic Share				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	-0.004 (0.018)	-0.004 (0.018)	n/a	n/a
Dep. Var. Mean	0.687	0.687		
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.072	0.072		
Number of Observations	1,404	1,404		
Number of Districts	213	213		
(e) Physical Education Share				
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	-0.000 (0.003)	0.003 (0.004)	-0.012*** (0.003)	0.008* (0.005)
Dep. Var. Mean	0.076	0.084	0.056	0.052
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.026	0.024	0.010	0.009
Number of Observations	4,243	1,404	1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
District FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Grade-Level FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year-of-Entry FE	✓	✓	✓	✓

Notes: This table re-estimates the same specification from Table 4 for other dependent variable measures capturing the mean share of weekly instruction time devoted to mathematics subject material in panel (a), science in panel (b), humanities in panel (c), thematic primary-school subjects in panel (d), and physical education in panel (e). The measures come from the SIAP registry for the 2018–19 school year, and we categorize subject material using a procedure detailed in Appendix D. *Humanities* includes courses spanning Social Sciences, Economics, History, Sociology, Anthropology, Entrepreneurship, and Geography. *Thematic* includes a theme-based interdisciplinary subject schedule for primary school grades, e.g., a theme on “Friendship” or “Animals” would include activities traditionally covered by subjects in the other categories like science and humanities in secondary school. Column (1) for this outcome necessarily restricts to primary schools. All specifications include district fixed effects, grade-level fixed effects, year-of-entry fixed effects, and a post-1972 dummy interacted with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program, and the baseline number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa*, and *pesantren*.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

Table A.14: Heterogeneous Curriculum Differentiation in Islamic Schools

	Dep. Var.: Islamic Subject Share			
	All Levels (1)	Primary (2)	Jun. Sec. (3)	Sen. Sec. (4)
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.012** (0.006)	0.015** (0.006)	0.033*** (0.008)	0.054*** (0.007)
INPRES $\times$ Islamic vote share (1950s) $\times$ post-1972	-0.006 (0.005)	-0.006 (0.005)	0.033*** (0.009)	0.089*** (0.007)
District FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Grade-Level FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Year-of-Entry FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Observations	4,243	1,404	1,662	1,046
Number of Districts	258	213	213	178
Dep. Var. Mean	0.246	0.238	0.261	0.242
Dep. Var. Std. Dev.	0.047	0.033	0.028	0.036

Notes: This table presents reports estimates of a heterogeneous effects specification of Table 4 allowing the effect of INPRES intensity to vary with the vote for Islamic parties in the 1950s legislative elections. The latter is also interacted with the post-1972 variable. The specification is otherwise identical to Table 4 (see the notes therein).

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

Table A.15: INPRES Exposure and Name-Based Ideology of New Schools

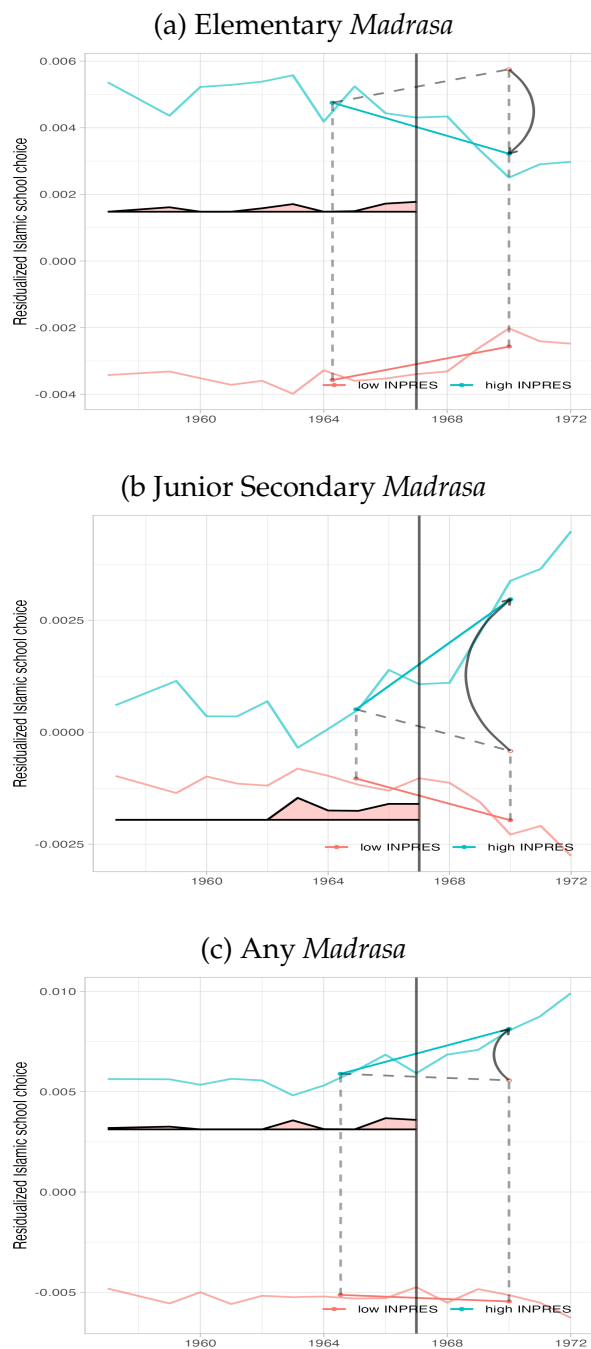
Ideology Prediction Based On:	Hours Islamic content		Share Islamic content	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
INPRES $\times$ post-1972	0.043*** (0.015)	0.048*** (0.015)	0.062* (0.033)	0.069* (0.036)
Observations	12,080	12,080	12,080	12,080
Number of Districts	266	266	266	266
District $\times$ Grade Level FE	No	Yes	No	Yes
R ²	0.899	0.906	0.462	0.488

Notes: This table reports effects of SD INPRES intensity on the name-based measure of school ideology described in Section 3.3. We use an unbalanced panel at the school-grade (primary, jun. sec., sen. sec.) $\times$ district $\times$ year level, including only years in which the given district had any school-grades enter. The estimating equation is $y_{sjt} = \beta(INPRES_j \times Post1972_t) + (\mathbf{X}_j \times Post1972_t)' \Theta + \delta_s + \delta_j + \delta_t + \varepsilon_{sjt}$, where s is a school-grade level. All specifications include district $\times$ grade-level fixed effects, year-of-entry fixed effects, and a post-1972 dummy interacted with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program, and the baseline number of elementary, junior secondary, and senior secondary *madrasa*.

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

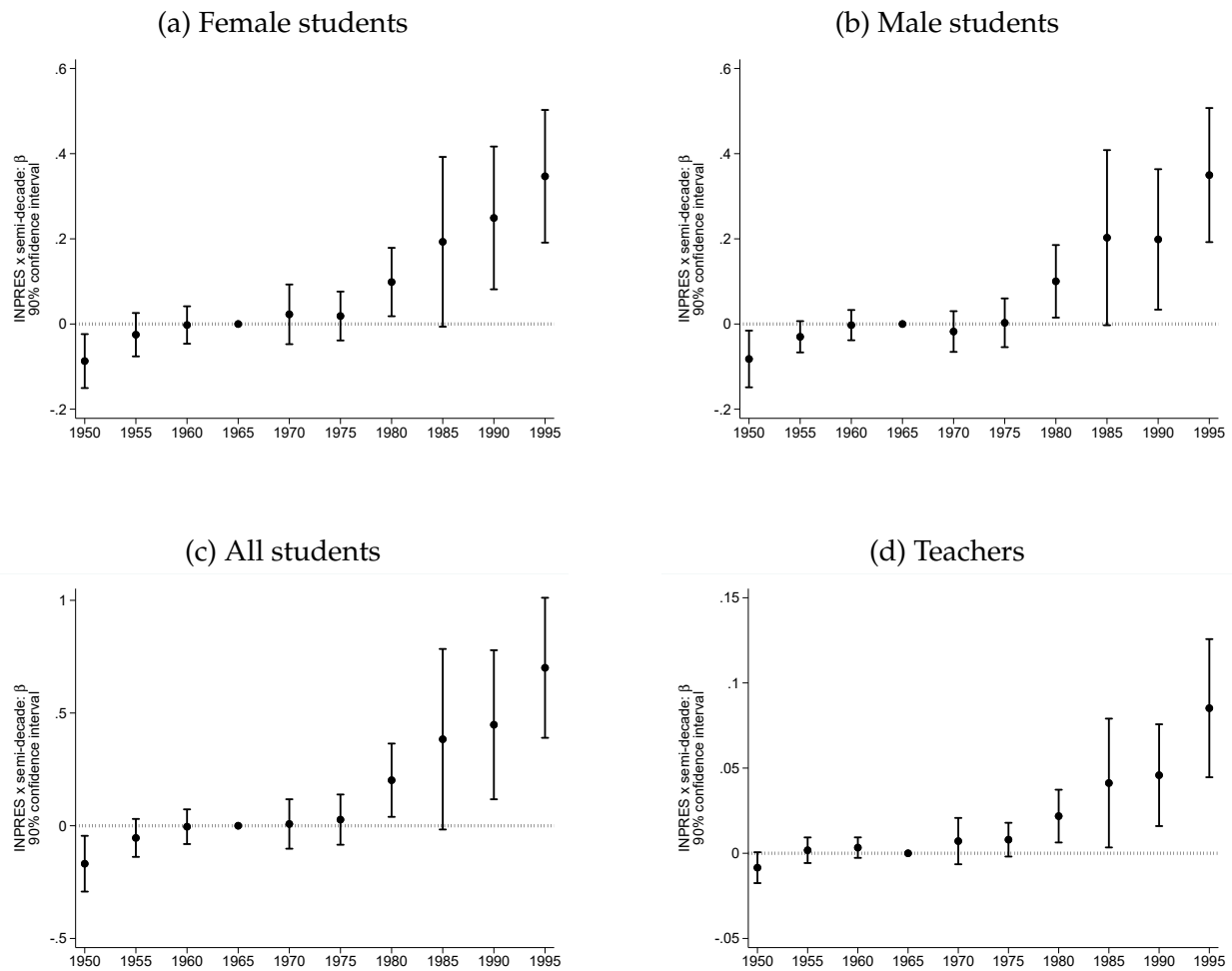
A.4 Further Results on Islamic School Choice

Figure A.7: Islamic School Choice, Synthetic DID Estimates



Notes: This figure reports synthetic difference-in-differences (SDID) estimates of the effect of SD INPRES on Islamic school completion based on annual *Susenas* data from 2012 to 2018. Each figure shows trends in enrollment in elementary *madrasa* (panel a), junior secondary *madrasa* (b), or *madrasa* at any level (c) for districts above the 51st percentile of SD INPRES intensity (“high INPRES” in blue) and the relevant weighted average of comparison districts below the 51st percentile (“low INPRES” in red), with the weights used to average pre-INPRES time periods at the bottom of each panel (in red). The outcomes correspond to the outcomes in Table 5. The dashed diagonal line indicates the counterfactual parallel trend, and the arrow indicates the estimated effect. The SDID estimation procedure is otherwise similar to that used in Figure 3 (see the notes therein).

Figure A.8: Informal (*pesantren*) Islamic School Enrollment



Notes: This figure reports semi-decade-specific estimates of β in equation (1) on a balanced district–year panel. The dependent variable measures: the number of female students (panel a), male students (b), students of both genders (c), and teachers (d) registered with informal Islamic boarding schools (*pesantren*) established in any given year normalized per 1,000 children in 1971. The data come the MORA registry of *pesantren*, which record 2019 enrollment by gender as well as total teaching staff. All other specification details are as in Figure 2. The figure reports 90% confidence intervals with standard errors clustered at the district level.

Table A.16: Islamic Education Rates

Source	IFLS, 1993–2014		<i>Susenas</i> , 2012–18		Admin., 2019
Exposure Definition	at given level		at final level		enrolled
Cohort	all	in school	all	in school	in school
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Education Level					
All	20%	25%	7%	9%	21%
	N=64,141	N=10,591	N=5,240,958	N=1,539,808	N=59,387,784
Primary	11%	16%	4%	6%	13%
	N=55,912	N=10,572	N=3,187,724	N=910,747	N=29,309,849
Junior Secondary	23%	28%	12%	15%	23%
	N=32,221	N=4,282	N=1,394,572	N=352,363	N=13,708,973
Senior Secondary	20%	24%	6%	9%	11%
	N=21,522	N=2,587	N=1,476,917	N=276,698	N=12,412,256

Notes: This table summarizes Islamic education rates across multiple levels of schooling using three different sources. The ‘All’ row includes *madrasa* enrollment as well as (where possible) *pesantren* enrollment which cannot be assigned to specific grade levels. Hence Islamic education includes only *madrasa* in the Primary, Junior Secondary and Senior Secondary rows. The sample sizes reflect the total number of observations over which the percent exposed to Islamic education is computed. Columns 1 and 2 used the Indonesian Family Life Survey (IFLS) longitudinal records from 1993, 1997, 2000, 2007 and 2014. This data is representative of 83% of the Indonesian population and does not cover many districts. This survey records the complete educational history of respondents. Column 1 reports the exposure across all individuals spanning the five survey rounds. Column 2 restricts to the 2014 round and looks only at currently enrolled students. The ‘All’ row includes any *pesantren* enrollment. Columns 3 and 4 use the nationally-representative annual *Susenas* data from 2012–2018, which covers all districts and which we deploy in our main empirical analysis. Unlike the IFLS, this data only captures the type of the final year of schooling completed by respondents and only allows respondents to indicate *madrasa* but not *pesantren*. Column 3 reports the exposure across all individuals spanning the six *Susenas* rounds. The Primary, Junior Secondary, and Senior rows are restricted to individuals that completed exactly 6, 9, and 12 years of education, respectively. Column 4 restricts to individuals currently enrolled in school in each round of the survey. These estimates are computed using the sampling weights to obtain national representativeness. Column 5 uses administrative data for the 2019 school year from the Ministry of Education (MEC) and Ministry of Religion (MORA). The former records *madrasa* attendance while the latter records *pesantren* attendance. The ‘All’ row includes *pesantren* enrollment.

Table A.17: Transitions Between Public and Islamic Schools

	Graduated Secular Elementary and Transitioned into [...]		Graduated Islamic Elementary and Transitioned into [...]	
	Secular Jun. Sec. (1)	Islamic Jun. Sec. (2)	Secular Jun. Sec. (3)	Islamic Jun. Sec. (4)
INPRES $\times$ young	0.0020*** (0.0006)	0.0003** (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 (0.0000)
District $\times$ Survey Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
1957 Islamic Schools $\times$ Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Individuals	839,026	839,026	839,026	839,026
Number of Districts	275	275	275	275
Dep. Var. Mean	0.022	0.002	0.000	0.000

Notes: This table reports estimates of equation (4) based on annual *Susenas* data from 2012 to 2018. INPRES refers to SD INPRES schools constructed from 1973-78 per 1,000 children in 1971. The dependent variables capture transitions across grade levels for those who graduated from one level and transitioned to but did not graduate from the next level. These are the only transitions that we can observe in *Susenas*, which records the type of schooling for the final year of education and, separately, the type of schooling for the final year of completed level of education. Column 1 considers an indicator equal to one if the individual graduated from secular elementary (SD) and transitioned to but did not graduate from secular junior secondary (SMP), column 2 an indicator for graduated from secular elementary (SD) and transitioned to but did not graduate from Islamic junior secondary (MTs), column 3 an indicator for graduated from Islamic elementary (MI) and transitioned to but did not graduate from secular junior secondary (SMP), and column 4 an indicator for graduated from Islamic elementary (MI) and transitioned to but did not graduate from Islamic junior secondary (MTs). The specifications are otherwise identical to those in Table 5 (see the notes therein).

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district of birth.

Table A.18: INPRES Exposure and Islamic Schooling in the IFLS

	Highest Education Level: [...] Islamic		Years of Islamic Education	
	Elementary (1)	Jun. Secondary (2)	Elementary (3)	Jun. Secondary (4)
INPRES $\times$ young	-0.0139 (0.0115)	0.0382 (0.0235)	-0.0509 (0.0640)	0.1232* (0.0717)
District FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
1957 Islamic Schools $\times$ Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Individuals	6,124	3,164	6,124	3,164
Number of Districts	205	197	205	197
Dep. Var. Mean	0.110	0.217	0.589	0.623
R ²	0.141	0.152	0.138	0.144

Notes: This table reports estimates of equation (4) based on Muslim respondents in the IFLS (1993–2015). The binary outcome variables in columns 1–2 are akin to those in panel (a) of Table 6, and the outcomes in columns 3–4 are continuous years of Islamic education at the elementary or junior secondary level. All specifications include district of birth dummies and year of birth dummies interacted with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program in the district of birth, and the number of Islamic schools in the district (elementary *madrasa*, secondary *madrasa*, and *pesantren*) as of 1957. The sample is composed of all individuals aged 2–6 (young) or 12–17 in 1974.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district of birth.

Table A.19: SD INPRES Exposure and Islamic School Choice (Robustness)
Additional Controls: Latent Potential Growth in Islamic Education

	Elementary		Highest Education Level: [...] <i>Madrasa</i>				Any Level	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
(a) Unconditional Estimates (Table 5)								
INPRES × young	-0.0008* (0.0005)	-0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0016*** (0.0004)	0.0025*** (0.0007)	0.0007** (0.0003)	0.0012*** (0.0004)	0.0013* (0.0007)	0.0028** (0.0011)
Number of Individuals	839,026	2,315,949	839,026	2,315,949	839,026	2,315,949	839,026	2,315,949
Dep. Var. Mean	0.014	0.011	0.011	0.016	0.008	0.012	0.031	0.038
(b) Conditional Estimates (Table 6)								
INPRES × young	-0.0015** (0.0007)	-0.0014 (0.0009)	0.0063*** (0.0021)	0.0060** (0.0023)	0.0001 (0.0017)	0.0025 (0.0016)	0.0009 (0.0007)	0.0015 (0.0010)
Number of Individuals	283,359	726,560	100,874	373,064	130,546	471,076	514,784	1,570,701
Dep. Var. Mean	0.024	0.024	0.070	0.086	0.044	0.053	0.038	0.047
Cohorts born 1968–72 vs. 1957–62	✓		✓		✓		✓	
Cohorts born 1968–87 vs. 1957–62		✓		✓		✓		✓
1957 Islamic Schools × Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Additional Controls × Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
District FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Notes: This table augments the baseline specification from panel (a) of Tables 5 and 6 with the following predetermined controls interacted with year fixed effects: the prevalence of *waqf* endowments in 1960, the Muslim population share in the 1972 census, Islamic political party support in the 1955 elections, historical Arab minority populations from the 1930 Dutch colonial Census, the occurrence of an Islamist armed insurgency in the 1950s, an indicator for districts involved in an experimental compulsory schooling program after 1957, and the total number of Transmigration villages and settlers before and after 1978. The dependent variables include an indicator equal to one if the individual's final year of schooling took place in an Islamic elementary (columns 1–2), junior secondary (columns 3–4), and senior secondary (columns 5–6). Panel (a) reports standard difference-in-differences estimates. All specifications include district of birth dummies and year of birth dummies interacted with survey year dummies, the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program in the district of birth, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa* in 1960, and the number of *pesantren* in 1960.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors are clustered by district of birth.

Table A.20: Exogeneity of the Compulsory Schooling Pilot Program

	Program Indicator (1)	Δ Schools ('1000s) (2)	Δ Teachers ('1000s) (3)
Elementary <i>madrasa</i>	-0.0014 (0.0112)	-0.0002 (0.0007)	0.0353 (0.0323)
Secondary <i>madrasa</i>	-0.0724* (0.0406)	-0.0058* (0.0031)	-0.1063 (0.0730)
<i>Pesantren</i>	0.0100* (0.0053)	0.0002 (0.0004)	0.0431 (0.0377)
Islamic elementary enrollment	-2.2458 (1.9434)	-0.0063 (0.1547)	-2.3549 (2.4869)
<i>Waqf</i> land	0.1343 (0.3971)	0.0643 (0.0510)	-0.9712 (1.3734)
Arab ethnic share in 1930	-1.8859 (1.8747)	0.0868 (0.1236)	-1.4780 (2.9838)
Historical Islamist insurgency	-0.0399 (0.0882)	-0.0137** (0.0062)	-0.1422 (0.1012)
Islamic party vote shares 1955-57	0.1610 (0.1666)	0.0003 (0.0084)	0.0143 (0.1572)
Muslim share	0.1185 (0.1103)	-0.0015 (0.0052)	-0.0111 (0.0706)
Number of Districts	273	273	273
Dep Var. Mean	0.121	0.005	0.064
R ²	0.163	0.150	0.249

Notes: This table reports district-level cross-sectional correlations between the introduction of the compulsory schooling pilot program (*Wajib belajar*) discussed in Section 4.1 and predetermined measures of Islamic schooling and presence in the late 1950s. The program applied to children aged 8 to 14 and was rolled out in 35 pilot districts starting in 1957 (Sarumpaet, 1963). The dependent variable is: in column 1, an indicator equal to 1 if the district was involved in the program; in column 2, the increase in the number of schools induced by the program; in column 3, the increase in the number of teachers induced by the program. The district-level stocks of Islamic schools (*madrasa* and *pesantren*) are measured as of 1957. Islamic enrollment rates are computed among cohorts born before 1957 based on *Susenas*. *Waqf* land is measured as of 1960. Other controls are defined as in Appendix Tables A.2 and A.19.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A.21: Heterogeneity in Islamic School Choice by Religious Preferences

	Years of School	Highest Education Level: [...] <i>Madrasa</i>			Any Islamic
	(1)	Elementary (2)	Jun. Sec. (3)	Sen. Sec. (4)	(5)
INPRES $\times$ young	0.1327*** (0.0248)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	0.0020*** (0.0005)	0.0010*** (0.0004)	0.0021*** (0.0008)
INPRES $\times$ young $\times$ Islamic vote (1950s)	-0.0136 (0.0290)	0.0002 (0.0007)	0.0010* (0.0006)	0.0006* (0.0004)	0.0018* (0.0011)
Observations	839,019	839,026	839,026	839,026	839,026
Number of Districts	275	275	275	275	275
Dependent Variable Mean	7.456	0.014	0.011	0.008	0.031
R ²	0.167	0.031	0.014	0.009	0.033

Notes: This table reports estimates of a modified version of equation (4). Compared to the baseline DID specification, we interact INPRES $\times$ young with the standardized vote share of Islamic parties in the 1950s elections, which is also separately interacted with cohort FE. With the exception of column 1, which looks at total years of education, the specifications are otherwise identical to those in Table 5 (see the notes therein).

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district of birth.

A.5 Further Results on the Substitutability of Public and Islamic Primary Schools

Although Islamic and public schools may cater to different groups, it is important to understand whether schools from the two sectors are substitutes or complements in raising overall education. We show in the main text that Islamic secondary schools generated some cross-grade complementarities as they absorbed excess demand for continued education among INPRES graduates that could not be met by the public sector. At the primary level, however, the two types of schools may act as substitutes or complements in raising overall education.

We explore this in Appendix Table A.22 by augmenting equation (4) to allow for entry of Islamic primary schools alongside and interacted with SD INPRES entry ($\times$ exposed cohorts). A negative interaction term implies that the two types of schools are substitutes. We estimate OLS and 2SLS specifications instrumenting for Islamic school entry with the mobilization mechanisms uncovered in Section 3.2, i.e., Islamic elementary school construction ($\times$ exposed cohort and *INPRES*) instrumented by the *waqf* endowment base, potential rice yields, and the Muslim population share ($\times$ exposed cohort and *INPRES*). These instruments are collectively strong; see the weak-IV diagnostics.

The estimates in Appendix Table A.22 point to substitutability between public and Islamic elementary schools entering 1973–78. Although each type of school is associated with more education for exposed cohorts (columns 2 and 5), there are counteracting effects when the two enter simultaneously (columns 3 and 5). Taking the IV estimates in column 5 at the mean Islamic and INPRES school entry (0.08 and 2.1 per 1,000 children, respectively), we find similar effect sizes of around 0.35 additional years of education when each school enters on its own. These gains are reduced by 0.25 years of education when the two types enter jointly. This suggests that the baseline estimate of around 0.13 additional years of education (column 1) might have been larger if not for competition from new elementary *madrasa*.

Across specifications, the IV estimates are significantly larger than the OLS (p -value <0.01). This may admit a LATE interpretation: elementary Islamic entry has the greatest impact on Islamic school choice in places where resource constraints in the Islamic sector were binding. The instruments capture, in part, supply shifts due to resource availability for Islamic organizations and leaders. In places where those entry decisions materialized, the latent demand for religious schooling would have been realized more quickly, giving rise to the larger own and substitution effects seen in the IV estimates.

Overall, these results provide further evidence of contestation between the Islamic sector and the secular state. We saw in Section 3.1 that Islamic elementary schools entered markets right after the state built SD INPRES. The estimates in Appendix Table A.22 suggest that these sequential entry decisions were partially redundant in generating additional years of schooling. However, because the learning environments were so different across the two sectors, a given year of education in public and religious schools would likely have been less substitutable in terms of impacts on identity and ideology, as suggested by our results in Section 5 of the paper.

Table A.22: Substitution between Public and Islamic Elementary Schools

	Dep. Var.: Years of Education (<i>mean</i> = 7.5)				
	OLS			IV	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
INPRES $\times$ young	0.134*** (0.029)	0.132*** (0.029)	0.155*** (0.032)	0.117*** (0.030)	0.185*** (0.042)
Islamic elementary $\times$ young		0.135 (0.162)	1.266** (0.503)	1.054** (0.505)	3.781*** (1.334)
INPRES $\times$ Islamic elementary $\times$ young			-0.568*** (0.206)		-1.521** (0.649)
District $\times$ Survey Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
1957 Islamic Schools $\times$ Cohort FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Number of Individuals	839,019	839,019	839,019	839,019	839,019
KP 1st stage Wald statistic				23.16	9.60
KP 1st stage LM test, p-value				< 0.01	< 0.01

Notes: This table reports estimates of equation (4) with years of schooling as the dependent variable and the regressors augmented with Islamic elementary school entry in the same period as SD INPRES entry 1973–78. Like the latter, Islamic elementary equals the total new Islamic school constructions during that period normalized by the district’s child population in 1971. Columns 1–3 are estimated by OLS and column 4–5 by IV. The instruments in column 4 include the exposed cohort indicator, young, times the district-level Muslim population share in 1972, the *waqf* endowment in 1972, and the predetermined potential rice yield from the FAO-GAEZ. The instruments in column 5 expand that set to include the triple interactions with INPRES. The OLS and IV specifications are otherwise identical to the baseline specification in the odd-numbered columns of Table 5 (see the notes therein). The KP 1st stage Wald statistic in column 4 is just the standard cluster-robust F statistic and column 5 is the [Kleibergen and Paap \(2006\)](#) multivariate Wald analogue. [Sanderson and Windmeijer \(2016\)](#) tests on the separate first stages in column 5 reject the null of weak instruments with p-values < 0.01. The KP 1st stage LM (Lagrange Multiplier) tests the null of underidentification. A Hausman GMM test strongly rejects the null (p-value < 0.01) that the OLS and IV are identical (i.e., that the regressors are endogenous).

* p < 0.1, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

A.6 Probing Linguistic Ability and Identity

Table A.23: INPRES Exposure and Linguistic Ability

	Able to Speak Indonesian			Latin Alphabet Literacy			Other Literacy		
	All (1)	Muslims (2)	Non-Muslims (3)	All (4)	Islamic-Educ. (5)	Secular-Educ. (6)	All (7)	Islamic-Educ. (8)	Secular-Educ. (9)
INPRES $\times$ young	0.0163*** (0.0052)	0.0224*** (0.0068)	0.0056 (0.0044)	0.0325*** (0.0038)	0.0101*** (0.0037)	0.0193*** (0.0039)	0.0038 (0.0023)	-0.0015 (0.0055)	0.0033 (0.0024)
Number of Individuals	31,680,947	27,811,517	3,869,430	839,026	25,819	813,087	839,026	25,819	813,087
Number of Districts	273	273	273	275	264	275	275	264	275
Dep. Var. Mean	0.931	0.933	0.918	0.914	0.985	0.912	0.060	0.045	0.061

Notes: This table reports estimates of equation (4) using data from the 2010 Population Census (columns 1–3) and *Susenas* 2012–18 (columns 4–9). The specification in columns 1–3 is the same as in columns 1–3 of panel (a) in Table 8 with the outcome here being whether the respondent is able to speak Indonesian. The specification in columns 4–9 is the same as in columns 4–6 of panel (a) in Table 8 with the other literacy outcomes here.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district of birth.

**Table A.24: Correlations of Islamic Education and Literacy
Conditional on Years-of-Schooling Fixed Effects**

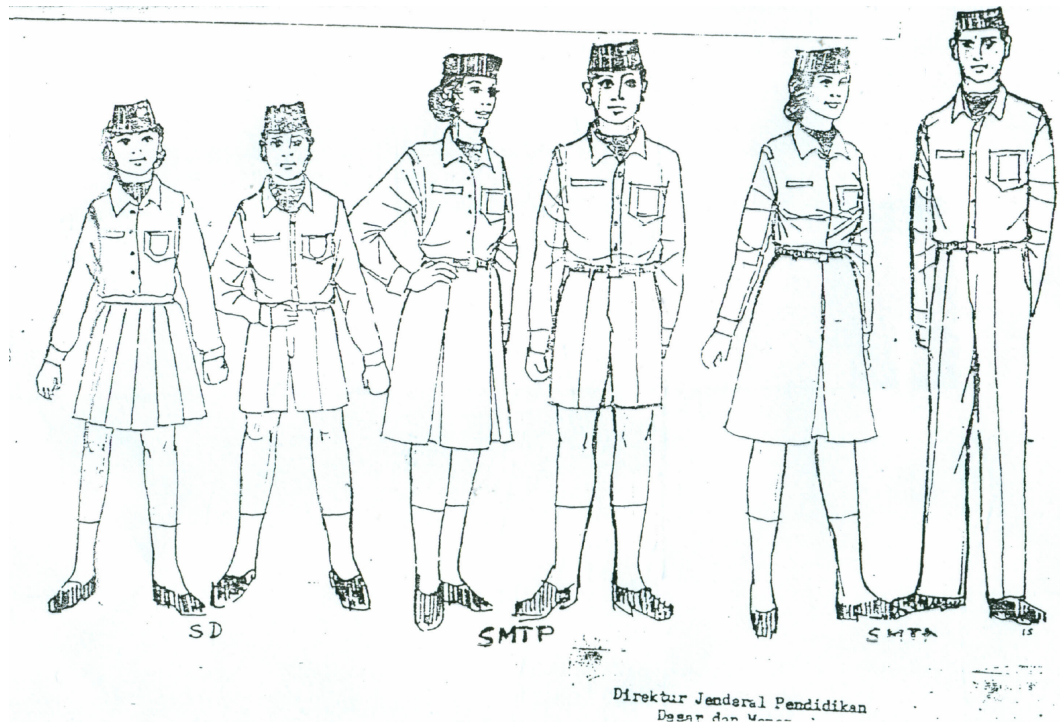
	Literacy in ... Alphabet		
	Arabic (1)	Latin (2)	Other (3)
Islamic primary	0.1992*** (0.0118)	0.0144*** (0.0020)	-0.0109*** (0.0025)
Islamic junior secondary	0.2627*** (0.0093)	0.0003 (0.0013)	-0.0021 (0.0030)
Islamic senior secondary	0.2842*** (0.0085)	-0.0004 (0.0012)	-0.0012 (0.0053)
Number of Individuals	839,019	839,019	839,019
Number of Districts	275	275	275
Dependent Variable Mean	0.343	0.914	0.060

Notes: This table regresses indicators for literacy in different languages/alphabets on indicators for whether the respondent's final level of schooling was Islamic primary, junior secondary or senior secondary. The data come from our baseline *Susenas* data from 2012 to 2018, and the sample is restricted to our baseline cohort specification used throughout the paper. The regressions are conditional on total years-of-schooling fixed effects such that the coefficients identify the differential literacy rates for those completing Islamic versus non-Islamic school with the same total years of schooling. The specification omits the interaction of INPRES and the exposure dummy but is otherwise identical to that used in column 4 of panel (a) in Table 8.

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district of birth.

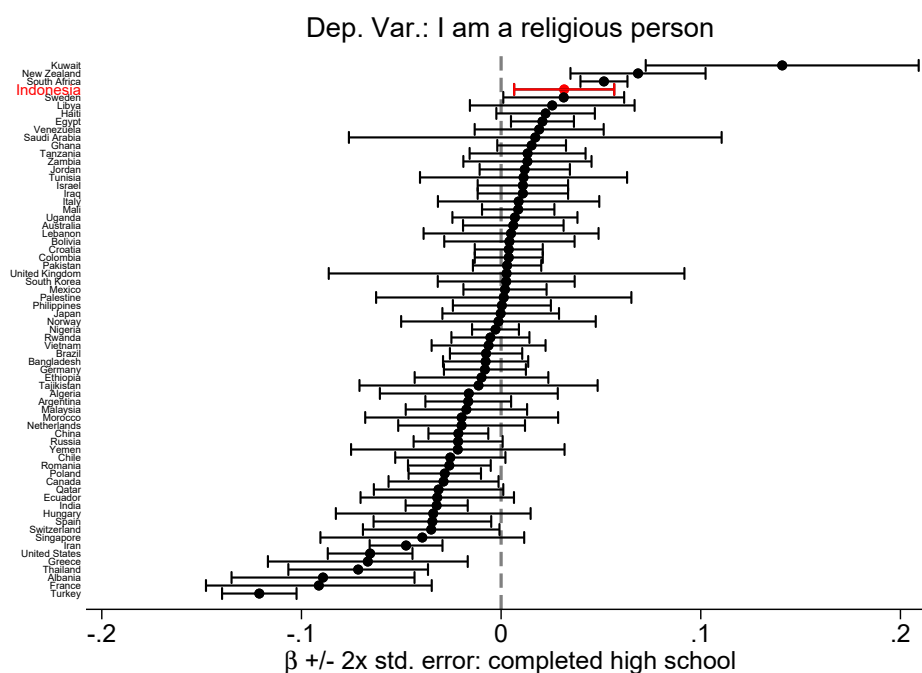
A.7 Additional Figures and Tables

Figure A.9: Mandatory School Uniforms in the 1982 MEC Regulation



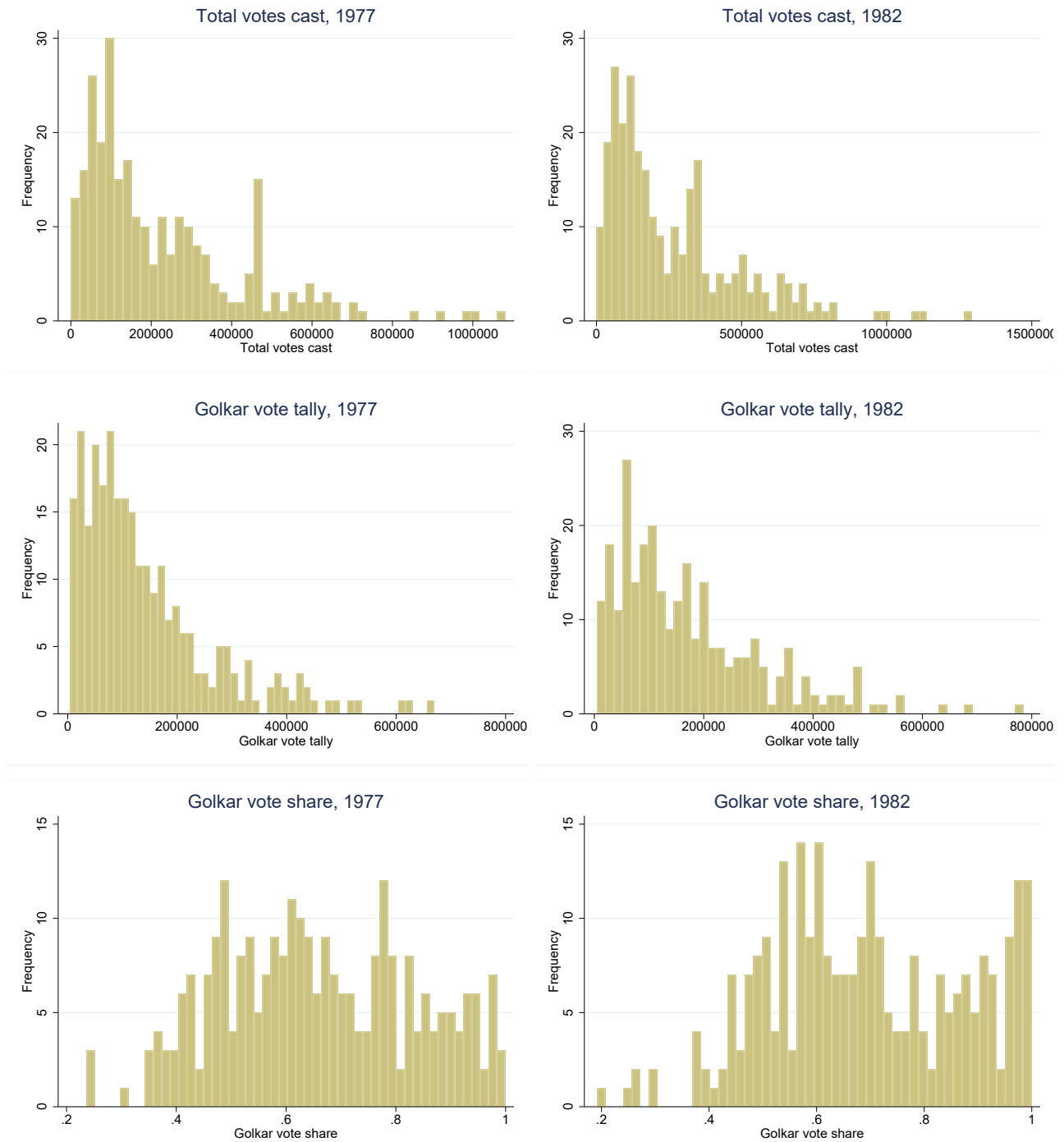
Notes: This picture shows the mandatory school uniforms for boys and girls across each instruction level in public schools (SD: elementary; SMTP: junior secondary; SMTA: senior secondary) in the 1982 MEC regulation on uniforms. Source: Decree of General Director of Primary and Secondary Education Ministry of Education and Culture No 52/C/Kep/D82 on School Uniform Guidelines for Students in Kindergartens, Primary Schools, Junior High Schools, and Senior High Schools Under the Authority of the General Directorate of Primary and Secondary Education.

Figure A.10: Education and Religiosity Across Countries



Notes: This figure reports the cross-sectional regression-based correlation between education and religiosity in the World Values Survey data spanning 1981 to 2020 with specific years of enumeration varying across countries. Education is an indicator for high school completion. Religiosity is measured based on the question, “How religious are you as a person?”, with answers being “religious”, “not religious”, and “convinced atheist”. Our outcome is a binary indicator for whether the respondent answers “religious”. Each point estimate and 95% confidence interval is based on a country-specific regression pooling across all survey waves for the given country. The regression controls for age, gender, religious denomination and survey year fixed effects, and standard errors are robust.

Figure A.11: Distribution of Key Electoral Outcomes in 1977 and 1982



Notes: We plot the distribution of: the number of votes cast by district (top row), the number of votes cast for Golkar (middle row), and the Golkar vote share (bottom row) in the 1977 election (left-hand side) and the 1982 election (right-hand side).

Table A.25: Electoral Data Checks: Excess *Golkar* Vote Share

<i>Outcome: Golkar vote (%)</i> <i>is ≥ [...] over mean:</i>	1971		1977		1982		1987		1992	
	1 SD (1)	1.5 SD (2)	1 SD (3)	1.5 SD (4)	1 SD (5)	1.5 SD (6)	1 SD (7)	1.5 SD (8)	1 SD (9)	1.5 SD (10)
SD INPRES intensity	-0.042 (0.034)	0.011 (0.017)	-0.005 (0.026)	0.003 (0.019)	0.004 (0.029)	-0.023 (0.018)	-0.031 (0.029)	-0.015 (0.010)	-0.008 (0.033)	0.005 (0.012)
Number of Districts	252	252	254	254	254	254	254	254	254	254
Dep. Var. Mean	0.171	0.040	0.181	0.087	0.205	0.091	0.209	0.031	0.217	0.051
R ²	0.321	0.198	0.480	0.425	0.556	0.412	0.522	0.172	0.451	0.265

Notes: District-level regressions in which the dependent variable is a binary indicator for whether the Golkar vote share is either more than 1 standard deviation (odd-numbered columns) or more than 1.5 standard deviation (even-numbered columns) above the mean in the given election. All regressions include province fixed effects.

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A.26: Electoral Data Checks: Excess Vote Tallies

<i>Outcome: Total votes cast</i> <i>are ≥ [...] over mean:</i>	1971		1977		1982		1987		1992	
	1 SD (1)	1.5 SD (2)	1 SD (3)	1.5 SD (4)	1 SD (5)	1.5 SD (6)	1 SD (7)	1.5 SD (8)	1 SD (9)	1.5 SD (10)
SD INPRES intensity	0.025 (0.018)	0.023 (0.016)	0.018 (0.021)	0.016 (0.015)	0.018 (0.021)	0.016 (0.020)	0.019 (0.021)	0.017 (0.018)	0.005 (0.022)	0.014 (0.019)
Number of Districts	256	256	256	256	256	256	256	256	256	256
Dep. Var. Mean	0.184	0.102	0.176	0.090	0.160	0.090	0.148	0.090	0.141	0.094
R ²	0.694	0.621	0.672	0.619	0.650	0.589	0.648	0.643	0.617	0.632

Notes: District-level regressions in which the dependent variable is a binary indicator for whether the total number of votes cast is either more than 1 standard deviation (odd-numbered columns) or more than 1.5 standard deviation (even-numbered columns) above the mean in the given election. All regressions include province fixed effects.

* p<0.1, ** p<0.05, *** p<0.01. Robust standard errors in parentheses.

Table A.27: SD INPRES Exposure and Ideology

	Dep. Var.: Respondent Supports ...				
	<i>Pancasila</i>	Islamic		<i>Sharia</i> (Index)	
	(1)	Politics (2)	Economics (3)	Subjective (4)	Objective (5)
INPRES $\times$ young	0.0203 (0.0415)	0.0018 (0.0880)	0.0346 (0.0605)	-0.0113 (0.0578)	0.0148 (0.0292)
Number of Individuals	1,444	1,284	1,297	1,377	1,286
Number of Districts	159	156	157	157	144
Dep. Var. Mean	0.857	0.616	0.732	0.637	0.434

Notes: This table reports estimates of equation (4) for ideological outcomes. The data come from the [Pepinsky et al. \(2018\)](#) survey data. The dependent variable in column 1 is an indicator for whether the individual supports the national, inclusive secular ideology of *Pancasila*, or thinks some other ideology would be preferable. We next look at measures of support for a greater role of Islamic principles in politics (column 2) or in economic life (column 3). Columns 4 and 5 consider measures of support for application of the *sharia* law. Column 4 is an indicator for whether the Muslim respondent express strong or very strong support for the implementation of *sharia* law. Column 5 is a mean index across several specific components of *sharia* law (e.g., prohibiting interest, mandating *hijab* for women). The sample is restricted to Muslim respondents from 1957 to 1987, excluding the partially exposed cohorts born 1963–67. The specification is otherwise identical to panel (a) in Table 5, which includes district of birth (times survey–year) fixed effects and cohort fixed effects interacted separately with the 1971 children population, the 1971 enrollment rate, exposure to the water and sanitation program in the district of birth, the number of elementary, junior secondary, senior secondary *madrasa* in 1957, and the number of *pesantren* in 1957 (see the notes therein).

* $p < 0.1$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$. Robust standard errors clustered by district.

B Conceptual Framework: Full Discussion and Derivations

This section describes a stylized model for understanding the interplay between state and religious schools. The framework clarifies how heterogeneous preferences and local market structure shape competitive responses to mass schooling interventions. We consider two types of actors on the supply side: the state sector and the religious sector. The latter refers to the decentralized combination of local organizations and communities that provide religious instruction, possibly across more than one market.

B.1 Setup

The model features N markets each home to a unit mass of students with heterogeneous preferences for religious schooling. The state and religious sectors each aim to maximize total student enrollment, and they compete through market entry and curriculum choices. Each market can support a state school s and/or a religious school r . Preferences are uniformly distributed over $[0, J]$, and J varies across markets. Schools compete on a line à la [Hotelling \(1929\)](#) with students ordered in terms of their religious preferences from most secular to most religious. Student i has preferences $\rho_i \in [0, J]$ and receives fixed utility $u_{i(k)}$ from school k :

$$u_{i(k)} = v_k - (x_k - \rho_i)^2$$

where x_k denotes school curriculum and v_k school quality. We assume that state schools have higher quality than religious schools but that this quality differential is not large enough to enable the state to capture all demand, i.e., $v_r < v_s < 2v_r$.¹ Student i attends school k if $u_{i(k)} > 0$, and otherwise chooses the school that maximizes u_i . Students with $u_{i(k)} < 0 \forall k$ remain unenrolled or attend an informal school.

State and religious schools offer different curricula. At one end of the spectrum, s must provide a secular curriculum, $x_s = 0$. This captures the state's objective to standardize and secularize education. Religious schools endogenously choose their curriculum, $x_r > 0$.

To enter any market, a school must pay a fixed cost of 1. The state initially has budget $S < N$, preventing it from entering all markets. The budget of the religious sector is a constant fraction of the state's budget, $R = \alpha S$, $\alpha \in (0, 1)$. Intuitively, the state and the religious sector raise revenue from the same tax base, but the religious sector has inferior tax capacity. We also use α as a reduced form representation of the strength of Islamic institutions in terms of their capacity to mobilize resources. More generally, this parametrization reflects the idea that income shocks that enable the state to fund mass schooling reforms may also trickle down to other segments of society, including non-state providers of education.

Timing. The timing of the game is as follows:

1. The state decides which markets to enter.
2. The religious sector decides which markets to enter.
3. Each religious school r sets curriculum x_r in the market where it entered.
4. Students in each market decide which school to attend, if any.

In what follows, we solve the model by backward induction. Then, we consider the effects of an exogenous windfall in the state's education budget. In [Appendix B.4.1](#), we provide all proofs. In [Appendix B.4.2](#), we extend the model to allow religious schools to also provide secondary education.

¹We further assume $J > 2\sqrt{v_r}$ to focus on the case where markets are large enough to accommodate at least one school, be it s or r . Evidence on test-score differentials support the assumption about average quality differences (see [Appendix A.3](#)).

B.2 Baseline Equilibrium

Stage 4 (student choice). In the final stage, each market may be served by a state school s , a religious school r , both schools, or no school. In markets with only s , all students who satisfy $\rho_i \leq \sqrt{v_s}$ will attend s , and the total mass of these students is $\sqrt{v_s}$. In markets with only r , all students who satisfy $\rho_i \in [x_r - \sqrt{v_r}, x_r + \sqrt{v_r}]$ will attend r . Given $J > 2\sqrt{v_r}$, in stage 3 school r will choose x_r such that its enrollment equals $2\sqrt{v_r}$ in these markets. In markets with both s and r , any student satisfying both $\rho_i \leq \sqrt{v_s}$ and $\rho_i \in [x_r - \sqrt{v_r}, x_r + \sqrt{v_r}]$ will choose to attend s over r if and only if:

$$(v_s - v_r) \geq x_r(2\rho_i - x_r)$$

Intuitively, students compare the benefit of higher schooling quality inside s with the benefit of more religious education inside r . Note that this constraint matters if and only if $x_r < \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}$.

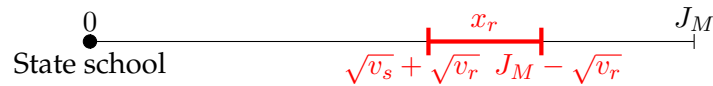
Stage 3 (curriculum choice). In markets where it operates alone, r can pick from a range of x_r that yield a payoff of $2\sqrt{v_r}$. The range of optimal curricula is given by $x_r \in [\sqrt{v_r}, J - \sqrt{v_r}]$. In markets served by both s and r , two cases arise. In the more religious markets (satisfying $J \geq 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s} \equiv \mathcal{M}$), which we call *major* markets, r is not constrained by competition from s and can choose any x_r that yields a payoff of $2\sqrt{v_r}$, e.g., $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$. In the less religious markets (satisfying $J < \mathcal{M}$), which we call *minor* markets, r has a unique optimal choice of $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$. In both cases, focusing on the most religious students by setting $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$ is always a best response for the religious school.

Stage 2 (religious school entry). From the perspective of school r , markets can be split into three groups: (i) major markets, (ii) minor markets with no school s , and (iii) minor markets with school s . The first two types of markets have value $2\sqrt{v_r}$ to school r . The third market has value less than $2\sqrt{v_r}$, which is also increasing in the market's J . Thus, the religious sector will prioritize the first two types of markets, namely the more religious markets (higher J) and less religious markets where the state has not entered. Only then, if it has any budget left over, will it enter remaining markets in descending order of J .

Stage 1 (state school entry). The state can enter up to $S < N$ markets and anticipates that religious schools will be present in $[R]$ markets. From the state's perspective, there are two cases to consider. Let m be the number of major markets satisfying $J \geq \mathcal{M}$. If the combined budget of both sectors is small enough (i.e., if $S + R \leq N + m$), then the two sectors split markets in such a way as to never compete for the same students. That is, there is no minor market where both schools enter—the schools might enter the same major market but would split minor markets without overlap.

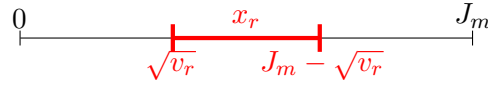
If $S + R > N + m$, then there are multiple equilibria where both schools enter *all* major markets and $S + R - N - m$ of the largest minor markets, and split the remaining minor markets in a non-overlapping way. Multiple equilibria come from rearranging how the schools split the smaller minor markets, but all equilibria have them jointly enter every major market and a few of the largest minor markets. The figure below illustrates the equilibrium prevailing in each market where a religious school has entered, with the range of optimal curricula for the religious school highlighted in red:²

1. Major markets with a state school:



²If $S + R \leq N + m$, then there may also be major markets with no state school, in which case school r sets x_r as in case 2. If $S + R < N$, then there are some markets where neither school s nor school r enters.

2. Minor markets with no state school:



3. Minor markets with a state school:



Overall, this setup sheds light on the market segmentation that characterizes the education sector before the introduction of mass public schooling. State schools and religious schools target segments of the population with different underlying preferences, with the latter prioritizing either the more religious markets or less religious markets that are underserved by the state. Curriculum differentiation allows religious schools to maximize student attendance in crowded markets, but the absence of state schools in some markets implies that curriculum may be set at a lower (less religious) level in those markets.

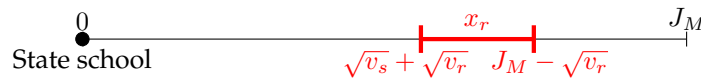
B.3 Budget Windfall

We now consider an exogenous increase in the state's budget to N . This allows the state to build schools in markets where it had not previously entered. In this case, there is an equilibrium in which the state enters all markets, whereas the religious sector enters $\lfloor \alpha N \rfloor$ markets. If there are many major markets, where $m \geq \lfloor \alpha N \rfloor$, then the religious sector simply enters as many of them as it can afford. If $m < \lfloor \alpha N \rfloor$, then the religious sector enters all major markets and $\lfloor \alpha N \rfloor - m$ of the largest minor markets, and this is a unique equilibrium. Regardless of the exact equilibrium outcome, the increase in the state's budget leads to a corresponding increase of $\lfloor \alpha N \rfloor - \lfloor \alpha S \rfloor$ in the number of markets that religious schools enter, where S is the initial state budget before the windfall.

Religious Curriculum. The state's budget windfall affects the choice of curriculum for religious school r . Recall that in the baseline case, the optimal curriculum x_r depends on the type of market. In any market without s , any $x_r \in [\sqrt{v_r}, J - \sqrt{v_r}]$ is optimal. In major markets with s , any $x_r \in [\sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}, J - \sqrt{v_r}]$ is optimal. In minor markets with s , the unique optimal choice is $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$.

Mass public schooling affects curriculum choice in all markets where r previously was and s was not. In major markets where the state could not previously afford to enter, the set of optimal curricula shifts upward from $[\sqrt{v_r}, J - \sqrt{v_r}]$ to $[\sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}, J - \sqrt{v_r}]$, i.e., some of the less religious curricula are eliminated. In minor markets, the change is even more pronounced. All less religious curricula are eliminated, and the only optimal choice is the previous upper bound $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$. As a result, mass public schooling increases incentives to further differentiate curriculum inside religious schools. The figure below illustrates the new equilibrium prevailing across major and minor markets.

1. Major markets:



2. Minor markets:



Taking Stock. The results above guide our analysis of the effects of SD INPRES on Islamic school entry, curriculum differentiation, and students' school choice. There are four main implications to consider.

First, SD INPRES increases the number of markets where both types of schools compete and coexist. That is, we expect a to see a larger number of markets supporting both types of schools, rather than state schools crowding out religious schools in districts with higher SD INPRES intensity. In order to maximize enrollment, the religious sector continues to prioritize major markets, which are the same markets prioritized by the state in the process of educational expansion. If there were previously markets served by neither sector, then mass schooling may lead to both sectors jointly entering these markets. Regardless of the exact baseline situation, mass schooling increases religious school entry.

Second, a higher fundraising capacity of the religious education sector (higher α) allows the latter to compete in more markets. In practice, the Islamic education sector might face smaller entry costs in markets with higher latent demand for religious schooling, namely those markets with a higher J . Smaller entry costs in those markets may result from a higher fundraising capacity through informal Islamic taxation or a higher prevalence of *waqf* land assets. If we allow α to vary across markets (e.g., if the funds raised for Islamic school construction are not fully fungible across markets), then the markets with higher taxation capacity should see relatively more religious school entry.

Third, the entry of state schools in new markets induces religious schools to differentiate towards more religious curriculum in those same markets. In the model, such differentiation is needed for the religious sector to minimize the potential loss in enrollment induced by mass public schooling. In practice, if schools face frictions in their ability to adjust curriculum over time, then we expect newer schools founded after SD INPRES to be more differentiated on curriculum than older ones.

Finally, introducing religious secondary education makes it relatively more likely that Islamic schools will locate in the same markets as public schools, as they seek to capture excess demand from primary graduates educated in either sector. This also increases incentives to make curriculum more religious at the primary level. Appendix B.4.2 discusses the formal details underlying this last set of predictions. We turn now to a discussion of the novel data that allow us to test these hypotheses.

B.4 Proofs

B.4.1 Baseline Setup

Stage 4 There are four types of markets that may arise: (1) markets with only s ; (2) markets with only r ; (3) markets with both schools; (4) markets without any school. Markets of type (4) do not involve any decision by the students. In markets of type (1) and (2), students need to decide whether to attend the only school they have or not. In markets of type (3), students need to choose between attending s , r or no school at all.

Consider market of type (1). School s must set $x_s = 0$. Hence, a student with religious preference ρ_i (called type ρ_i henceforth) will choose to attend the school if and only if

$$v_s - \rho_i^2 \geq 0, \text{ which implies } \rho_i \leq \sqrt{v_s}.$$

Note: if this market's J is lower than $\sqrt{v_s}$, all students will choose to attend the school.

Consider market of type (2). Suppose school r sets curriculum x_r . Then a student with type ρ_i will choose to attend if and only if

$$v_r - (x_r - \rho_i)^2 \geq 0, \text{ which implies } \rho_i \in [x_r - \sqrt{v_r}, x_r + \sqrt{v_r}].$$

Note: if this market's J is lower than $\sqrt{v_r}$, any choice of x_r will lead to all students attending the school.

Consider market of type (3). We already know that a student of type ρ_i may choose to attend school s if $\rho_i \leq \sqrt{v_s}$ and may choose to attend school r if $\rho_i \in [x_r - \sqrt{v_r}, x_r + \sqrt{v_r}]$. Consider a student whose type satisfies both conditions, i.e. she has to choose which of the two schools to attend. She will choose school s if and only if

$$v_s - \rho_i^2 \geq v_r - (x_r - \rho_i)^2, \text{ which implies } \rho_i \leq \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{v_s - v_r}{x_r} + x_r \right).$$

This condition can also be rewritten as $(v_s - v_r) \geq x_r(2\rho_i - x_r)$, which intuitively corresponds to comparing the benefit of higher quality in the public school on the left side and the benefit of more religious education in the religious school. Note: this constraint matters if and only if $x_r < \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}$.

This completes the analysis of stage 4.

Stage 3 Consider the curriculum decision of the religious school in markets of type (2) and (3).

In markets of type (2), the school wants to maximize the mass of attending students, which can be represented as

$$\max_{x_r} (\min\{x_r + \sqrt{v_r}, J\} - \max\{x_r - \sqrt{v_r}, 0\})$$

There may be a continuum of optimal values of x_r , provided that J is larger than $2\sqrt{v_r}$ (or smaller than $\sqrt{v_r}$). However, across all possible values of J , setting $x_r = \frac{1}{2}J$ is always an optimal choice. The range of optimal curricula is given by $x_r \in [\sqrt{v_r}, J - \sqrt{v_r}]$.

In markets of type (3), the school has to balance maximizing its reach over students and competing with the public school. A student of type ρ_i will choose to attend the religious school if and only if:

$$\begin{cases} x_r - \sqrt{v_r} \leq \rho_i \leq x_r + \sqrt{v_r} \\ \rho_i \geq \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{v_s - v_r}{x_r} + x_r \right) \end{cases}$$

Recall from stage 4 analysis that competition does not affect school r as long as $x_r > \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}$.

This effectively splits the school's problem into two possible situations: $x_r \geq \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}$, and vice versa. We can solve the problem separately and then compare the solutions to figure out the optimal x_r .

Case 1: Consider the case $x_r \geq \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}$. School r 's problem then becomes

$$\max_{x_r \geq \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}} (\min\{x_r + \sqrt{v_r}, J\} - (x_r - \sqrt{v_r})).$$

If $J > 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$ holds, then school r is not constrained by competition. There is a range of x_r (or a unique x_r in case of equality) where its objective function is maximized at the value of $2\sqrt{v_r}$. This range is given by

$$x_r \in [\sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}, J - \sqrt{v_r}].$$

Notably, picking $x_r = \frac{1}{2}J$ may no longer be optimal. This occurs when $J < 2\sqrt{v_s} + 4\sqrt{v_r}$.

If $J < 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$ holds, then the school's problem becomes

$$\max_{x_r \geq \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}} (J - (x_r - \sqrt{v_r})).$$

This problem has a unique solution $x_r = \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}$, i.e. the school wants to pick as low x_r as possible, while still maintaining the constraint of this case.

Case 2: Now consider the case where $x_r < \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}$. Based on the above, this case should only matter if $J < 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$. In such a case, the lower bound of students who pick school r is determined by school s , not by the student's individual rationality constraint. In other words, school r 's problem becomes

$$\max_{x_r < \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}} \left(\min\{x_r + \sqrt{v_r}, J\} - \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{v_s - v_r}{x_r} + x_r \right) \right).$$

For low enough values of x_r the problem takes form

$$\max_{x_{r1} < \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}} \left(x_{r1} + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{v_s - v_r}{x_{r1}} + x_{r1} \right) \right).$$

and for higher values it takes form

$$\max_{x_{r2} < \sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}} \left(J - \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{v_s - v_r}{x_{r2}} + x_{r2} \right) \right).$$

The first subcase has a strictly increasing function of x_r , so its solution will be on the upper edge of the subcases, where $x_{r1} = J - \sqrt{v_r}$.³ The second subcase is solved at $x_{r2} = \sqrt{v_s - v_r}$ or $x_{r2} = J - \sqrt{v_r}$, whichever is larger.

Assuming $v_s < 2v_r$, we can conclude $J > 2\sqrt{v_r} > \sqrt{v_s - v_r} + \sqrt{v_r}$, implying that $J - \sqrt{v_r} > \sqrt{v_s - v_r}$. Thus, the optimal choice for the religious school in the case $J < 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$ becomes $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$.

Overall, we can conclude that Case 2 is solved at $\sqrt{v_s - v_r}$ or $J - \sqrt{v_r}$, whichever is larger. If $v_s < 2v_r$, then Case 2 is solved at $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$.

To summarize, if $J \geq 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$, the religious school can enter the market without being affected by the secular school's competition, and get the same payoff as in a market of type (2). If $J \in (2\sqrt{v_r}, 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s})$, then the religious school has to actively compete with the secular school for students, and provided that $v_s < 2v_r$, it will choose $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$.

Note that in both cases, one of the religious school's best responses is to set $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$ in every market it enters, i.e. it focuses on the most religious students. It's not the only best response in larger markets and markets without competition from the state school. However, it is the only best response in markets where $J < 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$.

Stage 2 Consider the entry decision of the religious school. From its perspective, the markets are split into two groups: ones with school s and ones without.

School r 's problem may be viewed as a sequential decision about which market to enter next. It will identify "the best" market in each of the two groups, and then compare them. Whichever

³Note that $J - \sqrt{v_r}$ is smaller than $\sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}$ for this case.

market is "better", it will choose to enter, and move on to choosing which market to enter after that. This way, the school's problem can be viewed as a sequence of binary comparisons between the best market with school s and the best market without it.

Since school r only cares about enrolling as many students as possible, a market's value to it is measured by the mass of students it will be able to cover upon entering. For markets without s , this is easy to identify: given the assumption that $J > 2\sqrt{v_r}$, such a market always has value $2\sqrt{v_r}$ to the religious school.

Markets with school s split into two cases. If $J \geq 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$, then the market's value is equal to $2\sqrt{v_r}$. If $J \in [2\sqrt{v_r}, 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s})$, then the market has value

$$J - \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} + J - \sqrt{v_r} \right) = \frac{1}{2} \left(J + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} \right).$$

To summarize,

- (a) A market without s will have value $2\sqrt{v_r}$.
- (b) A market with s has value $2\sqrt{v_r}$ if $J > 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$. Otherwise, it has value $\frac{1}{2} \left(J + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} \right)$. Note that the latter value is increasing in J and is less than $2\sqrt{v_r}$ when $J < 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$.

This implies that the school will first prioritize markets that have value $2\sqrt{v_r}$. These are all markets without s and markets with s where $J > 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$. After that, it will rank remaining markets based on their J and enter them in descending order.

Stage 1 Here we introduce additional terminology: a market is called *major* if it satisfies $J \geq 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$, and otherwise it is *minor*. Major markets can host both schools without them actively competing for students, and hence harming each other's attendance. Let the number of major markets be m .

If the combined budget of the two schools is smaller than or equal to $N + m$, then there are many equilibria where the schools do not compete in any market, major or minor. For example, both schools might enter all major markets, and then split minor markets in a non-overlapping way. Alternatively, one school may mostly occupy minor markets, while the other mostly occupies major ones. Multiplicity of equilibria comes in how the schools split the set of markets in a non-overlapping way (except major markets, which they may share without affecting each other).

If the combined budget of the two schools is larger than $N + m$, then the equilibria all involve the following: both schools enter every major market and the largest (by J) minor markets; the smaller minor markets are divided between them in an arbitrary but non-overlapping way. Below is an example of how this may work.

Example: Suppose there are 5 major markets and 10 minor markets, with both schools having a budget of $R = S = 12$. If the schools enter all major markets, they both will still have a budget of 7 remaining. This implies that they will have to share at least 4 minor markets regardless of how they split them. In equilibrium, the state school will enter the 4 largest minor markets, and an arbitrary 3-large subset of the remaining minor markets. The religious school will then enter the 4 largest minor markets too, and the 3 unoccupied smaller minor markets. The multiplicity of equilibria here comes in how the two schools split the smaller 6 markets. The fact that they enter all major markets and the 4 largest minor markets is true in every equilibrium.

A few lemmas supporting the results above follow.

Lemma 1. Suppose s and r share a minor market with $J = j_1$, and suppose there is a minor market with $J = j_2 > j_1$ such that none of the schools entered it. Then this cannot be an equilibrium.

Proof. Either school obviously can improve their payoff by switching to the larger market in the corresponding phase. $\square$

Lemma 2. Suppose s and r share a minor market with $J = j_1$, and suppose there is a minor market with $J = j_2 > j_1$ such that only one of the schools entered it. Then this cannot be an equilibrium.

Proof. Let us start with school r , as it moves last. Suppose both schools occupy the market with $J = j_1$, but only school s occupies the market with $J = j_2$. By entering market with $J = j_1$, school r splits the market with the other school and earns a payoff of

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(j_1 + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{j_1 - \sqrt{v_r}} \right).$$

If it instead enters the larger market with $J = j_2$, it will earn a payoff of

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(j_2 + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{j_2 - \sqrt{v_r}} \right).$$

Note that this payoff is larger than the previous one, since the expression is strictly increasing in J . Hence, religious school prefers to deviate from $J = j_1$ to $J = j_2$, and the initial outcome cannot be part of an equilibrium.

Now consider school s in the same situation: it splits the market $J = j_1$ with r and doesn't enter market $J = j_2$, with r entering it afterwards. Under this outcome, it earns a payoff from this market equal to

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{v_s - v_r}{j_1 - \sqrt{v_r} + j_1 - \sqrt{v_r}} \right).$$

If it instead switches to $J = j_2$ in stage 1, then two things might happen later: r might remain in market $J = j_2$ or switch it to some other market. If it remains, then payoff of s improves to

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{v_s - v_r}{j_2 - \sqrt{v_r} + j_2 - \sqrt{v_r}} \right),$$

since its payoff above is increasing in J .

If r switches to another market, there are two subcases: either it switches to a market without impacting s 's payoff (a major market or a minor market without s), or it switches to a minor market with s in it. The former doesn't impact s 's payoff improvement, but the latter can. However, the latter occurs if and only if there is an even larger minor market which s originally occupied but r did not. In that case, the first half of this proof shows that the initial outcome could not be an equilibrium because r would prefer to switch. However, if r did not have such incentive while occupying $J = j_1$, then it will not switch to another minor market with s when that switches to $J = j_2$. Hence, s 's payoff will improve, and the original outcome could not be an equilibrium. $\square$

These two lemmas show that there is no equilibrium outcome where the largest minor markets are not split between the two schools. If a particular minor market is split between the schools, it must be the case that the larger minor markets are also split; otherwise, this is not an equilibrium. How many of these largest markets will be split in equilibrium?

Lemma 3. Suppose s and r share a minor market with $J = j_1$, and suppose there is a smaller minor market with $J = j_2 < j_1$ such that no school entered it. Then this cannot be an equilibrium.

Proof. It is sufficient to show this is not optimal for school r , though the same is true for the other school. By occupying the same $J = j_1$ market as school s , r earns a payoff of

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(j_1 + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} \right) < 2\sqrt{v_r},$$

where the inequality follows because of $J < 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$. By switching to the unoccupied $J = j_2$ market, r will earn a payoff of $2\sqrt{v_r}$ instead, which is clearly better. Hence, the original outcome cannot be an equilibrium. $\square$

This lemma shows that the equilibrium will have a particular split of the minor markets. All of them will be occupied by at least one of the schools, and the number of the largest minor markets split between both schools must be such that the remaining minor markets are partitioned exhaustively between the two schools in a non-overlapping way. There's a unique number that makes this work, and can be constructed in the following way. Start with schools jointly entering all of the largest markets, and then switch a school from the smallest of these largest markets to one of the smaller unoccupied markets one by one, until all markets are filled.

The exact number of minor markets that will be shared in equilibrium is given by $R + S - N - m$ or $N - m$, whichever is larger. This is true if and only if $R \geq N$ and $S \geq N$ are impossible. Otherwise, the exact number of shared minor markets depends on the parameters in a slightly more complicated way.

B.4.2 Introducing Religious Secondary Education

In this extension, we introduce religious secondary education. We then explore how this affects school r 's entry decisions at the primary and secondary levels. The market for primary schools works in the same way as above, except that the religious sector can allocate a fraction of its budget towards secondary schools. The new timing of the game is as follows:

1. The state decides which markets to enter.
2. The religious sector sets R_p , the amount of its budget R spent on primary schools.
3. The state decides which markets to enter for primary schools.
4. School r sets curriculum for primary schools in each market where it entered in stage 3.
5. Primary students in each market decide (in a myopic way) which school to attend, if any.
6. Using the remaining funds from stage 2, $R_h = R - R_p$, the religious sector decides which markets to enter for secondary schools, under the constraint that secondary schools can only be built wherever there is either a primary state or religious school. Secondary religious school curriculum must be set at some exogenous x_r^h and school quality is $v_r^h > v_r$. The cost of building a primary and a secondary school is equal to 1.
7. Primary student *graduates* in each market decide whether or not to attend the secondary religious school. They attend the religious secondary school if $v_r^h - (x_r^h - \rho_i)^2 > 0$.

In this modified setup, school r now maximizes a combination of primary and secondary enrollment (P and H , respectively), $P + \eta H$. We focus on the $\eta \geq 1$ case and, for simplicity, assume that there are no state secondary schools.⁴ Additionally, suppose that $x_r^h = J - \sqrt{v_r^h}$, since that is a best response under all circumstances.

Description of the equilibrium. In the baseline setup, religious schools avoided markets served by a state school. This changes once we introduce religious secondary schools, which may capture the excess demand from primary graduates educated in both sectors. This excess demand makes markets with a school s relatively more attractive for the religious sector, and leads to a change in the order in which schools r enter each market. The religious sector first prioritizes (major and minor) markets with a state school. Only then will it enter (major and minor) markets without a school s .

This different pattern of entry also incentivizes schools r to adopt a more religious curriculum at the primary level, for two reasons. First, in major markets with a state school s , the set of optimal curricula shifts weakly upwards to avoid competition from the state. Second, in all markets without a school s , the set of optimal curricula also shifts upwards because a low value of x_r would lead r to lose some of its least religious primary graduates at the secondary level.⁵ Thus, in addition to increasing incentives to challenge the state in the markets where it entered, the introduction of secondary education also increases curriculum differentiation at the primary level. Furthermore, this changes the incentives of the state, which previously would have prioritized major markets and the largest of the minor markets. Now, it has a strict incentive to avoid entering the largest of the minor markets because the religious school prioritizes those markets if it sees s in them.

Proof. Given $\eta \geq 1$, any religious primary school that entered a market will want to build a secondary school in the same market. The value of major markets and minor markets without s will increase, as the school now builds both a primary and a secondary school there (for the price of 2). Since $v_r^h > v_r$, both of these markets will have value $(2 + 2\eta)\sqrt{v_r}$. As for a minor market with school s , the primary attendance there is equal to

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(J + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} \right).$$

Note that the market is split exhaustively between the state and religious primary schools. Hence, when r builds a secondary school in it, it can take some of the state school's graduates and enroll them. Assuming $J > 2\sqrt{v_r^h}$, this makes secondary attendance in such a market equal to $2\eta\sqrt{v_r^h}$. This makes a minor market of size J with school s have a combined value for school r equal to

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(J + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} \right) + 2\eta\sqrt{v_r^h}.$$

Note that for some parameters, this may be larger than $2(1 + \eta)\sqrt{v_r}$. For instance, if J is sufficiently close to the cutoff between major and minor markets ($2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$), then the value of the market is close to

$$2\sqrt{v_r} + 2\eta\sqrt{v_r^h},$$

which is larger than $(2 + 2\eta)\sqrt{v_r}$.

⁴To maintain tractability, we do not consider competition between public and religious schools at the secondary level. Although restrictive, this assumption helps clarify the religious sector's incentives and will be relaxed in the empirical analysis.

⁵Here, recall that we assume $x_r^h = J - \sqrt{v_r^h}$. Formally, x_r must satisfy $x_r \geq x_r^h - \sqrt{v_r^h} = J - 2\sqrt{v_r^h}$ in order to minimize enrollment losses at the secondary level.

Another case to consider is that of major markets with school s . If J of that market is low enough, it is possible for a secondary religious school to get some graduates from the state primary school. For this, we need $J - 2\sqrt{v_r^h} < \sqrt{v_s}$ to hold, i.e. $J < 2\sqrt{v_r^h} + \sqrt{v_s}$. The value of building a primary and a secondary school in such market is

$$(2 + 2\eta)\sqrt{v_r} + \eta \left(2\sqrt{v_r^h} + \sqrt{v_s} - J \right).$$

This is clearly better than any market without school s , so school r will prioritize these markets in addition to minor markets with s . Note that this value is decreasing in J , so the school ranks a market higher when it is closer in size to $J = 2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$, the separating cutoff between major and minor markets.

How does the school comparatively rank major markets with s and minor markets with s ? Consider a minor market with $J = J_m$ and a major market with $J = J_M$, both with a primary state school. School r values the major market higher than the minor market if and only if

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{2} \left(J_m + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J_m - \sqrt{v_r}} \right) + 2\eta\sqrt{v_r^h} &< (2 + 2\eta)\sqrt{v_r} + \eta \left(2\sqrt{v_r^h} + \sqrt{v_s} - J_M \right) \\ \frac{1}{2} \left(J_m + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J_m - \sqrt{v_r}} \right) &< 2\sqrt{v_r} - \eta (J_M - 2\sqrt{v_r} - \sqrt{v_s}) \end{aligned}$$

The comparison on J_M and J_m is not clear. However, it is possible for this inequality to go either way. For example, when J_m is very close to $2\sqrt{v_r} + \sqrt{v_s}$ while J_M is not, the minor market is better than the major. When J_M is close to the cutoff instead, the major market is better than the minor. If school r has enough budget to fill both of these types of markets with primary and secondary school, it will do that. Otherwise, it will go through both lists and sequentially choose the best option out of the two.

Here is a formal summary of school r 's optimal order of building.

Lemma 4. *School r will both build a primary and a secondary school in the following order of priority:*

1. *Minor markets with school s that satisfy*

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(J + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} \right) + 2\eta\sqrt{v_r^h} > (2 + 2\eta)\sqrt{v_r},$$

in the descending order of J , as well as major markets with school s that satisfy

$$J < 2\sqrt{v_r^h} + \sqrt{v_s}$$

in the ascending order of J .

2. *Major markets without s , minor markets without s , and major markets with s that satisfy $J \geq 2\sqrt{v_r^h} + \sqrt{v_s}$.*
3. *Minor markets with s that satisfy*

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(J + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} \right) + 2\eta\sqrt{v_r^h} \leq (2 + 2\eta)\sqrt{v_r}.$$

In the first step, if the school has to pick and choose due to low budget, it will arrange the minor markets in descending order of J and the major markets in ascending order of J , and then compare the top options of both lists. As shown above, this formally corresponds to comparing

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(J_m + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J_m - \sqrt{v_r}} \right) \quad \text{and} \quad 2\sqrt{v_r} - \eta (J_M - 2\sqrt{v_r} - \sqrt{v_s}).$$

Lemma 4 impacts the choice of primary curriculum for r . Recall that we assume $x_r^h = J - \sqrt{v_r^h}$. When r expects to build a secondary school in the same market as a primary school, the primary curriculum cannot be too low (in order to maximize secondary enrollment. Specifically, x_r should satisfy

$$x_r \geq x_r^h - \sqrt{v_r^h} = J - 2\sqrt{v_r^h}.$$

If this does not hold, r will be losing some of its least religious primary graduates when it comes to the secondary enrollment. This changes the analysis in Stage 3 of the baseline model as follows:

- In markets of type (2) (without s), r must pick $x_r \in [\max\{\sqrt{v_r}, J - 2\sqrt{v_r^h}\}, J - \sqrt{v_r}]$, as opposed to $[\sqrt{v_r}, J - \sqrt{v_r}]$. This potentially shifts the set of optimal curricula upwards (in a weak sense), since the lower bound of the set may increase from $\sqrt{v_r}$ to $J - 2\sqrt{v_r^h}$, provided that J is large enough.
- In major markets of type (3) (with s), r must pick $x_r \in [\max\{\sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}, J - 2\sqrt{v_r^h}\}, J - \sqrt{v_r}]$. Once again, the set of optimal curricula weakly shifts upwards as its lower bound may increase from $\sqrt{v_s} + \sqrt{v_r}$ to $J - 2\sqrt{v_r^h}$, provided that J is large enough.
- In minor markets of type (3) (with s), there is no change. The optimal primary curriculum is still $x_r = J - \sqrt{v_r}$.

Interestingly, Lemma 4 changes the incentives of school s . Previously, it would prioritize entering major markets and the largest of the minor markets first. Now, it has a strict incentive to avoid entering the largest of the minor markets because the religious school is going to prioritize entering those if it sees s in them. Instead, it will prioritize markets in the following order.

Lemma 5. *School s will build its primary schools in the following order of priority:*

1. *Major markets, as well as minor markets that do not satisfy*

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(J + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} \right) + 2\eta\sqrt{v_r^h} \leq (2 + 2\eta)\sqrt{v_r},$$

in any order.

2. *Minor markets that satisfy this condition, in the descending order of size.*

Thus, s first prioritizes major markets and the smaller of the minor markets, and only then it goes back to the largest minor markets, if it has leftover budget.

Note that if the schools share any market, it again must be the largest of the minor markets. The exact number of shared markets depends on budget S first and foremost, and on budget R next.

Let m_{cond} be the number of minor markets that satisfy the condition

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(J + \sqrt{v_r} - \frac{v_s - v_r}{J - \sqrt{v_r}} \right) + 2\eta\sqrt{v_r^h} > (2 + 2\eta)\sqrt{v_r}.$$

The next lemma details the number of minor markets that r and s will share and compete in. Note that it is possible for the schools to share major markets without competing, i.e. impacting each other's attendance.

Lemma 6. *Schools s and r do not share any minor markets if $S \leq N - m_{cond}$. Otherwise, the schools share the number of the largest minor markets equal to*

$$\min \left\{ m_{cond}; S - N + m_{cond}; \frac{1}{2}R \right\}.$$

To understand this lemma, note that if S exceeds the number of markets that are not minor markets satisfying the condition above, it means that s will enter $S - N + m_{cond}$ or m_{cond} of those markets, whichever is lower. That is also the exact number of markets s and r will share, unless r does not have the budget to fill them all with a primary and a secondary school (which would happen if $\frac{1}{2}R$ is smaller).

C Oral History Accounts of School Construction in the 1970s

We conducted qualitative field visits to better understand the contexts, institutions, and history of local education markets at the time of SD INPRES, purposively focusing on the Islamic sector's response to the program. In total, we reconstructed from local interviews the histories of 9 SD INPRES schools, 33 elementary *madrasa* (MI), 14 junior secondary *madrasa* (MTs), 4 senior secondary *madrasa* (MA), 4 boarding schools (*pesantren*), and 6 Qur'anic afternoon (*madrasa diniyah*) established in 1973 or later. This appendix provides further background on these oral history accounts.

C.1 Setup

Site Selection. We selected the location for our qualitative interviews using the following considerations: (i) the historical importance of Islamic schooling in the area, and (ii) *madrasa* and SD INPRES construction activities between 1973–80. Our field locations included the districts of Sijunjung in West Sumatra province and Lamongan and Gresik in East Java province.

We selected West Sumatra based on a review of the secondary literature in Indonesian, Dutch, and English. Historical accounts of Islamic education in Indonesia highlight its deep roots in the region, reflecting its history as one of the first areas to be Islamized due to early contacts with Muslim traders from the Arabic Peninsula and India. Steenbrink (1986) noted that Adabiyah School, the first “modern” *madrasa* in Indonesia, was built in 1907 in Padang Panjang, West Sumatra. In addition, village-level data recorded as many as 51 SD INPRES schools in the district. Interviews were conducted in Fall 2021.

On the other hand, Lamongan in East Java stands out as one of the districts with the most *madrasa* constructions between 1973–80. In this period, Lamongan experienced the most constructions of Islamic junior secondary (MTs), the third-most of Islamic senior secondary (MA), as well as substantial numbers of Islamic elementary (MI) constructions (18 MTs, 7 MA, 87 MI). As a result, Lamongan had 0.39 more *madrasa* (across all levels) constructed per 1,000 children than the median district (0.32 more MI, 0.06 more MTs and 0.02 more MA). Interviews were conducted in Lamongan and neighboring Gresik district between October–November 2021.

Respondent Selection. We targeted respondents using snowball sampling. We instructed our local assistants to identify the following individuals for possible interviews: SD INPRES teachers or principals when the school was first established, *madrasa* teachers or principals at time of establishment, or community leaders (including village heads and subdistrict heads) who were in office during the construction period. Reaching the original *madrasa* founders typically required several interactions with intermediaries. Respondents were 69 years old on average.

C.2 Key Lessons

1. SD INPRES and Madrasa Compete on Location and Content. The first finding from our oral histories was that SD INPRES and elementary *madrasa* built between 1973–80 tend to operate in close geographical proximity to each other. Several villages had both types of schools constructed less than one kilometer apart from each other; occasionally the two schools were a few dozen meters apart. Constructions of new elementary *madrasa* tended to closely track the timing of SD INPRES construction.

One of the SD INPRES schools we located was described as having been strongly opposed by local religious leaders, who would frequently mention it during Friday prayers and subsequently mobilized the community to build a MTs. In this case, the SD INPRES itself competed back by providing free uniforms to students. One striking anecdote mentioned to us was that religious leaders would often refer to SDN (*Sekolah Dasar Negeri*, i.e., public primary school) as “schools in hell”, using a wordplay on the

Indonesian acronym. Finally, we recorded instances of (i) failed attempts to merge the SD INPRES with the local MI, after pushback from local chapters of large Islamic organizations (*Nahdlatul Ulama* (NU) and *Muhammadiyah*), and (ii) cheating in national exams orchestrated by SD INPRES and MI instructors as part of the ongoing competition between both types of schools.

Neighboring SD INPRES and elementary *madrasa* also competed on the content and organization of schooling. A local religious leader (known colloquially as *kiai*) who established an MI openly declared competition with the new SD. The *kiai* *“already had many students, the children in the neighborhood all went there. But when the SD was built he reacted like that. He felt the competition, because his school is located close with the SD.”* In that same village, the SD INPRES initially had high enrollment, but this enrollment dwindled—by the mid 1990s, the school only had six pupils left. *“The reason was that over time the community felt that the portion of religious teaching in the SD was inadequate for the children.”* In this and other cases, combining formal education in the state (SD) school with Islamic teachings in the early morning or the late afternoon was a solution adopted by many families: *“the elders and youths of the village discussed this and agreed to hold extra religious classes prior to the normal school day. The school day was made to start at 5:30am so they could have extra religious classes before normal school started at 7 am.”* The *kiai* *“then built a kindergarten in the village, with the hope that the kindergarten graduates go to MI, not the SD INPRES.”*

Competition to attract students transitioning across instruction levels was also salient in our interviews. In one instance, an SD INPRES instructor affiliated with NU encouraged all SD INPRES graduates to transition into the local MTs. Most MI graduates chose to continue their education in the nearest MTs, especially when the schools were run by NU or *Muhammadiyah*. While others chose to transition to the nearby *pesantren*, few students were said to have chosen the nearby SMP (junior secondary public school) because *“they deemed the religious education there was lacking.”* Other *Nahdliyin* (NU-affiliated) community members reported preferring educational institutions that offer a 70% religion / 30% general curriculum mix. A respondent affiliated with an MTs stated: *“To me, the curriculum from the government rather made the religious lessons fewer, because they add the numerous general subjects. We offer Fiqh, Alquran Hadits, Aqidah Akhlak, and others. The madrasa’s curriculum is roughly balanced between religious subjects and general subjects.”*

2. Waqf Contributions Supported Fixed Setup and Variable Operating Costs. New *madrasa* constructions were usually funded through donations from wealthy community members. In one case, *“the founders and administrators personally approached the Hajji [local elites who had made the pilgrimage to Mecca]. She had a lot of land, in the neighboring village a lot of land, in this village also a lot of land, she had land everywhere. Unfortunately she did not have any children, maybe she didn’t know whom to leave the land to. We asked for land to build a school. Thank God, she agreed immediately.”*

Constructing and launching a new *madrasa*, however, was a substantial effort that often required makeshift solutions in the short run: *In its first years, the madrasah used the space at the mosque for its classroom activities. Only in 1985 did the madrasa build its own permanent building on a land waqf endowed by ... a local community leader who was moved to give some of his land for the constructions.”*

Other community members contributed progressively through cash *waqf* auctions. This mechanism was described to us as follows: *“The land for the madrasa building was the property of one of the rich villagers which was bought communally using ‘waqf auction’. This is similar to common waqf that has land as its object, but to participate in the waqf, the waqif [waqf administrator] from local community bought it in an auction. The price was set at IDR 1,500 per square meter [roughly USD 1/square meter]. The waqif voluntarily bought the parcel according to their abilities.”* Prices recorded in these auctions varied across villages; in another village the price point was IDR 5,000 per square meter.

Finally, even the less well-off families were asked to contribute to the local fundraising effort: *“In this community in the old days, every harvest, a portion of the revenues was given to the madrasah. They themselves decided how much they could afford and they were keen to give. These were routine for years.”* Farmers were

among the first mobilized: *“Every harvest—our biggest harvest was peanut—the children helped their parents for the harvest. The NU-affiliated Muslim women helped us collect the harvest donation for the madrasah.”* These contributions would then mean that parents who enrolled their children in the *madrasa* were exempt from paying any fees: *“Here was the calculation: how much an agricultural laborer earned in two mornings, that’s their contribution for their children. For a ploughman, how much did he earn plowing the rice fields for two days, that’s what he gave to the madrasah. For a sawman, his earnings in two days was what he paid. Every child paid different amounts, because their parents’ earnings were also different.”*

3. Golkar Intervention in Education Markets. Finally, we uncovered anecdotal evidence consistent with SD INPRES allocation being used for political motives. In one instance, an SD INPRES planned in one village was moved to a different village after *Golkar* failed to win the election locally. Meanwhile, *madrasa* administrators faced various pressures from *Golkar* members to facilitate enrollment in the local SD INPRES. A *madrasa* teacher active since the 1970s shared with us: *“Once the village head came to visit me to ask the MI to ‘share’ its students with the newly built SD INPRES. Incidentally the village head is a Golkar man, so surely he sided with the SD. I told him that the decision of where children go to school is not my decision, but the decision of the child with their parents, a family decision. I did not dictate it nor should it be the village head’s business.”* We recorded other instances of MI and MTs teachers being pressured to join GUPPI (the Association for the Improvement of Islamic Education taken over by Suharto’s *Golkar* partisans), to participate in local *Pancasila* seminars, and to join or publicly support *Golkar*. One surviving MI founder reported feeling that his school had been ostracized by the New Order government because of the school’s affiliation with NU, which was seen back then as a hotbed of support for *Masyumi*, a major Islamic political party banned in 1960 under Sukarno.

D Data Sources and Construction

We describe here the main variables and data sources used in the paper.

Education: Survey and Administrative Data

Surveys. We measure years and type of schooling using the annual National Socioeconomic Survey (*Susenas*) from 2012, 2013, 2014, 2016, 2017, and 2018. These enumerate schooling measures for all household members and also record the birth district for each, which we merge with the district-level INPRES intensity measure collected by Duflo (2001). We additionally use Islamic school attendance data from the Indonesia Family Life Survey (IFLS) in 1993, 1997, 2000, 2007, and 2014. The IFLS is too limited geographically for our econometric analysis, but we use it for descriptive purposes in Table A.16 and elsewhere in the text.

Susenas reports the type of education (Islamic or secular) for the final level of schooling certification (primary, junior secondary, and senior secondary) as well as the final year of schooling attended if falling between certification levels. Our measure of Islamic schooling is based on the union of these two, but results are nearly identical when restricting to final level certified or final level attended. For example, some individuals report completing secular primary school and attending two years of Islamic junior secondary but not completing the full three years at that level. Our approach identifies this individual as having secular primary school and, separately, Islamic junior secondary school.

Registries. We use data from numerous administrative sources provided by the Government of Indonesia. Table A.16 used data on total non-*pesantren* enrollment in 2019 from the Ministry of Education (MEC) and Ministry of Religious Affairs (MORA) as reported at the following website: <http://apkapm.data.kemdikbud.go.id> (accessed March 22, 2020). *Pesantren* enrollment in 2019 is computed from school-level records that we scraped from the MORA portal: <https://ditpdpontren.kemenag.go.id/pbsb/> (accessed November 15, 2018). These records also indicate the district and year of establishment for each *pesantren* (see Bazzi et al., 2020, for additional details).

Data on *madrasa* come from MORA registries provided to us by MORA officials in August 2019 and January/February 2020.¹ These include village, district, and year of establishment for all formal *madrasa* (primary, junior secondary, and senior secondary) as well as informal *madrasa diniyah*. The latter are entirely privately-run. The former are majority private with a small fraction (around 8%) that are publicly-run by MORA. Overall, 6% of *madrasa* and 22% of *pesantren*, respectively, have missing establishment years. This missing-ness is uncorrelated with SD INPRES intensity.

Data on non-Islamic schools come from a MEC registry known by its Indonesian acronym *Dapodik*.² These data include village, district, and year of establishment for all formal schools not administered by MORA. These include 166,257 publicly-run schools and 52,888 privately-run schools. Among the latter, 10,919 schools have Islamic names, indicating that they are likely religious schools operating under the MEC instead of MORA. These schools are subject to different regulations on curriculum and also have access to other sources of state funding than the Islamic schools under MORA oversight. We distinguish secular from Islamic-named private schools in the MEC data by identifying the latter as having any of the following terms appearing in the school name: Islam, Darussalam, Darul, Muhammada, Salam, Sunna, Kuran, Jihad, Umma, Madrasa Halal, or Imam. We use this distinction to examine private secular schools in Appendix Figure A.2.

¹We are grateful to the following individuals for graciously sharing these data: Dodi Irawan, Aziz Saleh, Dr. Abdullah Faqih, and Doni Wibowo.

²We are grateful to Wisnu Harto Adiwijoyo for graciously sharing these data.

In addition to the main district-level data constructed from the above registries, we also built a village-level panel. We use the 2018 *Podes* dataset listing all villages in Indonesia as the master. We match this database by successively using a fuzzy merge with the *Dapodik*, MORA *madrasa*, MORA *diniyah*, and *pesantren* data. The *Dapodik* and MORA *madrasa* data record the village name where the school is located, while the *diniyah* and *pesantren* datasets have address fields to identify the location of each establishment. The fuzzy merge uses province code, district name, subdistrict name, and village name with a high matching score threshold (0.95) and required match on province code and district name. We were able to match 80% of villages in *Dapodik* and 84% of villages in MORA *madrasa* data. For *diniyah* and *pesantren*, we use village names extracted from its full address after pre-processing the address string with extensive regular expressions. We are able to match 62% of villages in the *diniyah* dataset and 66% of villages in the *pesantren* dataset.

We measure curriculum content at the school-grade level using data from the Sistem Informasi Aplikasi Pendidikan (SIAP) registry of schools. We scraped data from this registry's online portal over several months in Fall 2019: <http://siap-sekolah.com/>. As of April 2020, SIAP only included detailed curriculum timetables for *madrasa*. We link these *madrasa* to the MORA registry using school IDs reported in both sources. The SIAP report detailed course timetables for every hour of every schoolday in a typical week for the 2018–2019 academic year. There are over 3,000 distinct course titles with many being (spelling) variations on the same topic. We coded up each course as being Islamic or non-Islamic and also identified courses associated with civic education and *Pancasila*, which are known by their Indonesian acronym of PPKN. These course codings are available upon request. SIAP includes data for around one-fifth of all *madrasa*, but as noted in the text, this selective reporting likely works against our core findings with respect to INPRES intensity.

We process the curriculum strings with the following procedures. Each string has the start and end of each study period as well as its subject name; separately for each day (Monday-Saturday for the majority of schools, with a minority of schools Saturday-Thursday). We parse the string to obtain the subject name and its duration on a given period. We then run a regular expression on the parsed string to match on the following categories: (1) Islamic subjects using a list of manually coded course titles, (2) Pancasila/Civic, using the keywords “PPKn” or “Pendidikan Pancasila dan Kewarganegaraan” (3) Bahasa Indonesia, using the keywords “Bahasa” and “Indo,” (4) Arabic using the keyword “Arab” XOR keywords “Fiq”/“Fik” (as stem for *Fiqh*, which would otherwise be covered by the course coding), (5) Math using the keyword “Matematika,” (6) Natural Sciences using the keywords “Ilmu Pengetahuan Alam,” “Fisika,” “Kimia,” or “Biologi” (7) Humanities using the keywords “Ilmu Pengetahuan Sosial,” “Ekonomi,” “Sejarah,” “Sosiologi,” “Wirausaha,” “Antropologi,” or “Geografi,” and (8) Thematics for primary schools, using “Tematik” exactly at the beginning of the string. Thematic subjects was introduced with the 2013 curriculum (see Decree of the Ministry of Education and Culture number 67 year 2013), to subsume the following subjects: Indonesian language, Civics (PPKn), math (*Matematika*), natural sciences (IPA), social sciences and humanities (IPS), arts and crafts (*Seni Budaya dan Prakarya*), and physical education (*Pendidikan Jasmani, Olahraga, dan Kesehatan*). The subjects are reorganised into themes, such as “Environment,” “Hobbies,” “Friendship,” “Energy,” etc.

Electoral Outcomes: Vote Shares and Legislative Candidates

Vote Shares. First, we draw upon district-level vote shares by party from the national legislative elections in 1971, 1977, 1982, 1987, 1992, 1999, 2004, and 2009. These data were graciously shared with us by individuals that worked with Dwight King. In 1971, one observes the following Islamic parties: NU, PSII, Perti, and the Muslim Party of Indonesia (*Partai Muslimin Indonesia* or Parmusi). From 1977 to 1992, the only Islamic party was the United Development Party (*Partai Persatuan Pembangunan* or PPP), which was forged out of a forced merger of the four Islamic parties contesting the 1971 election. We study the

vote shares for the PPP and the Suharto regime party, *Golkar*.

Legislative Candidates. We use data on the universe of legislative candidates in the 2019 election. Thanks to Nicholas Kuipers for scraping and sharing these data from the Indonesian Electoral Commission: <http://www.kpu.go.id/>. These include candidates for national, provincial, and district legislatures. We use information on candidate age, district, and party ticket. We also categorize their campaign motivation and platform statements as appealing to Islamic themes as reflected in the following words: *umma*, *dawah*, Muslim, Islam, *sharia*, and jihad. We separately classify appeals to nation building as reflected in the following words: *Pancasila*, Indonesia, NKRI, *bangsa* (nation), *bhinneka* (diversity), and *satuan* (unitary). The latter three terms are staples in the nation-building corpus of Indonesian leaders and literature. NKRI is an acronym for the Indonesian homeland in a popular nationalistic slogan.

Linguistic Proxies for Identity

We proxy for national identity using an indicator of whether an individual speaks the national language, *Bahasa Indonesia*, as his/her main language at home (instead of his/her native ethnic language). This is distinct from Indonesian speaking ability, which we also observe. These data—along with religion, age, and district of birth—are recorded in the complete-count 2010 Population Census, which we obtained from the Harvard Library.

We view Arabic language proficiency as one indicator of Islamic identity. The *Susenas* data described above record literacy in Latin, Arabic, and other alphabets.

Religiosity and Religious Political Preferences

We use rich individual-level survey data from [Pepinsky, Liddle and Mujani \(2018\)](#), which is based on a 2008 survey conducted by the authors in which 10 individuals were sampled from each contemporary district. These data include individual age, religion, years and type of education, a host of questions on Islamic piety, practice, and political preferences. Seven Islamic practices are explored in Table 8. The survey also record dimensions of support for Islamic law (*sharia*) and religious politics more generally. We also use a measure of stated support for *Pancasila*.